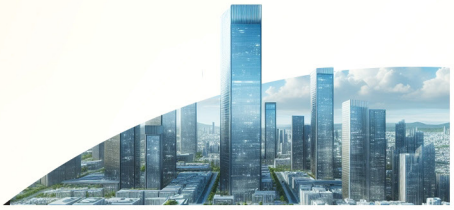
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VALUE ADDED MATERIAL

MAINS 2025













Key Features:

PYQ-Focused: Helps identify recurring themes and high-yield areas for the Mains.

Holistic Coverage: Includes foundational concepts, current issues, and expert solutions.

Answer Enrichment: Elevate your Mains answers with unique insights and examples.

Structured for Clarity: Ensures quick comprehension and strong retention.

Efficient Revision: Consolidates key information for targeted, high-productivity study.



Preface

A Message to the Dedicated Mains 2025 Aspirant

Dear Aspirant,

Congratulations on conquering the first stage of the Civil Services Examination. The journey from Prelims to Mains is a test of not just knowledge, but also of strategy, endurance, and smart work. We understand that this crucial period is often marked by a sense of urgency and confusion. With a vast and dynamic syllabus to cover and limited time on the clock, you might find yourself asking: What should I read? What can I afford to skip? How do I structure my preparation to gain a genuine competitive edge?

It is with a deep understanding of these challenges that we have crafted this **Governance Value Added Material (VAM) for Mains 2025**. This document is not just another compilation of notes; it is a strategic tool designed to be your trusted companion in navigating the complexities of the **GS Paper 2 Governance section**.

The Philosophy: Precision and Relevance through PYQ Analysis

The foundation of this VAM lies in a thoughtful and objective analysis of the UPSC Mains Governance questions from 2013 to 2024. We believe that the surest way to understand the expectations of the examiner is to meticulously study the questions they have asked over the past decade. This rigorous analysis has been the guiding light in designing every aspect of this material.

At the very beginning of this document, we have provided a comprehensive macro-analysis of the PYQs. This will offer you a bird's-eye view of the entire Governance syllabus, helping you to intelligently allocate your time and energy by understanding the relative importance of various themes.

Furthermore, each theme within the document is prefaced with a micro-level PYQ analysis. This will guide you on the specific sub-topics to focus on, the nature of questions asked, and how to approach each theme to maximize your score.

How Will This Document Empower Your Mains Preparation?

Our primary goal is to equip you with the content and confidence to write high-scoring answers. This VAM is structured to achieve three key objectives:

1. **Revise Core Content Efficiently:** The material is designed to facilitate a quick and effective revision of the core concepts of public administration, accountability, and development processes that you have already studied. It ensures your foundational knowledge is sharp and ready for application.
2. **Provide High-Impact Value Addition:** Moving beyond the basics, this document provides curated, value-added content for each theme. This includes critical analysis, relevant 2nd ARC recommendations, important reports (e.g., NITI Aayog), best practices, case studies, and contemporary viewpoints that will help you enrich your answers and stand out from the competition.
3. **Cover High-Probability Current Affairs Themes:** We recognize that the Governance section is increasingly dynamic. Therefore, we have identified and comprehensively covered key themes that have been prominent in the news over the last few years. This proactive approach ensures you are well-prepared for questions that connect static concepts with current events, a high-yield area in recent trends.

Our Commitment to Your Success

This document is a culmination of dedicated effort aimed at simplifying your preparation and maximizing your output. We believe that with a clear strategy and the right resources, you can transform your hard work into success. Trust the process, utilize this material to its fullest potential, and walk into the examination hall with the confidence that you have prepared smartly.

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A Thematic Analysis of Mains Questions (2013-2024) and Strategic Insights

The Governance section of General Studies Paper 2, as specified in the official UPSC syllabus, focuses on:

- "Important Aspects of Governance, Transparency and Accountability, E-governance- applications, models, successes, limitations, and potential; Citizens Charters, Transparency & Accountability and institutional and other measures.
- Role of Civil Services in a Democracy."

To navigate this and related aspects which are crucial for a comprehensive understanding of governance in action for the Mains preparation, and to enable a deeper, more focused analysis of examination trends, we have structured these areas into **5 distinct thematic chapters**. This approach serves multiple strategic purposes:

- It allows for a **targeted study** of interlinked concepts within each theme.
- It facilitates a clearer **identification of high-priority areas** based on the patterns observed in past questions.
- It enables the delivery of **focused value-added content** tailored to the specific requirements of each theme.

All subsequent analysis, insights, and preparatory guidance for Governance will be aligned with this 5-chapter framework. Our aim is to help you master these crucial aspects of GS Paper 2 with enhanced clarity, strategic understanding, and a well-organized approach to your preparation.

Topic-wise Previous Year Questions (2013-2024) for Governance (UPSC Mains)

1. IMPORTANT ASPECTS OF GOVERNANCE *(Covers: Governance in India, People's Participation, Sevottam Model, Citizen Charter, Social Accountability, Social Audit, E-Governance, RTI, Transparency, Accountability measures like Lokpal, Whistleblower protection)*

- "Though Citizens' charters have been formulated by many public service delivery organizations, there is no corresponding improvement in the level of citizens' satisfaction and quality of services being provided. Analyse. (2013, 10 marks)"
- "'A national Lokpal, however strong it may be, cannot resolve the problems of immorality in public affairs.' Discuss. (2013, 10 marks)"
- "In the light of the Satyam Scandal (2009), discuss the changes brought in corporate governance to ensure transparency, accountability. (2015, 12.5 marks)"
- ""If amendment bill to the Whistleblowers Act, 2011 tabled in the Parliament is passed, there may be no one left to protect." Critically evaluate. (2015, 12.5 marks)"

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- ""Effectiveness of the government system at various levels and people's participation in the governance system are inter-dependent." Discuss their relationship in the context of India. (2016, 12.5 marks)"
- "In the integrity index of Transparency International, India stands very low. Discuss briefly the legal, political, economic, social and cultural factors that have caused the decline of public morality in India. (2016, 12.5 marks)"
- "E-governance is not only about utilization of the power of new technology, but also much about critical importance of the 'use value' of information. Explain. (2018, 10 marks)"
- "The Citizens' Charter is an ideal instrument of organizational transparency and accountability, but it has its own limitations. Identify the limitations and suggest measures for greater effectiveness of the Citizens' Charter. (2018, 15 marks)"
- "Implementation of Information and Communication Technology (ICT) based Projects/Programmes usually suffers in terms of certain vital factors. Identify these factors, and suggest measures for their effective implementation. (2019, 10 marks)"
- ""Recent amendments to the Right to Information Act will have profound impact on the autonomy and independence of the Information Commission". Discuss. (2020, 10 marks)"
- ""The emergence of Fourth Industrial Revolution (Digital Revolution) has initiated e-Governance as an integral part of government". Discuss. (2020, 10 marks)"
- "Has digital illiteracy, particularly in rural areas, coupled with lack of Information and Communication Technology (ICT) accessibility hindered socio-economic development? Examine with justification. (2021, 15 marks)"
- "e-governance, as a critical tool of governance, has ushered in effectiveness, transparency and accountability in governments. What inadequacies hamper the enhancement of these features? (2023, 10 marks)"
- "The Citizens' charter has been a landmark initiative in ensuring citizen-centric administration. But it is yet to reach its full potential. Identify the factors hindering the realisation of its promise and suggest measures to overcome them. (2024, 15 marks)"
- "e-governance is not just about the routine application of digital technology in service delivery process. It is as much about multifarious interactions for ensuring transparency and accountability. In this context evaluate the role of the 'Interactive Service Model' of e-governance. (2024, 15 marks)"

2. ROLE OF CIVIL SERVICES IN A DEMOCRACY *(Covers: Role, evolution, issues, reforms, Mission Karmayogi)*

- "Has the Cadre based Civil Services Organization been the cause of slow change in India? Critically examine. (2014, 12.5 marks)"
- "Has the Indian governmental system responded adequately to the demands of Liberalization, Privatization and Globalization started in 1991? What can the government do to be responsive to this important change? (2016, 12.5 marks)"
- ""Traditional bureaucratic structure and culture have hampered the process of socio-economic development in India." Comment. (2016, 12.5 marks)"
- "Initially Civil Services in India were designed to achieve the goals of neutrality and effectiveness, which seems to be lacking in the present context. Do you agree with the view that drastic reforms are required in Civil Services? Comment. (2017, 15 marks)"
- ""Institutional quality is a crucial driver of economic performance". In this context suggest reforms in Civil Service for strengthening democracy. (2020, 10 marks)"
- "The Doctrine of Democratic Governance makes it necessary that the public perception of the integrity and commitment of civil servants becomes absolutely positive. Discuss. (2024, 10 marks)"

3. DEVELOPMENT PROCESSES AND THE DEVELOPMENT INDUSTRY - THE ROLE OF NGOS, SHGS, VARIOUS GROUPS AND ASSOCIATIONS, DONORS, CHARITIES, INSTITUTIONAL AND OTHER STAKEHOLDERS *(Covers: Development Industry, CSOs, NGOs, SHGs, Co-operatives, MFIs, Donor Agencies)*

- "The legitimacy and accountability of Self Help Groups (SHGs) and their patrons, the micro-finance outfits, need systematic assessment and scrutiny for the sustained success of the concept. Discuss. (2013, 10 marks)"
- "The penetration of Self Help Groups (SHGs) in rural areas in promoting participation in development programmes is facing socio-cultural hurdles. Examine. (2014, 12.5 marks)"
- "Examine critically the recent changes in the rules governing foreign funding of NGOs under the Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Act (FCRA), 1976. (2015, 12.5 marks)"
- "The Self-Help Group (SHG) Bank Linkage Programme (SBLP), which is India's own innovation, has proved to be one of the most effective poverty alleviation and women empowerment programmes. Elucidate. (2015, 12.5 marks)"
- "How can the role of NGOs be strengthened in India for development works relating to protection of the environment? Discuss throwing light on the major constraints. (2015, 12.5 marks)"
- ""In the Indian governance system, the role of non-state actors has been only marginal." Critically examine this statement. (2016, 12.5 marks)"
- ""The emergence of the Self-Help Groups (SHGs) in contemporary times points to the slow but steady withdrawal of the State from developmental activities." Examine the role of the SHGs in developmental activities and the measures taken by the Government of India to promote the SHGs. (2017, 15 marks)"
- "The need for cooperation among various service sectors has been an inherent component of development discourse. Partnership bridges the gap among the sectors. It also sets in motion a culture of 'collaboration' and 'team spirit'. In the light of statements above examine India's development process. (2019, 15 marks)"
- ""Micro-Finance as an anti-poverty vaccine, is aimed at asset creation and income security of the rural poor in India". Evaluate the role of the Self Help Groups in achieving the twin objectives along with empowering women in rural India. (2020, 15 marks)"
- "Can the vicious cycle of gender inequality, poverty and malnutrition be broken through microfinancing of women SHGs? Explain with examples. (2021, 10 marks)"
- "Can Civil Society and Non-Governmental Organizations present an alternative model of public service delivery to benefit the common citizen? Discuss the challenges of this alternative model. (2021, 15 marks)"
- "Do you agree with the view that increasing dependence on donor agencies for development reduces the importance of community participation in the development process? Justify your answer. (2022, 15 marks)"
- "Discuss the contribution of civil society groups for women's effective and meaningful participation and representation in state legislatures in India. (2023, 15 marks)"
- "Public charitable trusts have the potential to make India's development more inclusive as they relate to certain vital public issues." Comment. (2024, 10 marks)"

4. GOVERNMENT POLICIES AND INTERVENTIONS FOR DEVELOPMENT IN VARIOUS SECTORS AND ISSUES ARISING OUT OF THEIR DESIGN AND IMPLEMENTATION *(Covers: Public Policy process, challenges, strategies for improvement)*

- "Electronic cash transfer system for the welfare schemes is an ambitious project to minimize corruption, eliminate wastage and facilitate reforms. Comment. (2013, 10 marks)"

- "The basis of providing urban amenities in rural areas (PURA) is rooted in establishing connectivity. Comment. (2013, 10 marks)"
- "Though 100 percent FDI is already allowed in non-news media like a trade publication and general entertainment channel, the Government is mulling over the proposal for increased FDI in news media for quite some time. What difference would an increase in FDI make? Critically evaluate the pros and cons. (2014, 12.5 marks)"
- "An athlete participates in Olympics for personal triumph and nation's glory; victors are showered with cash incentives by various agencies, on their return. Discuss the merit of state sponsored talent hunt and its cultivation as against the rationale of a reward mechanism as encouragement. (2014, 12.5 marks)"
- "Two parallel run schemes of the Government, viz. the Adhaar Card and NPR, one as voluntary and the other as compulsory, have led to debates at national levels and also litigations. On merits, discuss whether or not both schemes need run concurrently. Analyse the potential of the schemes to achieve developmental benefits and equitable growth. (2014, 12.5 marks)"
- ""To ensure effective implementation of policies addressing water, sanitation and hygiene needs the identification of the beneficiary segments is to be synchronized with the anticipated outcomes." Examine the statement in the context of the WASH scheme. (2017, 10 marks)"
- ""Policy contradictions among various competing sectors and stakeholders have resulted in inadequate 'protection and prevention of degradation' to environment." Comment with relevant illustrations. (2018, 10 marks)"
- "'In the context of neo-liberal paradigm of development planning, multi-level planning is expected to make operations cost-effective and remove many implementation blockages.' - Discuss. (2019, 15 marks)"
- "The Gati-Shakti Yojana needs meticulous coordination between the government and the private sector to achieve the goal of connectivity. Discuss. (2022, 10 marks)"
- "Reforming the government delivery system through the Direct Benefit Transfer Scheme is a progressive step, but it has its limitations too. Comment. (2022, 10 marks)"
- "What are the aims and objects of recently passed and enforced, The Public Examination (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024? Whether University/State Education Board examinations, too, are covered under the Act? (2024, 15 marks)"

5. PRESSURE GROUPS *(Covers: Significance, techniques, types, characteristics in India, criticism, reforms)*

- "Pressure group politics is sometimes seen as the informal face of politics. With regards to the above, assess the structure and functioning of pressure groups in India. (2013, 10 marks)"
- "Khap Panchayats have been in the news for functioning as extra-constitutional authorities, often delivering pronouncements amounting to human rights violations. Discuss critically the actions taken by the legislative, executive and the judiciary to set the things right in this regard. (2015, 12.5 marks)"
- "How do pressure groups influence Indian political process? Do you agree with this view that informal pressure groups have emerged as more powerful than formal pressure groups in recent years? (2017, 10 marks)"
- "What are the methods used by the farmers' organisations to influence the policy-makers in India and how effective are these methods? (2019, 10 marks)"
- ""Pressure groups play a vital role in influencing public policy making in India." Explain how the business associations contribute to public policies. (2021, 10 marks)"

Analysis of Governance PYQs (2013-2024) - Marks Distribution Table:

SN	Theme	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	Avg. weightage of the topic
1	**Important Aspects of Governance**	20	0	25	25	0	25	10	20	15	0	10	30	**29.27%**
2	**Role of Civil Services in a Democracy**	0	12.5	0	25	15	0	0	10	0	0	0	10	**11.79%**
3	**Development Processes and the Development Industry - Role of NGOs, SHGs, etc.**	10	12.5	37.5	12.5	15	0	15	15	25	15	15	10	**29.67%**
4	**Government Policies and Interventions for Development in various sectors and Issues (Design & Implementation)**	20	37.5	0	0	10	10	15	0	0	20	0	15	**20.73%**
5	**Pressure Groups**	10	0	12.5	0	10	0	10	0	10	0	0	0	**8.54%**
	Total Governance Marks Each Year	**60**	**62.5**	**75**	**62.5**	**50**	**35**	**50**	**45**	**50**	**35**	**25**	**65**	

Overall Analysis and Key Insights for Governance Preparation (GS Paper 2):

1. **Primacy of Non-State Actors and Participatory Development:**
   - A very significant portion of questions, as seen in **Theme 3: Development Processes and the Development Industry - Role of NGOs, SHGs, etc.** (182.5 marks, ~29.67%), focuses on the role of civil society, NGOs, SHGs, and other non-state actors. Understand their contributions, challenges, accountability, and the dynamics of their interaction with the state in development and service delivery.
   - *PYQ Example: ""The emergence of the Self-Help Groups (SHGs) in contemporary times points to the slow but steady withdrawal of the State from developmental activities." Examine the role of the SHGs in developmental activities and the measures taken by the Government of India to promote the SHGs. (2017, 15 marks)"*
2. **Core Governance Mechanisms (Transparency, Accountability, E-Gov) are Crucial:**
   - **Theme 1: Important Aspects of Governance** (180 marks, ~29.27%) is consistently tested. This includes tools like Citizen Charters, RTI, social audit, mechanisms like Lokpal, and various facets of e-governance. Focus on their effectiveness, limitations, and potential for improvement.

- *PYQ Example: "The Citizens' Charter is an ideal instrument of organizational transparency and accountability, but it has its own limitations. Identify the limitations and suggest measures for greater effectiveness of the Citizens' Charter. (2018, 15 marks)"*

3. **Policy Design, Implementation, and Outcomes are Key:**
   - **Theme 4: Government Policies and Interventions** (127.5 marks, ~20.73%) requires a critical understanding of how policies are formulated, the challenges in their implementation, and their socio-economic impact. Questions often ask for analysis of specific schemes or policy areas.
   - *PYQ Example: "Two parallel run schemes of the Government, viz. the Adhaar Card and NPR, one as voluntary and the other as compulsory, have led to debates at national levels and also litigations. On merits, discuss whether or not both schemes need run concurrently. Analyse the potential of the schemes to achieve developmental benefits and equitable growth. (2014, 12.5 marks)"*
4. **Role and Reform of Civil Services – A Consistent Focus:**
   - While carrying moderate weightage as a distinct theme (**Theme 2: Role of Civil Services in a Democracy** - 72.5 marks, ~11.79%), the role, challenges, and reforms needed in civil services are consistently probed. Link this to broader governance quality and democratic principles.
   - *PYQ Example: "Initially Civil Services in India were designed to achieve the goals of neutrality and effectiveness, which seems to be lacking in the present context. Do you agree with the view that drastic reforms are required in Civil Services? Comment. (2017, 15 marks)"*
5. **Understanding Influence Mechanisms (Pressure Groups):**
   - **Theme 5: Pressure Groups** (52.5 marks, ~8.54%) explores how various interest groups influence policy and governance. Understand their methods, types, role in democracy, and the Indian context specifically.
   - *PYQ Example: "How do pressure groups influence Indian political process? Do you agree with this view that informal pressure groups have emerged as more powerful than formal pressure groups in recent years? (2017, 10 marks)"*
6. **Interlinkages and Applied Nature:**
   - Governance questions often require interlinking concepts (e.g., e-governance for transparency, SHGs for policy implementation). They are frequently applied in nature, asking for critical evaluation, suggestions for improvement, or analysis of contemporary issues rather than just theoretical explanations.
   - *PYQ Example (linking Themes 1 & 4): "Electronic cash transfer system for the welfare schemes is an ambitious project to minimize corruption, eliminate wastage and facilitate reforms. Comment. (2013, 10 marks)"*
7. **Focus on Practical Challenges and Solutions:**
   - A recurring theme across all governance topics is the emphasis on practical challenges in implementation, effectiveness of various mechanisms, and the need for reforms or viable alternatives. Prepare to offer constructive suggestions.
   - *PYQ Example (Theme 3): "Can Civil Society and Non-Governmental Organizations present an alternative model of public service delivery to benefit the common citizen? Discuss the challenges of this alternative model. (2021, 15 marks)"*

By focusing on these core aspects, understanding the role of various actors, and critically evaluating policies and mechanisms, students can effectively prepare for the Governance portion of GS Paper 2. Staying updated with current examples and best practices in governance will be highly beneficial.

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GOVERNANCE

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IMPORTANT ASPECTS OF GOVERNANCE

Student Notes:

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Student Notes:

Previous Years Questions (2013-24)

- Though Citizens' charters have been formulated by many public service delivery organizations, there is no corresponding improvement in the level of citizens' satisfaction and quality of services being provided. Analyse. (2013, 10 marks)
- 'A national Lokpal, however strong it may be, cannot resolve the problems of immorality in public affairs.' Discuss. (2013, 10 marks)
- In the light of the Satyam Scandal (2009), discuss the changes brought in corporate governance to ensure transparency, accountability. (2015, 12.5 marks)
- "If amendment bill to the Whistleblowers Act, 2011 tabled in the Parliament is passed, there may be no one left to protect." Critically evaluate. (2015, 12.5 marks)"
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- In the integrity index of Transparency International, India stands very low. Discuss briefly the legal, political, economic, social and cultural factors that have caused the decline of public morality in India. (2016, 12.5 marks)
- E-governance is not only about utilization of the power of new technology, but also much about critical importance of the 'use value' of information. Explain. (2018, 10 marks)
- The Citizens' Charter is an ideal instrument of organizational transparency and accountability, but it has its own limitations. Identify the limitations and suggest measures for greater effectiveness of the Citizens' Charter. (2018, 15 marks)
- Implementation of Information and Communication Technology (ICT) based Projects/ Programmes usually suffers in terms of certain vital factors. Identify these factors, and suggest measures for their effective implementation. (2019, 10 marks)
- "Recent amendments to the Right to Information Act will have profound impact on the autonomy and independence of the Information Commission". Discuss. (2020, 10 marks)
- "The emergence of Fourth Industrial Revolution (Digital Revolution) has initiated e-Governance as an integral part of government". Discuss. (2020, 10 marks)
- Has digital illiteracy, particularly in rural areas, coupled with lack of Information and Communication Technology (ICT) accessibility hindered socio-economic development? Examine with justification. (2021, 15 marks)
- e-governance, as a critical tool of governance, has ushered in effectiveness, transparency and accountability in governments. What inadequacies hamper the enhancement of these features? (2023, 10 marks)
- The Citizens' charter has been a landmark initiative in ensuring citizen-centric administration. But it is yet to reach its full potential. Identify the factors hindering the realisation of its promise and suggest measures to overcome them. (2024, 15 marks)
- e-governance is not just about the routine application of digital technology in service delivery process. It is as much about multifarious interactions for ensuring transparency and accountability. In this context evaluate the role of the 'Interactive Service Model' of e-governance. (2024, 15 marks)

Previous Years Questions Analysis: (Avg. weightage: ~29.27%)

1. **Focus on Core Mechanisms of Good Governance:** This is a high-priority area. Questions consistently probe into tools for transparency and accountability like Citizen Charters, RTI, Lokpal, and the overall effectiveness of governance.
    - *PYQ Example:* The Citizens' Charter is an ideal instrument of organizational transparency and accountability, but it has its own limitations. Identify the limitations and suggest measures for greater effectiveness of the Citizens' Charter. (2018, 15 marks)
2. **E-Governance is a Recurring Theme:** Understand various aspects of e-governance including its applications, models, benefits (transparency, efficiency), limitations (digital divide,

Student Notes:

accessibility), and potential. Questions often require an analytical rather than purely descriptive approach.
   - *PYQ Example:* "e-governance, as a critical tool of governance, has ushered in effectiveness, transparency and accountability in governments. What inadequacies hamper the enhancement of these features? (2023, 10 marks)
3. **Prepare for Analytical and Evaluative Questions:** Be ready to critically evaluate the success and failures of various governance tools, discuss challenges in their implementation, and suggest practical improvements.
   - *PYQ Example:* "Recent amendments to the Right to Information Act will have profound impact on the autonomy and independence of the Information Commission". Discuss. (2020, 10 marks)

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1. Introduction

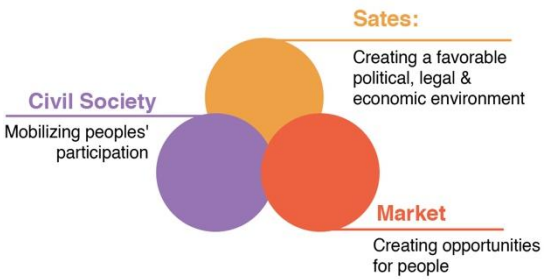
Government performs a variety of functions:

Government's Function

Self Preservation	Conflict Resolution	Socio-economic Development	Economy Regulation	Goods and Services Provision
Maintaining authority, protecting from external aggression and internal disturbances.	Strengthening of democratic practices and processes, ensuring equity to all citizens.	Enactment and effective enforcement of laws, assuring welfare of the weaker sections, bringing about desirable social change.	Adopting sound fiscal and monetary policies.	Providing essential services such as education, health, public distribution of food grains etc.

Governance builds upon these functions by encompassing the **broader processes, mechanisms, and interactions** through which these governmental responsibilities are executed.

A key distinction between government and governance is the **involvement of institutions beyond the state** in managing public affairs. While the state wields power and is the principal actor in government, governance involves the entire society in managing public affairs.



Stakeholders in governace

2. Governance

Governance is a **complex web of decision-making processes** that involves various stakeholders, including government bodies, non-governmental organizations, local leaders, and citizens. It refers to the **way** decisions, rules, and actions are **made and implemented** to effectively manage a country or organization's affairs.

2.1. Good Governance

Good governance means managing and running an organisation or country in a fair, transparent, and effective way, ensuring that the needs and interests of the people are met.

The United Nations Development Programme (UNDP), 1997, defined governance as "**the exercise of economic, political and administrative authority to manage a country's affairs at all levels**. It comprises the mechanisms, processes and institutions, through which citizens and groups articulate their interests, exercise their legal rights, meet their obligations and mediate their differences."

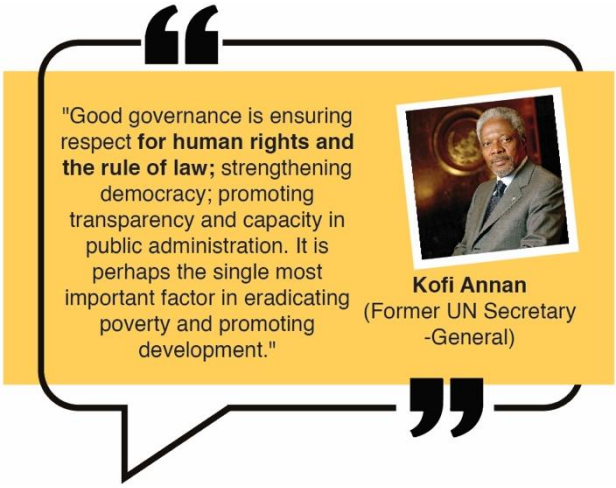
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Good governance is considered key to achieving **sustainable development and human well-being**. Empirical studies show that good governance, in contrast to democratization, has strong positive effects on measures of social trust, life satisfaction, peace and political legitimacy.

UNDP recognizes **eight core** characteristics of good governance as mentioned in the table below:

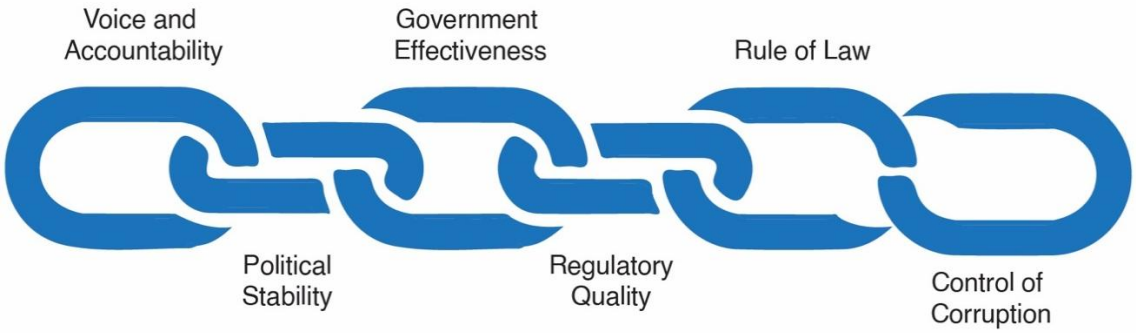
Principle	Details
Participation	Active involvement of all societal sectors in decision-making, enabled by timely information and free expression. **Examples:** Public forums; civil society engagement in policy-making.
Rule of Law	State power guided by published, widely supported social values, with laws applying equally to all, including the state itself. **Examples:** Independent judiciary; constitutional limits on executive power; laws consistent with human rights.
Transparency	Decision-making processes are open to scrutiny by society, with officials providing information and people having access to it. **Examples:** Free press; publicly accessible government procedures and data.
Responsiveness	Institutions promptly and appropriately serve all stakeholders, protecting citizens' interests and addressing discrimination. **Examples:** Citizen's charters with service timelines; mechanisms for grievance redressal.
Consensus orientation	Systems aim for the best interests of society by considering diverse viewpoints to find common ground or compromise. **Examples:** Public hearings; referendums; mediation structures for policy disputes.
Equity & Inclusiveness	All individuals, especially the vulnerable, have opportunities for well-being and are considered in policymaking. **Examples:** Progressive taxation; subsidized essential services; policies benefiting the least advantaged.
Government efficiency & effectiveness	Institutions make optimal use of resources to deliver results meeting societal needs, with quality services and minimal waste. **Examples:** Streamlined public services; professional bureaucracy; performance-based management.
Accountability	Individuals and institutions are answerable for their actions, especially concerning the public interest. **Examples:** Checks and balances within government; citizens' ability to demand explanations; codes of conduct for officials.

Note: Many sources include **"Strategic Vision"** also as a **9th principle** of Good Governance. A strategic vision refers to a **clear, long-term plan** that guides **how a government** aims to **improve** and **manage** its services and responsibilities.



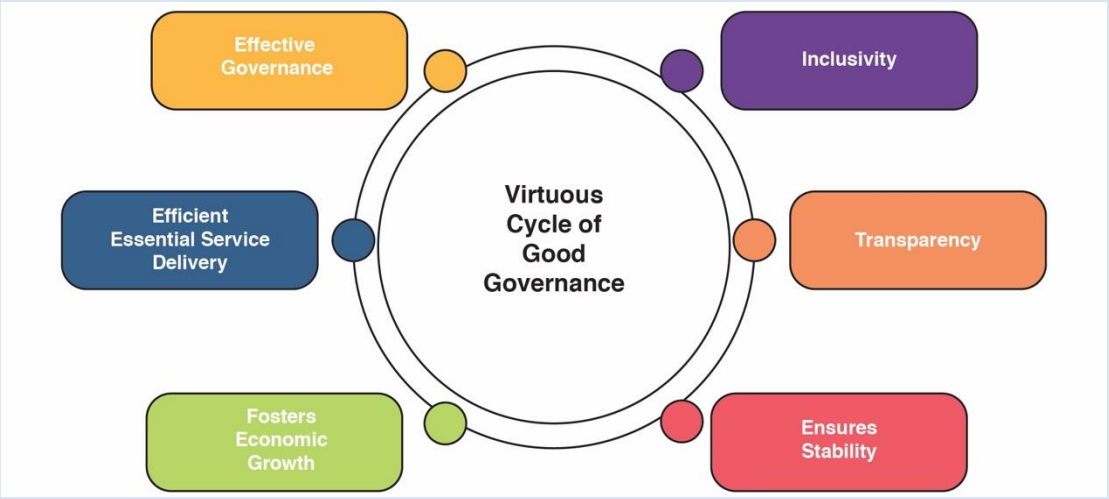
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Six Dimensions of Governance in Worldwide Governance Indicators (WB)



VIRTUOUS CYCLE OF GOOD GOVERNANCE

A "virtuous cycle of good governance" describes a positive feedback loop where **effective governance leads to increased legitimacy**, which in turn fosters **greater effectiveness and citizen trust.** This cycle promotes development, strengthens democracy, and improves the overall well-being of society.



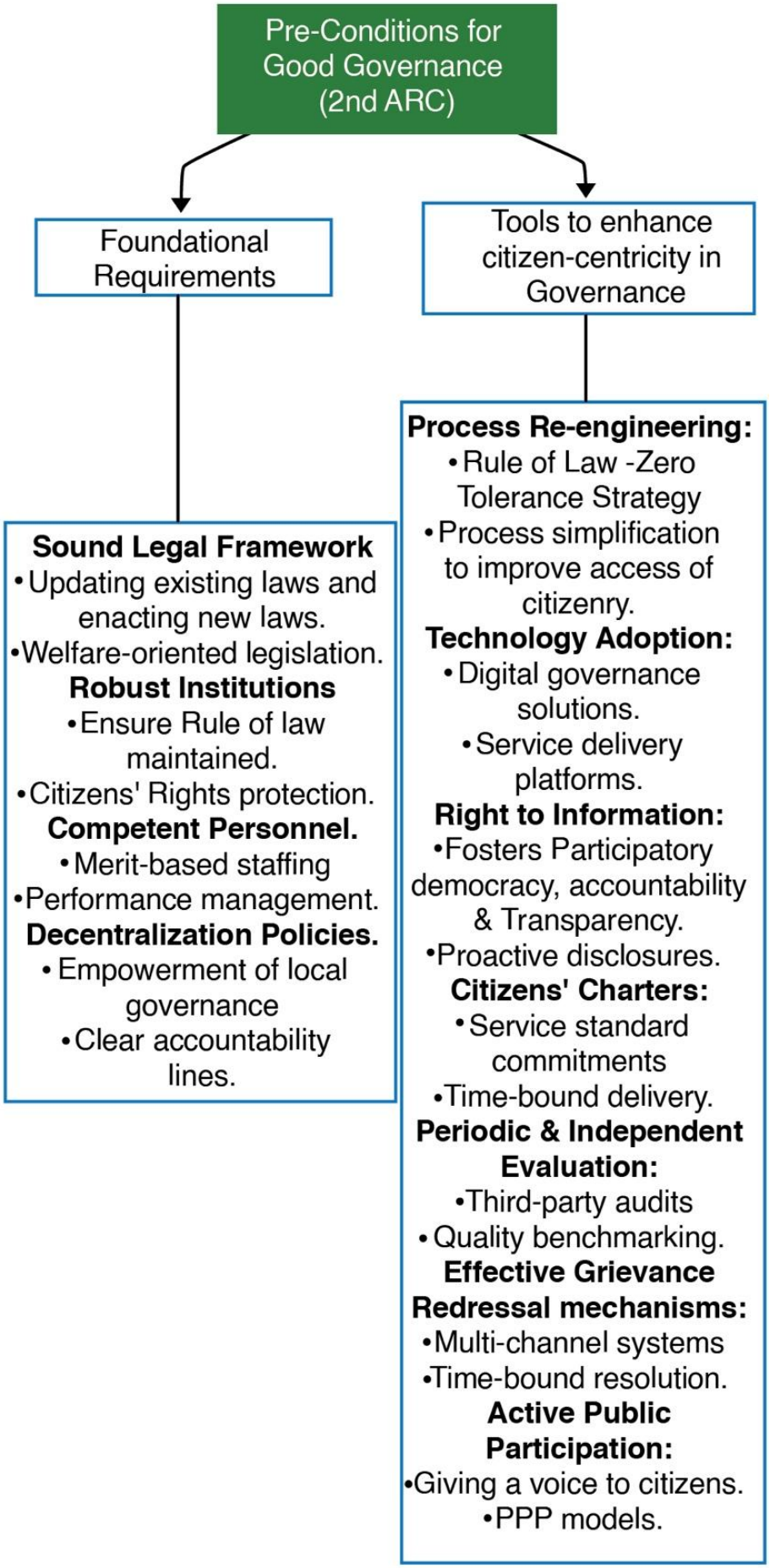
However, the conversion of effective governance into legitimacy depends on several conditions: shared values, correct attribution of effectiveness, and governance actors' capacity to transform legitimacy into impactful policies.

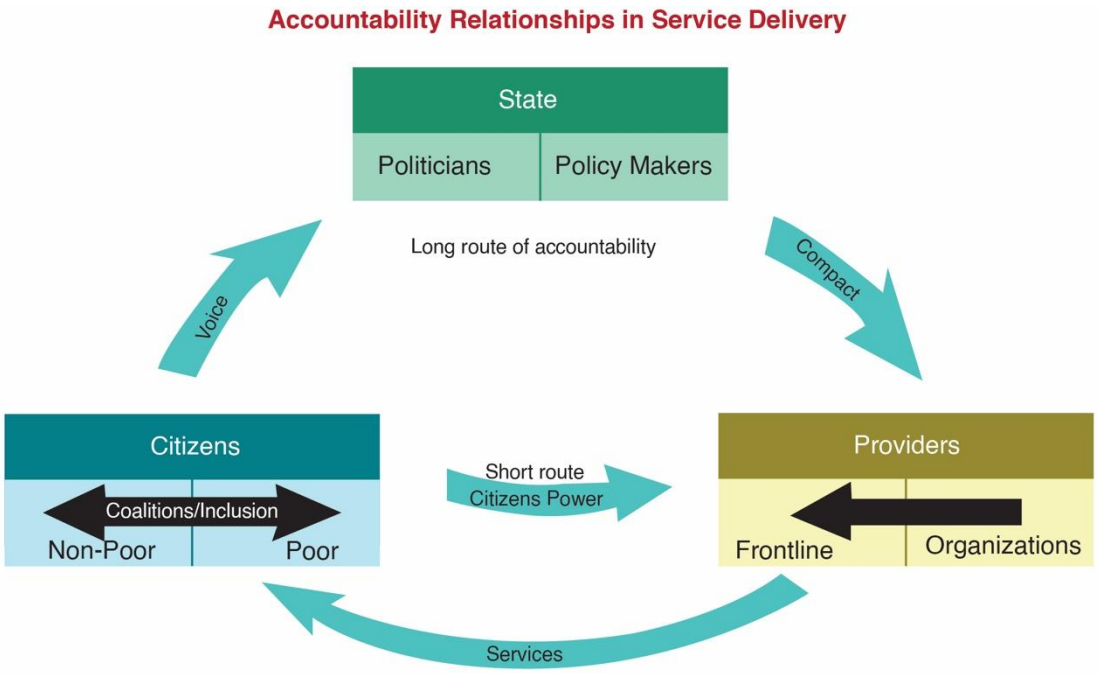
2.1.1. Pre-conditions & tools for Good Governance

The 2nd ARC identified several preconditions which must be fulfilled in order to make governance good and citizen centric.

Having established this foundational knowledge of good governance, we will proceed to have a look at governance in India, followed by a detailed discussion of few key tools of good governance, such as social audit, citizens' charter, and e-governance.

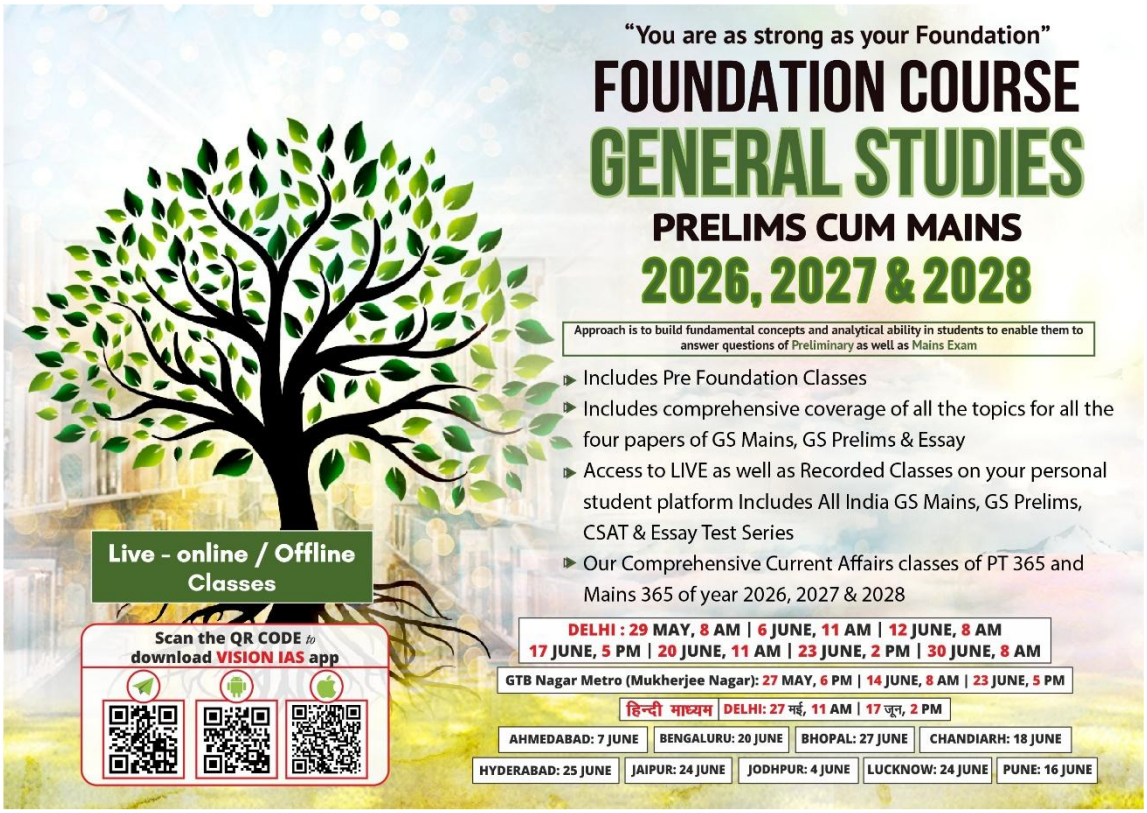
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3. Governance in India

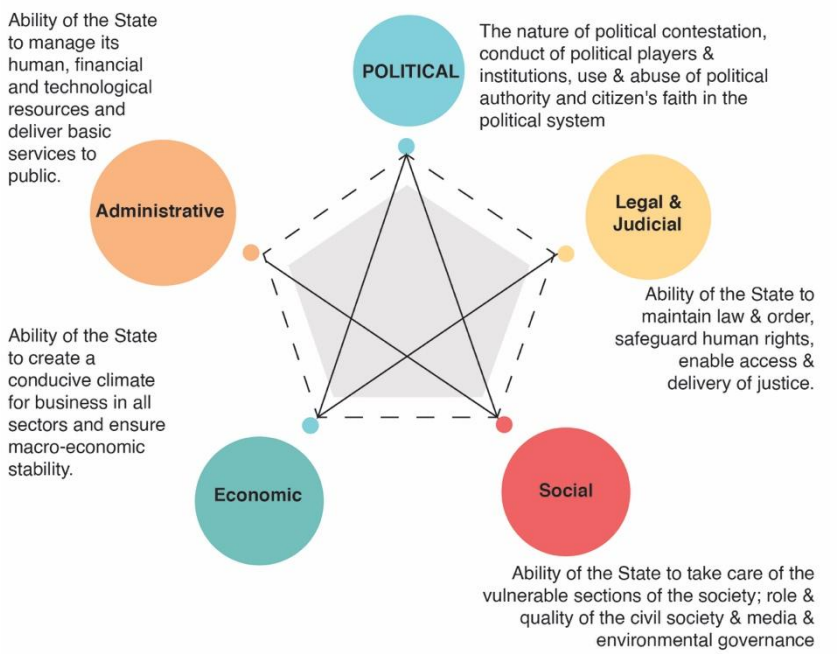
Governance in India has evolved through distinct phases, from British colonial rule focused on consolidating power to post-independence nation-building emphasizing social justice and economic development. Post 1991 economic reforms that introduced a market-driven economy, developments such as decentralization, digitization etc. have led to greater transparency, increased citizen engagement, enhanced accessibility and efficiency of governance.



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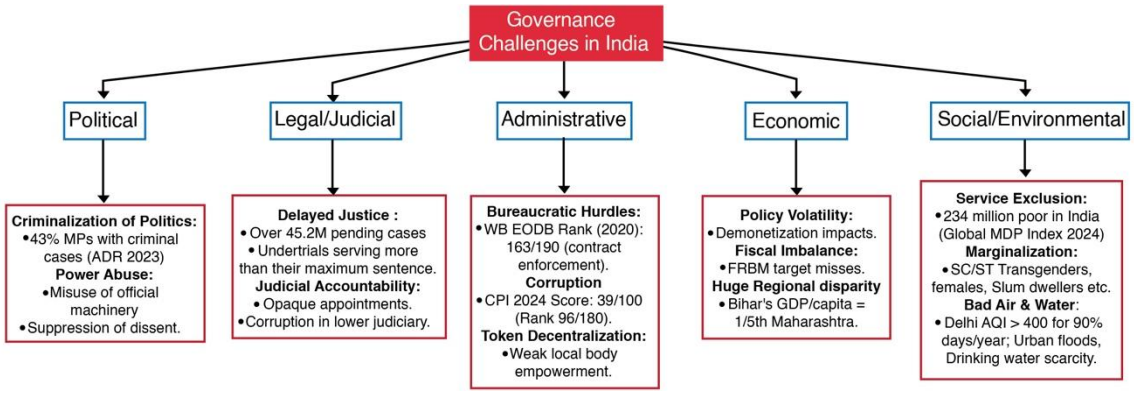
3.1. Various dimensions of governance

The Department of Administrative reforms and Public grievances (DARPG) in its report "State of Governance – A framework of assessment" has broken down governance into **five dimensions,** viz., political, legal & judicial, administrative, economic and social & environmental dimensions.



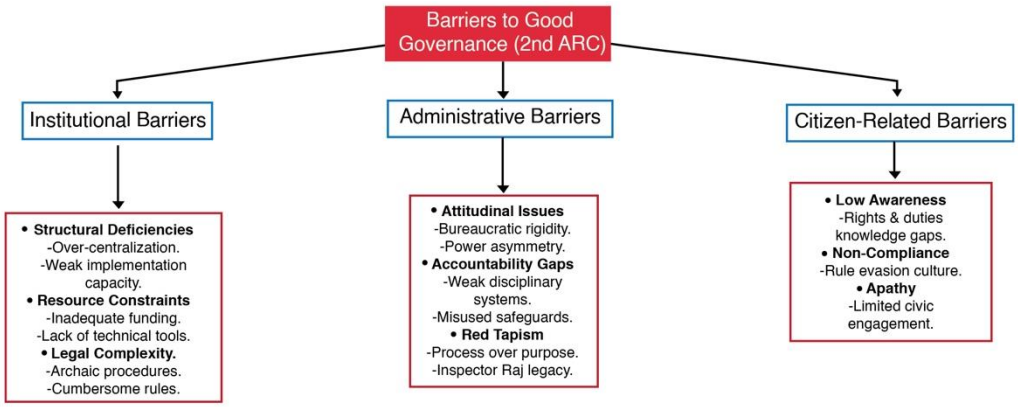
3.2. Governance issues in India

India faces a range of governance related issues in political, economic, administrative, social and legal domain. Some factors attributable to poor governance are:



3.3. Barriers to Good Governance

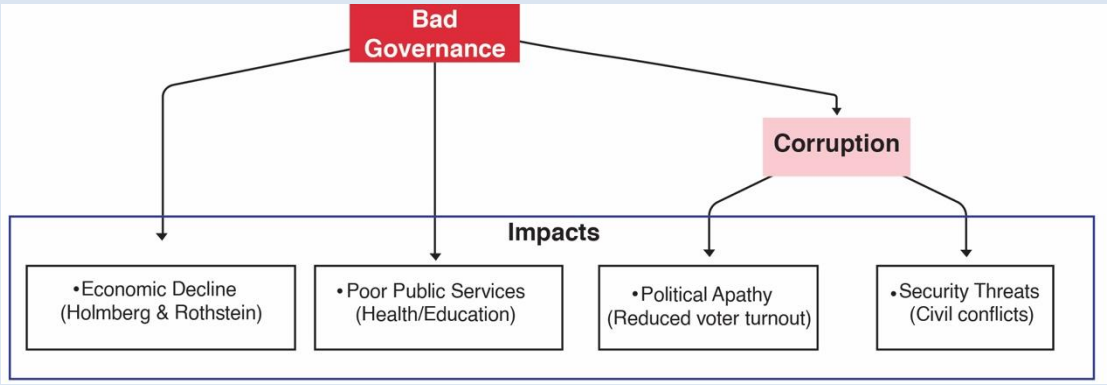
Barriers to good governance arise from the attitudes and actions of some government officials, weaknesses in institutional structures, and citizen-related factors. Although laws may be well-designed, poor implementation and insufficient institutional capacity often hinder their effective enforcement.



Student Notes:

Ethics in Governance

Ethics is a set of standards that society places on itself and which helps guide behaviors, choices and actions. Corruption and the abuse of office is an important manifestation of the failure of ethics. Corruption and good governance have a **two-way causal relationship** with each other and feed off each other in a **vicious circle**.



3.4. Good Governance initiatives in India

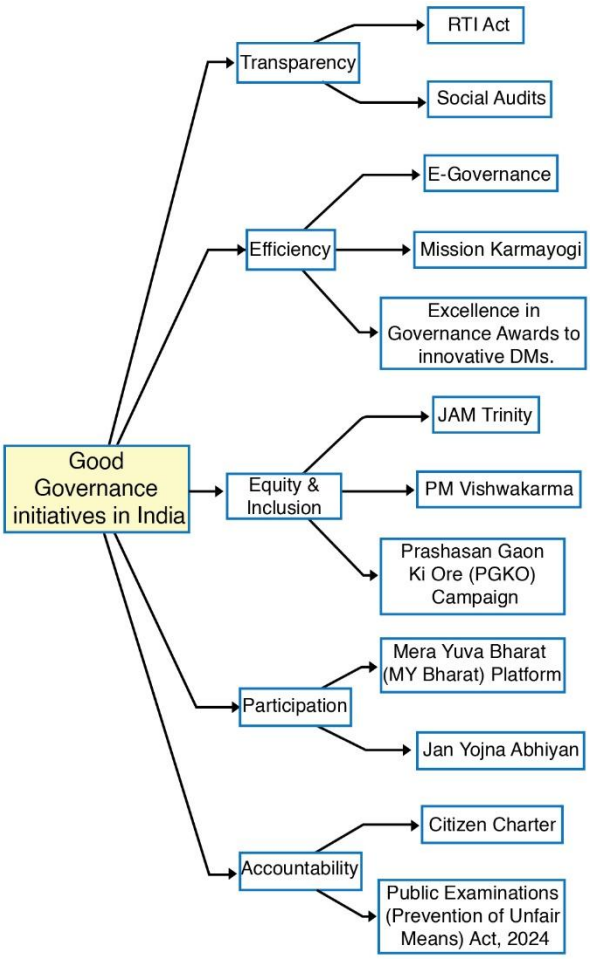
Must use 'last-mile', 'good governance' approach to reach out to people in remotest corners, minorities: PM

Good governance is an **ongoing process** aiming to serve the people better—this commitment to service underpins the **core philosophy of a democratic government.** To foster good governance, GoI has launched various initiatives:

Minimum Government, Maximum Governance (MGMG): Does shrinking government automatically leads to better governance?

- MGMG is a slogan that suggests limiting government size while enhancing its efficiency and accountability. It focuses on streamlined government structure that minimizes bureaucratic red tape.
- While developed countries like Scandinavia have large governments and strong economies, Asian nations generally have smaller governments. India's government size has grown modestly compared to its GDP.

In developing countries, the government plays an important role in providing public services and infrastructure. Focus should be on smart governance, strategic public expenditure, and placing the right people in positions.



Student Notes:

4. Important tools to implement Good Governance (in detail)

The implementation of good governance can be achieved through various tools and mechanisms, including people's participation, the Right to Information (RTI), the Sevottam model, Citizen Charters, and e-governance.

Letting Go is Part of Good Governance

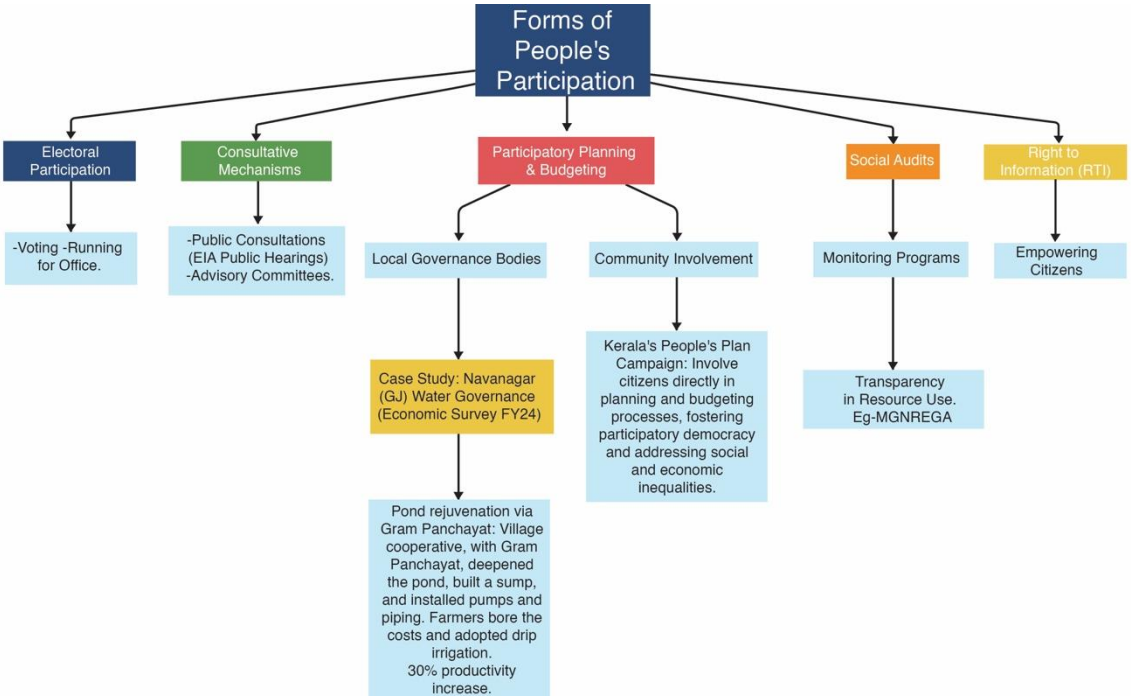
The **Economic Survey 2023-24** emphasizes that letting go is crucial for good governance. As the world faces potential **conflicts and challenges**, the **Indian state** must **focus on critical areas** by reducing its grip on **non-essential sectors**.

Licensing, **inspection**, and **compliance** requirements continue to **burden businesses**, particularly small and medium enterprises. This excessive regulation stifles their growth and **holds the country back.**

4.1. Enhancing People's Participation

People's participation is a vital component of good governance, reflecting the principle that governance **should be for the people, by the people, and with the people**.

- **Active involvement** of citizens in the **decision-making process** ensures that governance is not only **representative** but also **responsive** to the needs and aspirations of the community.
- This participatory approach enhances the legitimacy, accountability, and effectiveness of governance.



Benefits of People's Participation

1. **Enhanced Legitimacy:**
   - When citizens are actively involved in the governance process, decisions made are more likely to be **accepted and respected**, thereby enhancing the legitimacy of the government.
2. **Improved Accountability:**
   - Participation increases **transparency** and **accountability** as citizens can hold their representatives and public officials accountable for their actions and decisions.
3. **Better Decision-Making:**
   - Incorporating diverse perspectives leads to more comprehensive and informed decision-making, ensuring that policies and programs are more effective and inclusive.

Student Notes:

4. **Empowerment:**
   - Participation empowers citizens by giving them a voice in governance and enabling them to influence decisions that affect their lives.
   - This fosters a sense of ownership and responsibility towards community development.
5. **Social Cohesion:**
   - Active participation promotes social cohesion by bringing together diverse groups to work towards common goals, fostering a sense of unity and collective effort.

Challenges to People's Participation

1. **Lack of Awareness:**
   - Many citizens are unaware of their rights and the mechanisms available for participation, which limits their engagement in the governance process.
2. **Socio-Economic Barriers:**
   - Socio-economic disparities can hinder participation, as marginalized and disadvantaged groups may lack the resources and opportunities to engage effectively.
3. **Institutional Constraints:**
   - Bureaucratic red tape, lack of responsiveness, and inadequate infrastructure can pose significant barriers to effective citizen participation.
4. **Political Will:**
   - Genuine participation requires political will and commitment from those in power to create and maintain inclusive and participatory governance mechanisms.

SEVEN SINS OF PEOPLE'S PARTICIPATION

Andrea Cornwall's "Seven Sins of Citizen Participation" highlight pitfalls where engagement is superficial, not genuine. These manifest across various development and governance initiatives:

1. **Cosmetic Labeling:** Participation as an illusion.
   - **Example:** Environmental Public Hearings (EPHs) for projects, often function as mere procedural formalities, with public concerns frequently ignored in final decisions.
2. **Paternalism:** Assuming "We Know Best."
   - **Example:** Top-down development schemes like some **urban slum redevelopment projects** in cities like Mumbai or Delhi **impose solutions, disregarding community** needs and traditional wisdom, leading to poor adoption.
3. **Politicization:** Participation as a political tool.
   - **Example:** The functioning of **Gram Sabhas** can be **manipulated by local power politics**, influencing outcomes and resource allocation to favor dominant groups, as sometimes observed in social audits under MGNREGA.
4. **Poor Representation:** Marginalizing voices.
   - **Example:** Despite constitutional reservations, **women and marginalized groups** in Panchayati Raj Institutions often struggle to exert influence, a phenomenon sometimes termed **"Sarpanch Pati**."
5. **Instrumentalization:** Participation as a means to an end.
   - **Example:** Some **NGOs** organize community **consultations primarily to meet funding checklist** requirements for watershed development projects, rather than for genuine input.
6. **Fragmentation:** Uncoordinated efforts, diluted impact.
   - **Example:** In urban areas, multiple government departments (e.g., for water and sanitation) often initiate **separate "participatory" consultations without adequate coordination**, leading to confusion and ineffective outcomes.
7. **Overloading:** Participation fatigue and disengagement.
   - **Example: ASHA workers** face immense workloads and numerous responsibilities across health programs, leading to burnout and hindering their capacity for sustained community engagement.

Addressing these sins requires a fundamental shift towards genuine inclusivity, transparency, and empowering citizens as active agents in their own development and governance.

People's participation is indispensable for achieving good governance. It ensures that governance is not only representative but also responsive, transparent, and accountable. A participatory approach to governance strengthens democracy and promotes sustainable development.

4.2. Sevottam Model

The **Sevottam** model has been developed with objective of improving the quality of public service delivery in the country. It is a combination of two words **Seva (service)** and **Uttam (excellence).**

It **provides a framework** for organizations to assess and improve the quality-of-service delivery to citizens. The model was suggested by **2nd ARC** in its **12th report Citizen Centric** administration.

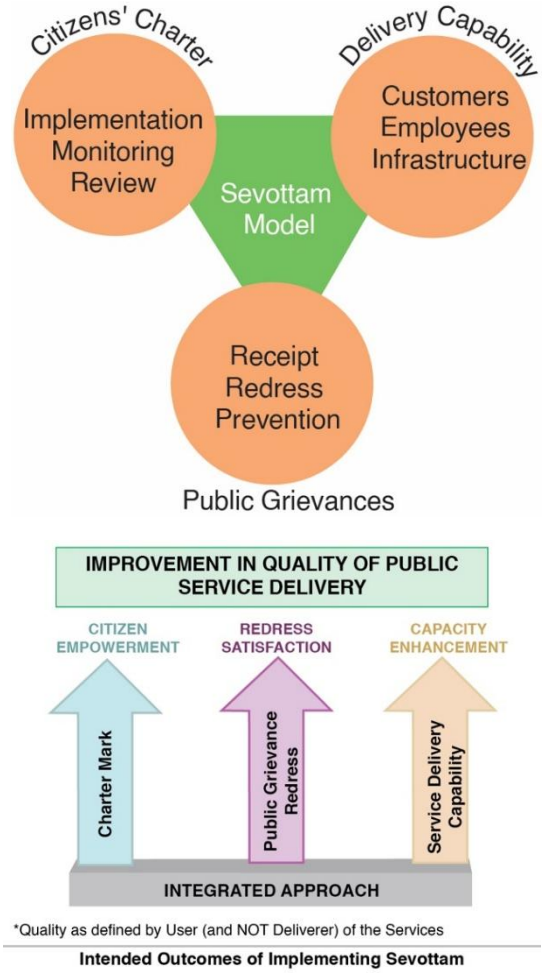
The model has three modules:

- **Citizen Charter**
- **Public Grievance Redress mechanism**
- **Service Delivery Capability**

Organizations adopting Sevottam model for service delivery need to comply with seven steps:

1. **Define** services and identify clients.
2. **Set** standards and norms for each service.
3. **Develop** capability to meet the set standards.
4. **Perform** to achieve the standards.
5. **Monitor** performance against the set standards.
6. **Evaluate** impact through an independent mechanism.
7. **Continuous** improvement based on monitoring and evaluation

Implementation of Sevottam framework in the government departments was started in 2009.



Significance of the Model

- It guides them through systematic initiatives for sustainable improvements in service delivery.
- The framework enables implementing organizations to undertake **a systematic, credible and authenticated self-assessment (or 'gap analysis') for citizen-centric service delivery**.
- Using this analysis, practical solutions are gradually and systematically incorporated into the organization's day-to-day routine thereby ensuring sustainable results.

Some success stories of Sevottam framework

Department of Post (India Post)

- India Post, with its vast network of post offices, embraced Sevottam.
- They improved services like speed post, parcel delivery, and savings accounts.

Indian Railways:

- The lifeline of India, Indian Railways, implemented Sevottam across various services—ticket booking, cleanliness, and passenger amenities.

Passport Offices:

- Sevottam transformed passport services.
- Citizens now encounter streamlined processes, faster issuance, and improved customer support.

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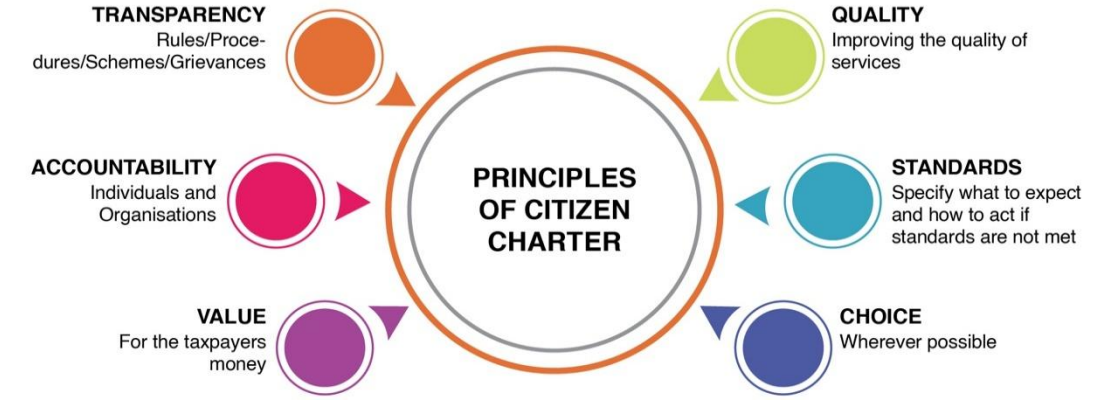
4.2.1. Citizen Charter

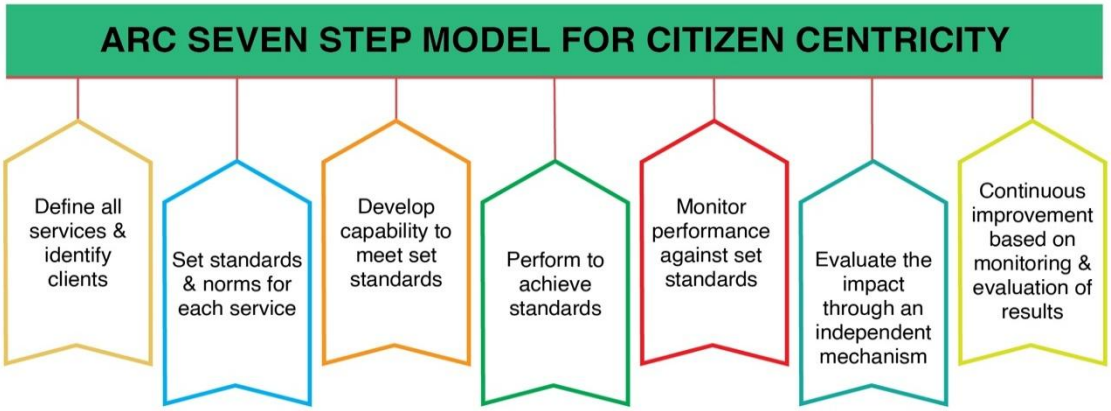
A Citizens' Charter is basically a **set of commitments** made by an organization regarding the standards of service which it delivers (**2nd ARC**).

It is a public **statement** that **defines the entitlements of citizens to a specific service**, the standards of the service, the conditions to be met by users, and the remedies available to the latter in case of non-compliance of standards.

Principles of Citizen Charter

Originally, **six principles** of the Citizens Charter movement are framed. (Refer infographic)





Significance of Citizen Charter

It is a **tool to achieve good governance**:

- It **provides services to the people** in a time bound manner, redressing their grievances and improving their lives.
- It enshrines the **trust between the service** provider and its users and empowers the citizen in relation to public service delivery.

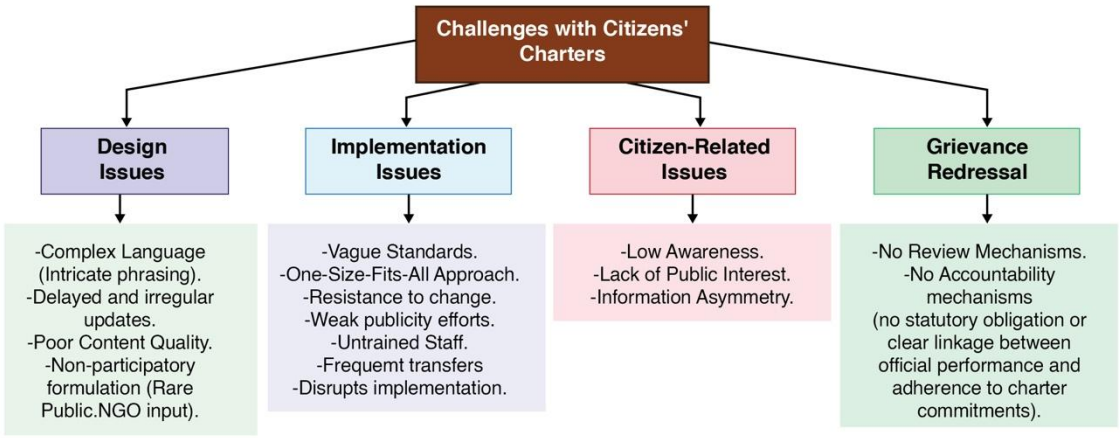


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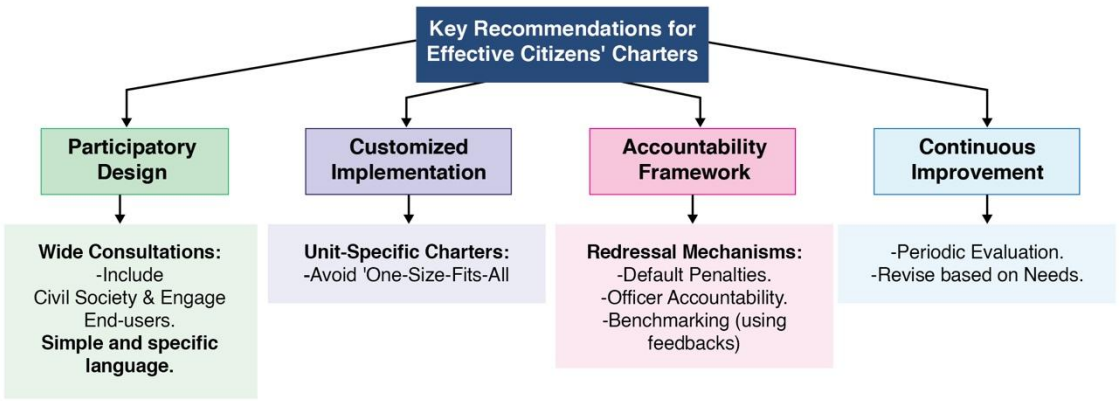
Citizen Charter in India

- The concept was first articulated and implemented in the **United Kingdom in 1991. India** adopted citizen's charter in **1997**.
  - The **Department of Administrative Reforms and Public Grievances (DARPG)** initiated the task of coordinating, formulating and operationalising Citizen's Charters.
  - The **Right of Citizens for Time Bound Delivery of Goods and Services and Redressal of their Grievances Bill, 2011 (Citizens Charter**) seeks to create a mechanism to ensure timely delivery of goods and services to citizens. However, it lapsed due to the dissolution of the Lok Sabha in 2014.

Challenges in implementing Citizens Charter



Strengthening Citizen Charters



4.3. Social Accountability

Social accountability refers to a **wide range of actions and mechanisms** that the citizens, communities, independent media and civil society organizations can use to **hold public officials accountable.**

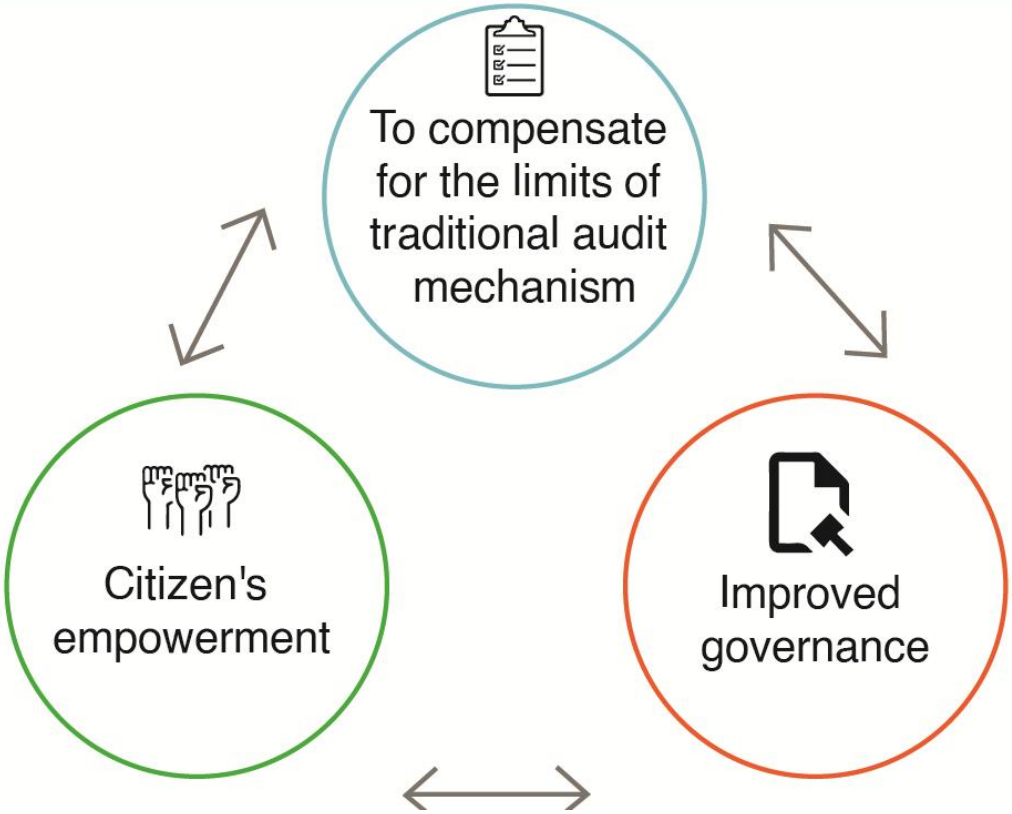
Open Government

OECD defines open government as

- the **transparency** of government actions,
- the **accessibility** of government services and information, and
- the **responsiveness** of government to new ideas, demands and needs.

Student Notes:

NEED FOR SOCIAL ACCOUNTABILITY



Common tools of Social Accountability at various stages of service delivery involves the following:

Tool	Description	Already in practice in
Participatory budgeting	A process through which citizens participate directly in budget formulation, decision- making, and monitoring of budget execution.	**Gujarat**
Participatory Planning	**Beneficiaries of government programs are involved in the planning and design** of programme components in order to determine local problems, priorities and solutions.	**Kerala**
Public expenditure tracking	Involve citizen groups in **tracing the flow of public resources.** It can **help to detect bottlenecks, inefficiencies, or corruption.**	**Delhi, Rajasthan**
Citizen Report Card	**Participatory surveys that provide quantitative feedback to service providers** on the satisfaction levels amongst citizens on the quality of public services in a particular geographical area.	**Bangalore, Maharashtra**
Community Scorecard	A community-based **monitoring tool that assesses services, projects, and government performance** by analysing qualitative data obtained through focus group discussions with the community.	**Maharashtra, Andhra Pradesh**
Social audit/ Social Accounting	A **government program is audited with the active participation of the intended beneficiaries** of the program. Process culminates with the organization of public hearings where the findings are discussed and discrepancies are exposed in the presence of service providers, officials and beneficiaries.	

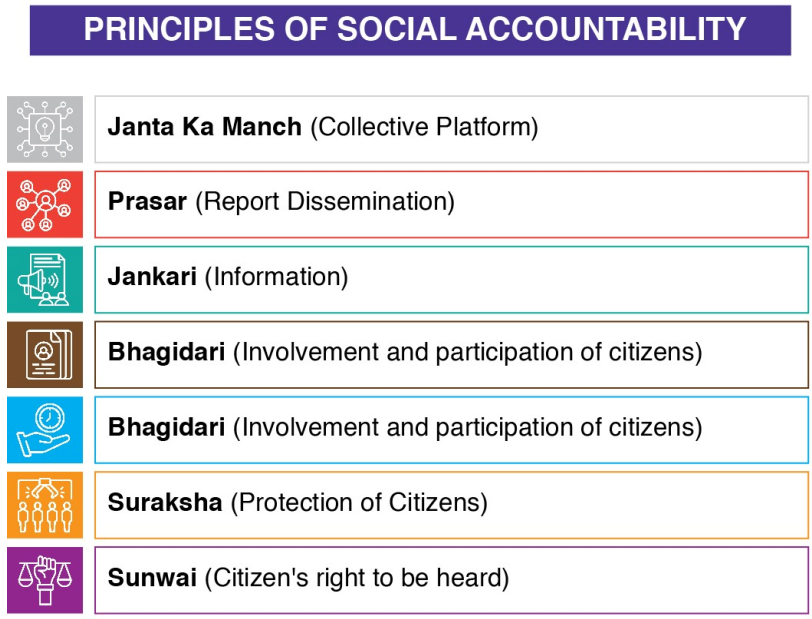
Challenges and Vulnerabilities Inherent to Social Accountability Efforts

- **Lack of Transparency:** Withholding crucial information or providing inadequate information, such as budget documents, necessary for social accountability initiatives.
- **Complacency on part of citizens:** Citizens not speaking up against corruption and refusing to cooperate in social accountability efforts.
- **Disruption by powerful vested interests:** Threats and coercion result in communities becoming hesitant to participate in social accountability initiatives.
- **Lack of effective grievance redressal:** Strict and unfailing follow-up action on social accountability findings is lacking.

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Key Elements of Effective Social Accountability

- **Effective Decentralization:** Empower local governments, such as panchayats and municipalities, by providing them with the necessary resources and authority to implement schemes and programs based on the **"principle of subsidiarity."**
- **Information and Awareness:** Enhance Section 4 of the RTI Act to promote the proactive disclosure of relevant and accurate information.
- **Capacity Building and Community Mobilization:** Regularly train officials and citizens, and involve local NGOs, SHGs, and community groups to increase awareness and encourage participation in schemes.
- **Mandatory Social Accountability:** Require social audits in programs with significant public impact to ensure accountability.





Student Notes:

3.3.1. Social Audit

Social audit is a process where a **public agency shares details of resources** used in development initiatives **with the public**, often through public platforms. This process allows **end users to scrutinize** the effectiveness of developmental programs.

Social audit serves as an **instrument** for the measurement of **social accountability** of an organization.

Supply-side Accountability and Demand-side Accountability:

Supply-side Accountability: Refers to mechanisms and institutions **within the government** that uphold accountability through traditional, legal, and hierarchical structures.

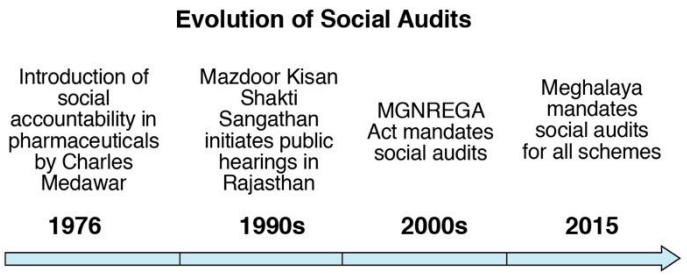
Demand-side Accountability: Emphasises the role of **citizens and external bodies** in ensuring accountability, often through more modern, participatory, and horizontal approaches.

Supply-side Accountability	Demand-side Accountability
Accountability upheld from Government	Accountability with People's participation
Traditional Method	Modern method
Top-Down	Bottom-Up
Internal	External
Legal	Diagonal
Hierarchical	Horizontal
Example: Legislature, CAG, CIC, CVC, SC	Example: Social Audit, RTI, Citizens Charter

3.3.1.1. Significance of Social Audit

Social audits empower citizens to actively monitor programs, ensuring transparency and better outcomes. Below are the key benefits of social audits:

1. **Boosts Accountability and Transparency**
   - Social audits enhance **both supply-side and demand-side accountability** by scrutinizing fund utilization and program implementation. Public hearings (*jan sunwais*) and community-led reviews expose discrepancies, ensuring corrective action. For instance:
   - In **Rajasthan**, social audits under NREGA uncovered fraud in wage payments and labor records, leading to fund recovery and stricter oversight.
   - By making government data publicly accessible, social audits allow collective interrogation, reducing misuse of resources.



2. **Strengthens Governance and Community Engagement**
   - While **supply-side accountability** relies on administrative checks, social audits strengthen **demand-side accountability** by empowering local communities through platforms like **Gram Sabhas**. Marginalized groups, especially women, gain a voice in monitoring entitlements and demanding transparency.
3. **Enhances Program Design and Delivery**
   - Social audits bridge gaps between policy goals and ground realities, providing feedback to improve **supply-side systems**. For example:
   - In **Odisha**, audits across 240 Gram Panchayats improved nutrition service delivery by identifying implementation flaws.
   - States like **Andhra Pradesh and Telangana** scaled up audits, leading to better NREGA performance and expanded oversight in food security and juvenile justice.
4. **Empowers Marginalized Groups**
   - By involving disadvantaged communities in monitoring, social audits ensure **supply-side accountability** is complemented by grassroots participation. Women and marginalized groups can challenge inefficiencies, ensuring equitable service delivery.

Student Notes:

5. **Delivers Tangible Improvements**
   Observable outcomes include:
   - **Better public service delivery** (e.g., schools opening on time, improved teacher attendance).
   - **Efficient grievance redressal** through structured feedback mechanisms.
   - **Policy reforms** aligning programs with community needs, strengthening **both supply and demand-side accountability**.

CASE STUDY (2021)

Open Government in Education: Learning from social audits in India

This study transformed the social audit format for MGNREGA into a social audit of education, and drew the following stakeholder perspectives on the effectiveness of social audits:

Stakeholders' Perspective on Social Audits

- **Community Members:**
  - In Rajasthan, communities recalled positive impacts on teacher punctuality and school timings.
  - In Delhi, initial community distrust was noted due to a lack of prior mobilization and skepticism about community-based organizations' effectiveness.
- **Government School Teachers:**
  - Experienced increased accountability, leading to more punctual school operations.
  - Faced interference from vested interests, including local Panchayat officials, who often sided with teachers.
- **Education Officials:**
  - Often hesitated to share information and data, providing delayed or incomplete responses, even to RTI requests.
  - Frontline auditors faced obstacles due to uneven responses from state governments to audit findings (e.g., in Telangana).
- **Social Audit Team (Activists/Facilitators):**
  - Found the process challenging due to resistance but gained respect.
  - Played a crucial role in accessing and translating government information and documenting user testimonies.

The study concluded that **building bridges between stakeholders and state actors**, and working on the **basis of collaboration** rather than confrontation, play an important role in making social audits work.

3.3.1.2. Limitations of Social Audit

Despite their importance, social audits come with several limitations that can hinder their comprehensive application and effectiveness:

- **Localized Scope:** Social audits are **highly localized**, focusing only on **selected aspects** and not broadly applicable across different regions or the entire population.
  - It's findings are **context-specific** and not universally applicable, as they reflect unique local conditions and stakeholder feedback specific to the area audited.
- **Inconsistency and Ad Hoc Nature:** These audits often occur sporadically and **lack a formal, continuous monitoring process.**
- **Not suitable for all programs:** Each program faces unique challenges, and social audits may not always be effective. For instance, adult literacy programs for migrants need migration data, which might not be covered in a typical social audit.

- **Lack of Trained Auditors:** There is a notable shortage of professionals trained specifically to conduct effective social audits as audit require a distinct set of skills and knowledge.
- **Inaction on Audit Findings:** Often, there is no subsequent action taken on the findings and recommendations of social audits, limiting their effectiveness and impact.

Improving auditor **training**, broadening the audits' **scope**, and ensuring actions are taken based on **findings** are vital for enhancing their effectiveness. These improvements can make social audits stronger tools for community development and governance.

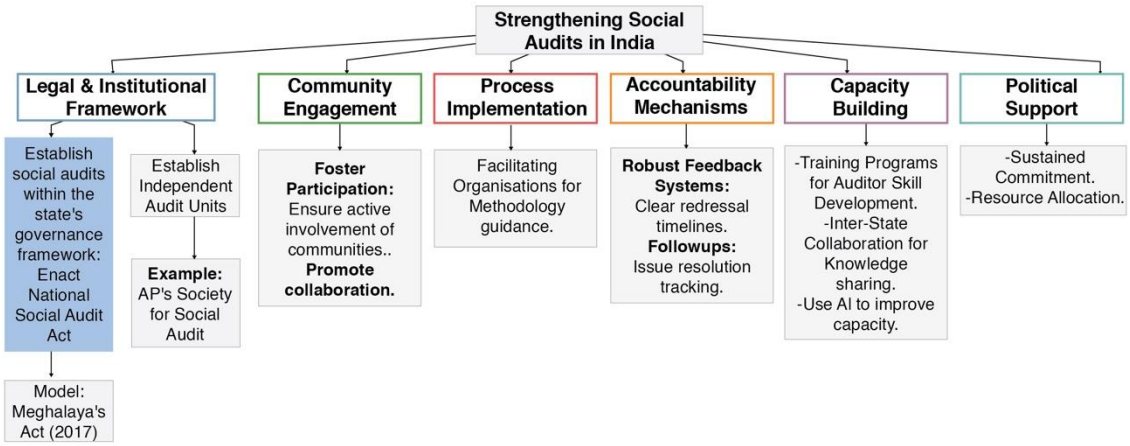
Social Audits supplementing CAG Audits (CAG+1)

Social audits can significantly enhance CAG audits by providing an **outcome orientation** that broadens the scope—**referred to as CAG+1—**focusing on performance outputs, and supplying vital data, reports, and findings.

- The CAG has directed **all state Auditors General (AGs) to support the institutionalization of social audits**.
- CAG has emphasized the importance of AGs assisting in strengthening social audits by providing inputs, advising social audit teams in gram sabhas, panchayats, and NGOs on report making, data collection, and ensuring policy implementation.
- Proposed **dedicated portal** at state level to manage all social audits, making it accessible to the CAG.

This integrated approach, called CAG+1, is expected to significantly strengthen the auditing system.

3.3.1.3. Recommendations for strengthening Social Audit in India



These comprehensive steps aim to revitalize the social audit mechanism in India, ensuring it not only checks compliance but also drives meaningful improvements in governance and public trust.

4.4. E-Governance

What is E-governance?

According to **the World Bank**, "*E-Governance refers to the use by government agencies of* ***information technologies (such as Wide Area Networks, the Internet, and mobile***

E- Governance is about bringing **SMART Governance** viz:

- **S - Simple**: Simplification of rules and procedures of Government making it user-friendly.
- **M-Moral**: Infusing ethics and morals into officers again since anti-corruption and vigilance agencies are improving.
- **A- Accountable**: ICT helps set standards of performance and efficiently measures it.
- **R- Responsive**: Efficient service delivery and government that is in tune with the people.
- **T - Transparent**: Information confined to secrecy is out in the public domain bringing equity and rule of law in public agencies.

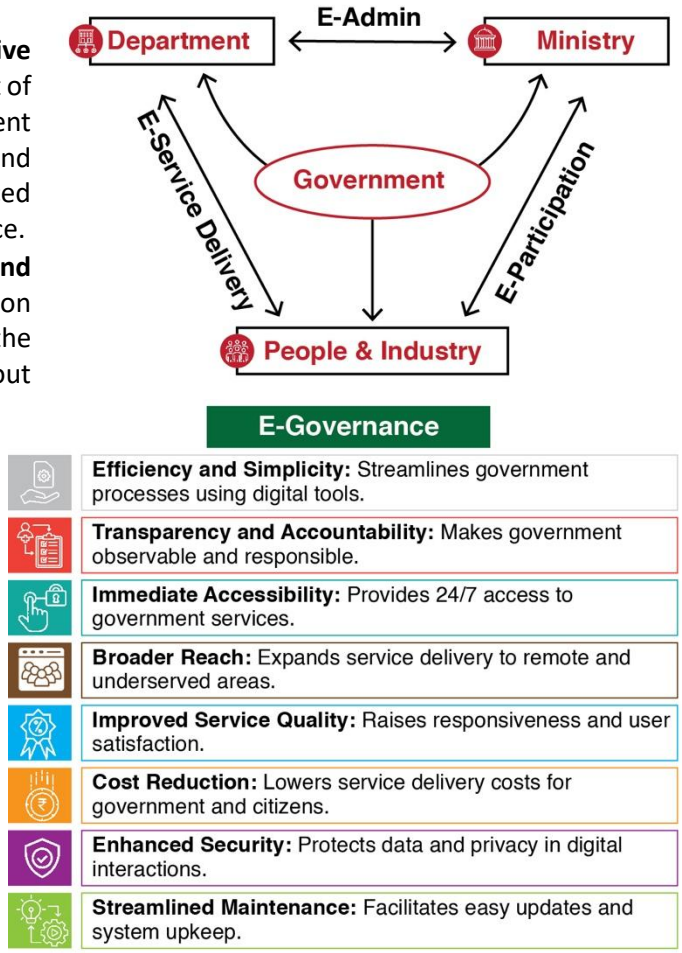
Student Notes:

computing) *that have the ability to transform relations with citizens, businesses, and other arms of government".*

The adoption of technology in governance facilitates more effective communication, informed decision-making and streamlined workflows. The **framework** of **e-governance** is often described through the **"5C"** model, as identified by **Miglani in 2001**, which includes:

Component	Description
Computer	Encompasses all necessary hardware and software for government functions.
Connectivity	Relates to systems that handle data transmission, including bandwidth and other information carriers.
Content	Refers to the information exchanged within the system among users.
Consumer	Includes all individuals and their proxies who access and utilize this content.
Confidence Building	Consists of measures aimed at enhancing citizen trust in the e-governance system, encouraging their engagement in e-transformation.

Potential of e-governance



- **Fast, Convenient and Cost-Effective Service Delivery**: With the advent of e-Service delivery, the government can provide information and services at lesser costs, in reduced time and with greater convenience.
- **Transparency, Accountability and Reduced Corruption:** Dissemination of information improves the awareness levels of citizens about their rights and powers. It helps to reduce the discretionary powers of government officials and curtail corruption.
- **Expanded Reach of Governance**: Expansion of telephone network, spread of internet and strengthening of other communications infrastructure facilitated delivery of a number of public services.
- **Empowering people through information:** Increased accessibility to information has empowered the citizens and has enhanced their participation.
- **Improve interface with Business and Industry:** Industrial development in India has been hampered in the past with complex procedures and bureaucratic delays. E-governance aims to expedite the various processes important for industrial development.

Ease of Governance

- As per this idea, the main aim of e-governance should be **'ease of governance'** leading to **'ease of living'** of people. This is essential for the emergence of a 'New India'.
- Ease of Governance essentially means Ease of access to governance where public policies are people centric with empathetic and responsive government mechanisms.

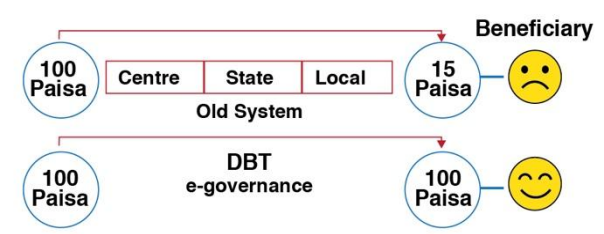
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E-governance and JAM Trinity

The JAM Trinity, comprising **Jan Dhan, Aadhaar, and Mobile connectivity**, has revolutionized governance in India. Jan Dhan facilitates financial inclusion and direct benefits transfer, reducing leakages. **Aadhaar** provides unique IDs to authenticate identities and ensure benefits reach the right people. Mobile connectivity enables digital transactions and improves service delivery.

"For every rupee targeted towards welfare and poverty alleviation only a fraction, 15 paise, reached the intended beneficiary." Rajiv Gandhi (1980s).

"The amount that reaches the poor has reached 50%." Montek Singh Ahluwalia (2007).



This implementation of JAM trinity enhances efficiency and transparency. **Direct Benefits Transfer (DBT)** through Jan Dhan accounts reduces corruption and ensures timely subsidies. Aadhaar minimizes fraud, while mobile connectivity streamlines processes for easier access to services.

4.4.1. Models of e-governance

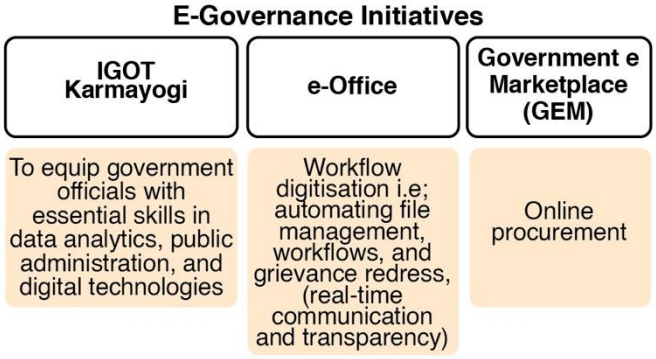
There are various models for e-governance, each with distinct strength and usefulness.

1. **Broadcasting Model**
   - **Key Features**: One-way dissemination of information from government to citizens. It's a **unidirectional communication** model.
   - **Usefulness**: Ideal for **general public information** (e.g., policy updates, public service announcements). E.g., Use in emergency alerts or public announcements where citizen feedback is unnecessary.
   - **Examples**: Government websites, TV channels like Doordarshan, social media announcements.
   - **Limitations**: **No feedback loop**— citizens cannot interact.
2. **Critical Flow Model**
   - **Key Features**: **Targeted communication** to specific groups with **priority-based** distribution. The information is relevant and customized for the audience.
   - **Usefulness**: Useful when communicating critical, timely data to specific **stakeholder groups** (e.g., healthcare professionals, pensioners, businesses).
   - **Examples**: Emergency alerts, pension scheme updates, medical insurance details for doctors.
   - **Advantage**: **Focused and prioritized distribution** of information.
3. **Comparative Analysis Model**
   - **Key Features**: In this model, benchmarks are created and regional parameters are compared to it.
   - **Usefulness**: Good for **performance evaluations and benchmarking** and comparison across jurisdictions.
   - **Examples**: Dashboards comparing government performance, educational outcomes, health indicators.
   - **Advantages**: Emphasizes **performance metrics and data visualization** for **comparison**.
4. **E-Advocacy/Mobilization and Lobbying Model**
   - **Key Features**: This model creates **online forums** to gather public opinion on policies, fostering diverse virtual communities that share ideas, expertise, and resources through digital networking.

Student Notes:

- **Usefulness**: Promotes **public participation and engagement** and **policy change** through **citizen-driven** initiatives. Useful for issues requiring citizen mobilization and collective action.
- **Examples**: Online petitions, social media campaigns, direct interactions with government decision-makers.

5. **Interactive Services Model**
   - **Key Features**: **Two-way communication**, **real-time interaction**, and **personalized services**. Citizens can engage with government officials. It is a Government to Consumer to Government Model (**G2C2G** Model- See below).



   - **Usefulness**: **Customer-centric**— best for **personalized public services** and **real-time interaction**. E.g., Civil consultations or service applications.
   - **Examples**: Online consultations, interactive government portals for service requests.
   - **Advantages**: Most **interactive**, enabling direct citizen-government interaction.

E-governance can also be understood through the interaction between different stakeholders such as citizens, businesses, government agencies, and employees.

4.4.1.1. Stakeholder-Based Models of E-Governance: G2C, G2G, G2B, and G2E

Models	Services/Information Shared	Initiatives/Examples
Government to Citizen (G2C)	• Payment of online bills such as electricity, water, telephone bills etc. • Online registration of applications • Online copies of land-record • Online filling of complaints • Availability of any kind of online information etc	• Computerisation of Land Records • Bhoomi Project in Karnataka aimed at digitizing land records • Project FRIENDS in Kerala aimed at providing multiple public services through a single window system. • Digital Locker System etc.
Government to Government (G2G)	• Government document exchange • Finance and budget management etc.	• Khajane Project in Karnataka aimed at streamlining and automating the state's treasury operations.
Government to Business (G2B)	• Tax collection • Patent approvals and rejections • Bill and penalty payments • Information and rule sharing etc.	• e-Procurement Project in Andhra Pradesh and Gujarat • SWIFT (Single Window Interface for Facilitating Trade) initiative to streamline and simplify international trade processes. etc.
Government to Employees (G2E)	• Data submissions (attendance, employee records) • Complaint filing • Sharing rules and regulations • Payment and work records etc.	• Mission Karmayogi/ Integrated Government Online Training-iGOT Karmayogi platform etc.

Student Notes:

4.4.2. Recent Development in India regarding e-governance

4.4.2.1. Digital India Mission

- It was launched by the Government of India in 2015.
- It aims to transform India into a digitally empowered society and knowledge economy.
- This initiative focuses on three core areas: **creating digital infrastructure**, **delivering services digitally,** and **promoting digital literacy.**
- A **key component** of the mission is the **Common Service Centres (CSCs),** which provide essential government services and digital access to citizens in rural and underserved areas.

4.4.2.2. NeGP 2.0 or E-Kranti (Electronic Delivery of Services):

- It aims to provide electronic delivery of services to citizens in various sectors such as healthcare, education, agriculture, and justice.
- For instance, **e-Hospital services** allow online appointment bookings and access to medical records.

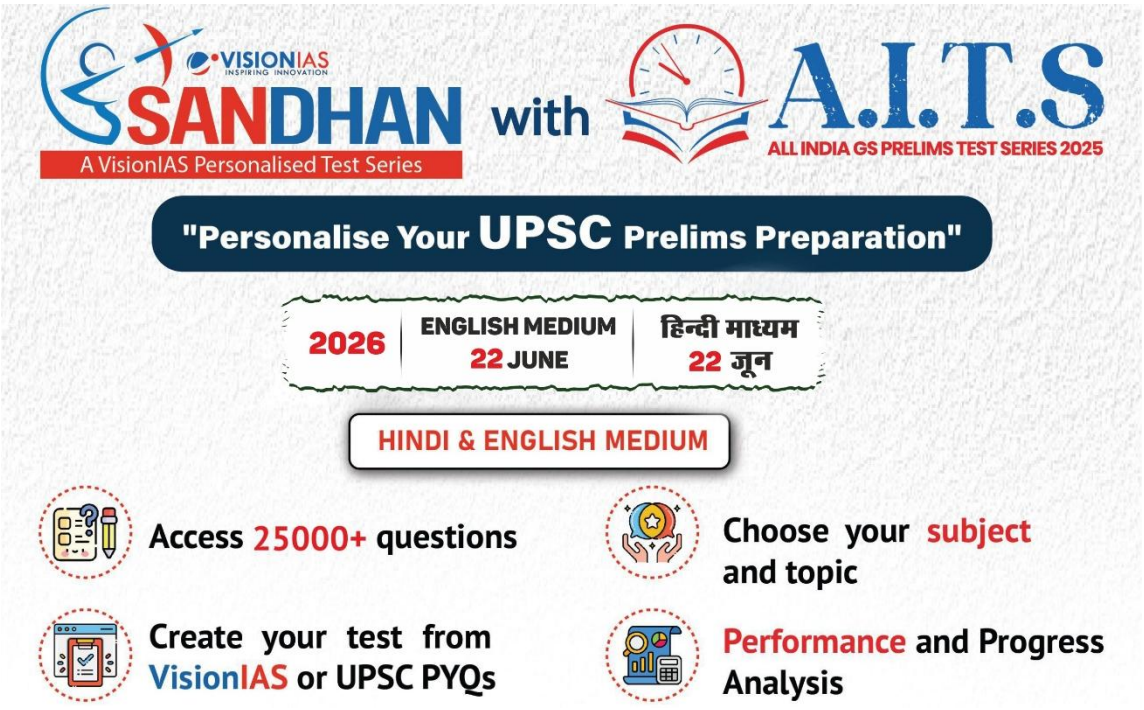
Enhancements in Governance: NeGP vs. NeGP 2.0 (e-Kranti)

The **National e-Governance Plan (NeGP),** launched in 2006, aimed to make government services accessible electronically but faced issues like lack of needs analysis, interoperability problems, and adapting to new technologies.

NeGP 2.0 (e-Kranti), introduced in **March 2015 under Digital India,** addresses these limitations to enhance governance. **Here's how:**

- **Integrated Approach**
  - Combines cloud computing, mobile platforms, and geospatial systems for better coordination and resource use.
- **Outcome-Oriented**
  - Focuses on achieving real impacts rather than just completing tasks, ensuring initiatives are effective and beneficial.
- **Fast and Agile**
  - Adapts quickly to technological changes, allowing for faster implementation and efficient service delivery.

NeGP 2.0 (e-Kranti) significantly advances e-governance by integrating systems, focusing on real outcomes, and being agile, thus improving governance and service delivery.



Student Notes:

4.4.2.3. BHIM (Bharat Interface for Money) UPI (Unified Payments Interface):

- The BHIM UPI has revolutionized digital payments in India, making transactions quick, easy, and secure.
- The UPI system has seen exponential growth, with billions of transactions processed monthly, reflecting the country's shift towards a cashless economy.

Case Study

Education and E-Governance: India's E-Learning Revolution

- **SWAYAM**: An open online platform with over 13,140 courses, including AI and machine learning, serving 4.3 crore users.
- **SWAYAM PRABHA**: A 24x7 DTH service with 48 channels offering UG/PG content, reaching 1.2 million students.
- **SWAYAM Plus**: IIT Madras-led platform offering industry-relevant courses for credit, aimed at upskilling in Tier 2 and Tier 3 cities.
- **SAMARTH**: E-governance tool streamlining higher education processes, adopted by over 3,500 institutions.
- **PM e-VIDYA**: Integrates digital education through **DIKSHA** (3.5 lakh e-contents) and **SATHEE** (2000 video lectures), enhancing access to educational resources.

4.4.2.4. India Stack:

- A set of **APIs (Application Programming Interfaces)** that allows governments, businesses, startups, and developers to utilize India's digital infrastructure to deliver services.
- Components like Aadhaar, eKYC, eSign, and DigiLocker form the backbone of IndiaStack.

These components streamline service delivery, reduce paperwork, and enhance accessibility for citizens. By leveraging this digital infrastructure, governments, businesses, and developers can provide faster, more reliable public services.

National Data Governance Framework Policy (NDGFP)

The NDGFP is an initiative by the Government of India aimed at creating a **robust framework for managing** and utilising data across various sectors.

- Launched in 2022, the policy seeks to promote the ethical use of data while ensuring privacy, security, and transparency.

Key objectives

1. **Data Accessibility**: To enhance the availability and accessibility of data for public good, ensuring that it is used effectively for governance and decision-making.
2. **Data Privacy and Security**: To establish guidelines for protecting sensitive data, ensuring compliance with privacy laws, and safeguarding citizens' information.
3. **Interoperability**: To promote interoperability

IndEA 2.0: Enhancing Digital Governance in India

IndEA 2.0 (India Enterprise Architecture) is a framework designed to improve digital governance by **creating a coherent structure** for government IT systems.

Key Features of IndEA 2.0:

Unified Architecture: Provides a cohesive structure for government IT systems, ensuring all components work together seamlessly.

Interoperability: Establishes standards and protocols that enable different government systems to communicate and share data efficiently.

Efficiency: Optimizes resource utilization, reducing duplication of efforts and ensuring cost-effective solutions.

Enhanced Service Delivery: Focuses on improving the quality and accessibility of government services to citizens through integrated digital platforms.

among different data systems, facilitating seamless data exchange and integration across government departments and agencies.

4. **Encouraging Innovation**: To foster a data-driven ecosystem that encourages research, innovation, and the development of new technologies, enhancing service delivery and efficiency.
5. **Capacity Building**: To build institutional capacity and expertise in data management, enabling government officials and agencies to leverage data effectively.

Key Components

- **Data Sharing and Collaboration**: Promoting collaboration among government departments, private entities, and research institutions to create a cohesive data ecosystem.
- **Open Data Initiatives**: Encouraging the release of non-sensitive government data to the public to promote transparency and stimulate innovation.
- **Data Governance Bodies**: Establishing bodies and frameworks for overseeing data governance practices, ensuring compliance with the policy's objectives.

Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI)

Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI) refers to the **foundational digital** systems and platforms that support the delivery of public services and facilitate governance in a digital environment. DPI encompasses a range of technologies and frameworks designed to enhance accessibility, efficiency, and transparency in government operations.

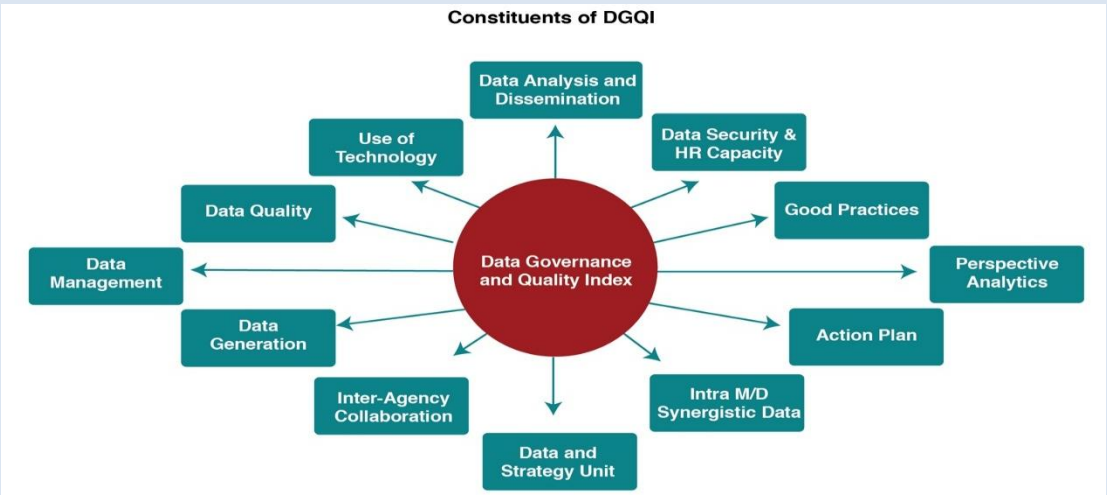
How DPI Helps in E-Governance:

- **Core Digital Systems:** Identity management (e.g., Aadhaar), payment systems (e.g., UPI), and digital storage solutions (e.g., DigiLocker) form the backbone of e-governance, enabling seamless service delivery.
- **Interoperability Frameworks:** Standards and protocols ensure different government systems can communicate and exchange data efficiently, improving coordination and reducing redundancy.
- **Open Data Initiatives:** Platforms that make non-sensitive government data available to the public foster transparency, encourage innovation, and enable informed decision-making.
- **User-Centric Services:** Digital platforms provide easy access to government services, ensuring citizens can interact effectively with the government, enhancing user experience and satisfaction.

Advancing Data Governance in India: DGQI 2.0

DGQI (Data Governance Quality Index) is an initiative by the Government of India to assess the data management practices of various Ministries and Departments. It aims to improve data quality, promote healthy competition, and encourage the adoption of best practices for better governance.

Student Notes:



What is DGQI 2.0?

DGQI 2.0 is the upgraded version of the original DGQI. It enhances the framework by:

1. **Comprehensive Evaluation**: It includes more detailed criteria for assessing data preparedness and management practices.
2. **Interoperability Focus**: Emphasizes improving data sharing and interoperability across different government departments.
3. **Actionable Insights**: Provides more actionable recommendations for improving data governance.
4. **Benchmarking Best Practices**: Encourages peer learning and the adoption of best practices from top-performing departments.

E-Governance is more than 'use of technology' in governance

Effective e-governance requires attention to both technological innovation and the redesign of administrative processes.

Humans are still core to Digital India

Intermediaries who deliver last mile governance establish trust between governments and citizens

- **Use value of information:** Value of information lies in its **capacity to empower citizens, improve transparency, and strengthen accountability** mechanisms. Merely digitizing services without ensuring that information is accurate, timely, and accessible fails to harness the transformative potential of e-governance.
- **Multifarious interactions—**Multifarious interactions are essential for effective e-governance. These occur not **only between government and citizens** but also **involve civil society, private sectors, and local communities.** Such engagement promotes participatory governance by enabling feedback, grievance redressal, and collaborative policymaking, thereby enhancing transparency and reducing corruption.
- **Institutional reforms**: A **people-first approach** is fundamental to good governance, as technology alone has limited impact in rigid administrative systems. The potential of new technologies remains untapped when **outdated procedures and practices are strictly enforced** and misused to target officials selectively. Such controls are often exploited by corrupt actors for personal gain, hindering effectiveness of e-governance.
- **Ease of governance**: The main aim of e-governance should be **'ease of governance'** leading to **'ease of living'** of people. When administrative procedures are easy to understand and navigate, citizens and officials can engage with digital platforms

effectively, leading to **higher adoption rates**. Simplified governance reduces bureaucratic delays, minimizes corruption opportunities, and enhances transparency. This creates a more responsive system.

E-governance is a holistic approach that integrates technology, effective information use, and multi-stakeholder interactions to create a transparent, accountable, and inclusive governance framework.

Student Notes:

4.4.3. Challenges

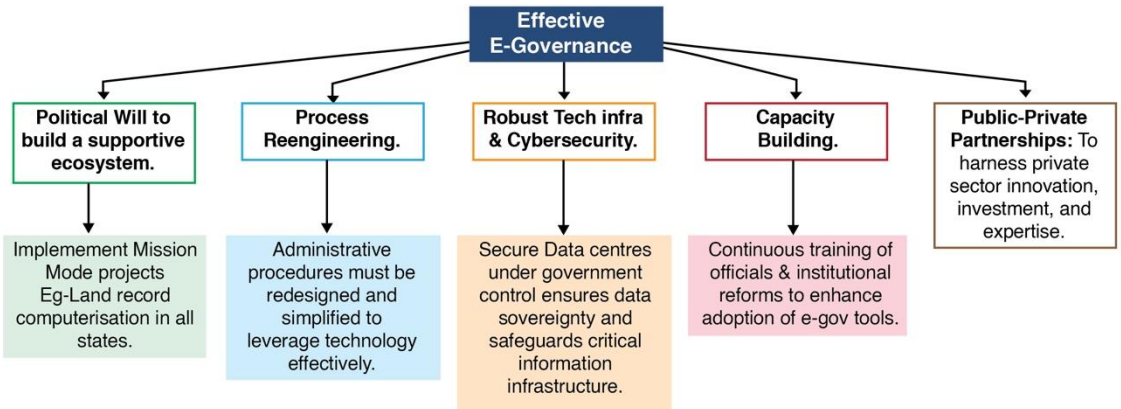
There are a large number of obstacles in implementation of e-Governance in India. These can be categorized under the following:

E-Governance Issues in India

Issue	Description
Resistance to Change	Reluctance or Slow adaptation to digital technologies.
Lack of Incentives	Initiatives risk becoming mere formalities without delivering real value. E.g., IGOT Karmayogi becoming mere attendance tracking platform.
Interoperability	Different government departments use various legacy systems that are not always compatible with each other.
Digital Divide	Limited access to high-speed internet and digital devices in rural areas. According to India Inequality Report 2022 by Oxfam, among the poorest 20% of households, only 2.7% have access to a computer, and 8.9% have internet facilities. Only 38% of households in the country are considered digitally literate.
Cybersecurity Threats	Heightened risks of data breaches, compromising public privacy & safety.
Cost factors	The cost of setting up or upgrading digital infrastructure, maintaining systems, and training personnel is substantial. Capacity-building programs due to dynamicity needs ongoing training for government staff and are costly.

Addressing these challenges requires a multi-faceted approach.

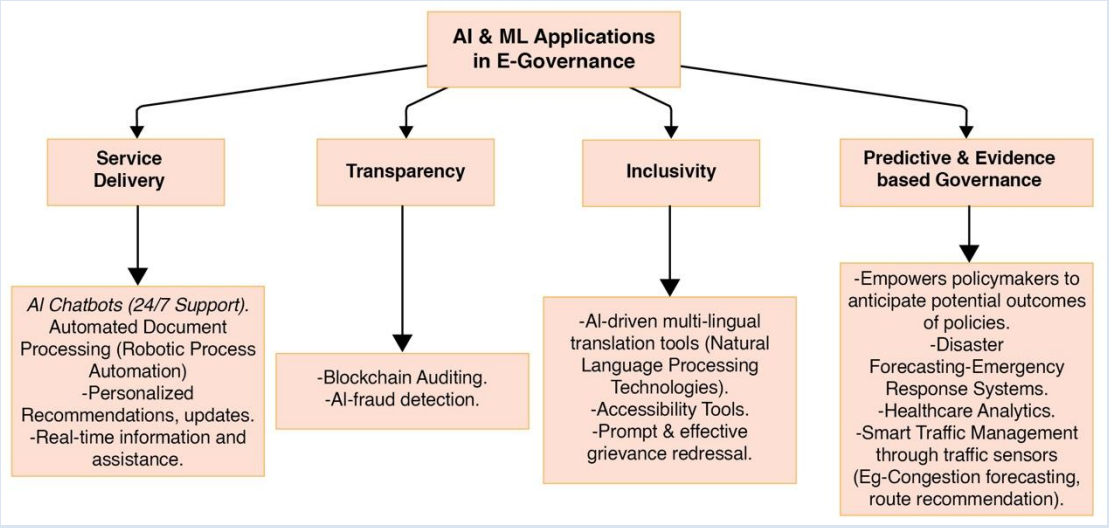
4.4.4. Recommendations on e-governance (2nd ARC)



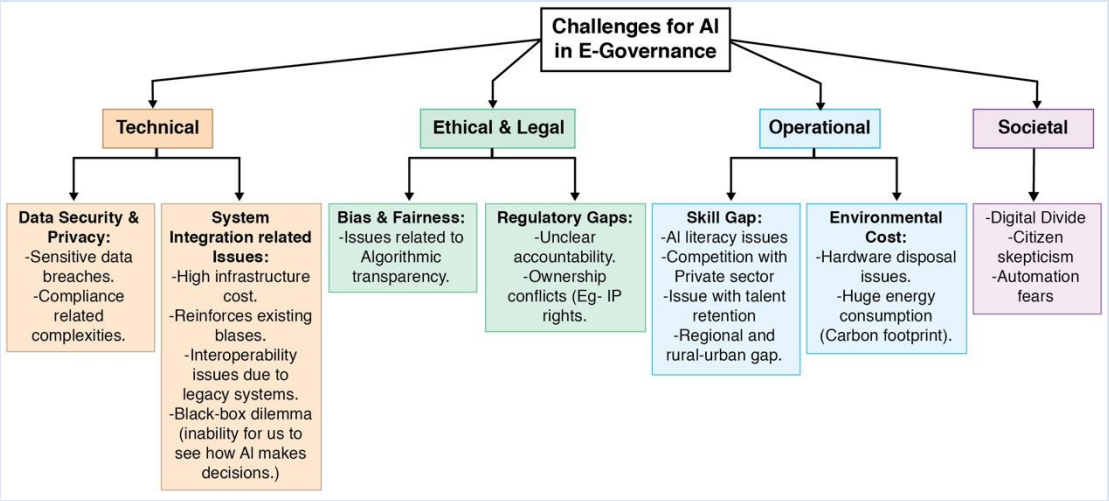
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AI & ML for e-Governance

The incorporation of AI and ML into e-governance presents significant opportunities for revolutionizing administrative procedures and improving efficiency of public service delivery, improving citizen services, and promoting transparency in India.



However, AI-led e-governance is not without its challenges.



AI integration in e-governance demands secure data exchange and robust electronic infrastructure. With focused efforts and strategic investments, India can emerge as a global leader in leveraging advanced technology for public welfare.

With robust infrastructure, targeted training, and a commitment to building a dynamic workforce, India can set a global benchmark for digital governance. The key lies in ensuring that every employee, regardless of background, rank, or location, is equipped to excel in the digital age.

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ROLE OF CIVIL SERVICES IN A DEMOCRACY

Student Notes:

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Student Notes:

Previous Years Questions (2013-24)

- Has the Cadre based Civil Services Organization been the cause of slow change in India? Critically examine. (2014, 12.5 marks)
- Has the Indian governmental system responded adequately to the demands of Liberalization, Privatization and Globalization started in 1991? What can the government do to be responsive to this important change? (2016, 12.5 marks)
- "Traditional bureaucratic structure and culture have hampered the process of socio-economic development in India." Comment. (2016, 12.5 marks)
- Initially Civil Services in India were designed to achieve the goals of neutrality and effectiveness, which seems to be lacking in the present context. Do you agree with the view that drastic reforms are required in Civil Services? Comment. (2017, 15 marks)
- "Institutional quality is a crucial driver of economic performance". In this context suggest reforms in Civil Service for strengthening democracy. (2020, 10 marks)
- The Doctrine of Democratic Governance makes it necessary that the public perception of the integrity and commitment of civil servants becomes absolutely positive. Discuss. (2024, 10 marks)

Previous Years Questions Analysis: (Avg. weightage: ~11.79%)

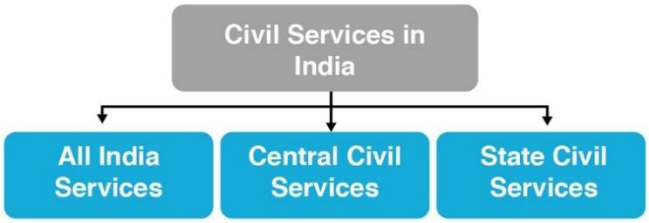
1. **Understand the Evolving Role and Core Values:** Focus on the expected role of civil services in a democracy (neutrality, integrity, efficiency), how this role has evolved post-LPG, and the importance of upholding democratic and constitutional values.
    - *PYQ Example:* The Doctrine of Democratic Governance makes it necessary that the public perception of the integrity and commitment of civil servants becomes absolutely positive. Discuss. (2024, 10 marks)
2. **Identify Key Issues and Challenges:** Be aware of the problems plaguing civil services, such as political interference, corruption, lack of specialization, resistance to change, and issues with recruitment and training.
    - *PYQ Example:* "Traditional bureaucratic structure and culture have hampered the process of socio-economic development in India." Comment. (2016, 12.5 marks)"
3. **Focus on Reforms:** Civil services reforms (Sarkaria, Hota Committee, Mission Karmayogi) are a critical area. Understand the objectives, key recommendations, and the potential impact of various reform measures.
    - *PYQ Example:* "Institutional quality is a crucial driver of economic performance". In this context suggest reforms in Civil Service for strengthening democracy. (2020, 10 marks)

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1. Civil Services

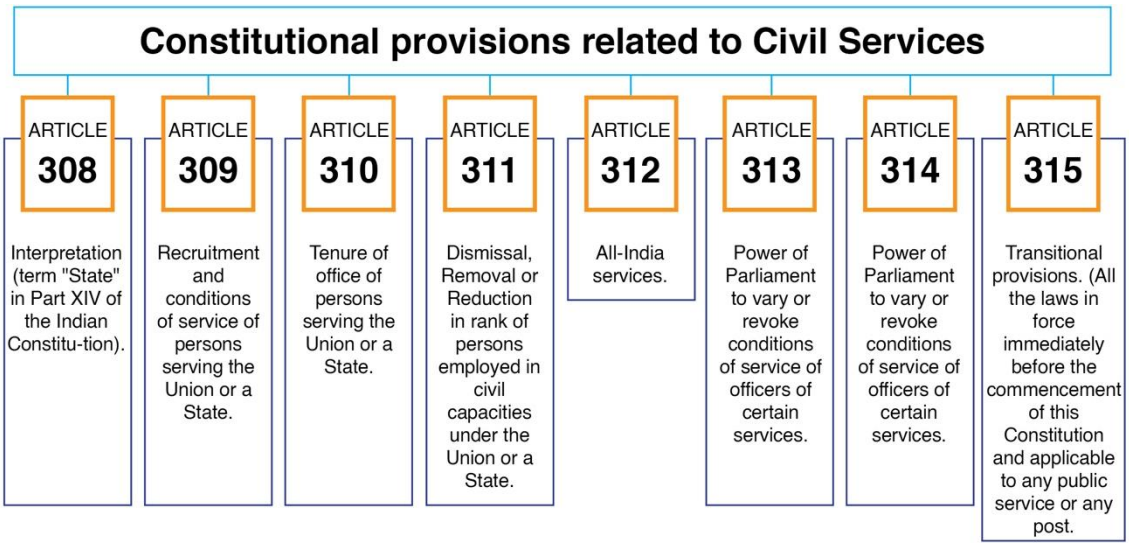
Civil service refers to the **body of government officials** who are employed in **civil occupations** that are neither political nor judicial. Often called the **"Steel Frame of India",** they provide **stability** and **ensure smooth transitions** between governments.

Civil services are **essential in public administration**, significantly influencing a country's development and progress by ensuring **efficient operations**. The **development, upliftment** and **progress** of society depend upon the efficient functioning of civil services.

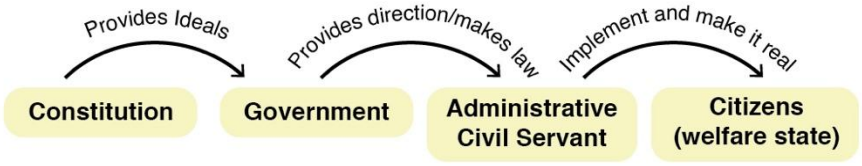


Civil servants operate within an **impersonal system**, governed by specific **rules** and a **clear hierarchy**.

Student Notes:



1.1. Role of Civil Services



Civil servants play a **crucial role as agents of change** in societal transformation by implementing policies, **driving innovation**, engaging with communities, managing crises, promoting social equity, fostering sustainable development, and building institutional capacity. Their key roles include:

Facilitators of Democratic Processes and Good Governance:

- Conduct free and fair elections and ensure smooth transfer of power at Centre and States.
- Maintain uninterrupted administration during political instability (e.g., President's Rule).
- Uphold loyalty to the people, Constitution, and nation, not to any political party.
- Protect unity, integrity, and constitutional values; have the courage to say "no" if laws or conventions are compromised.

Policy Advisors to the Government:

- Serve as repositories of institutional knowledge and provide expert advice in policy-making.
- Undertake research and assess financial, administrative, and legal implications of policies.
- Highlight consequences of flawed policies and provide inputs for effective decision-making.

Policy Implementers and Administrative Leaders:

- Design policies and ensure their effective implementation, including Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs).
- Provide leadership at senior levels to monitor and guide program execution.
- Execute government programs, lay down laws, rules, and regulations.
- Facilitate delivery of essential services and coordinate relief operations.

Maintainers of Stability and Continuity in governance:

- Act as stabilizing forces during political crises or administrative vacuums.
- Rise above partisan conflicts to resolve crises and ensure smooth governance.

Regulators and Facilitators in a Market Economy:

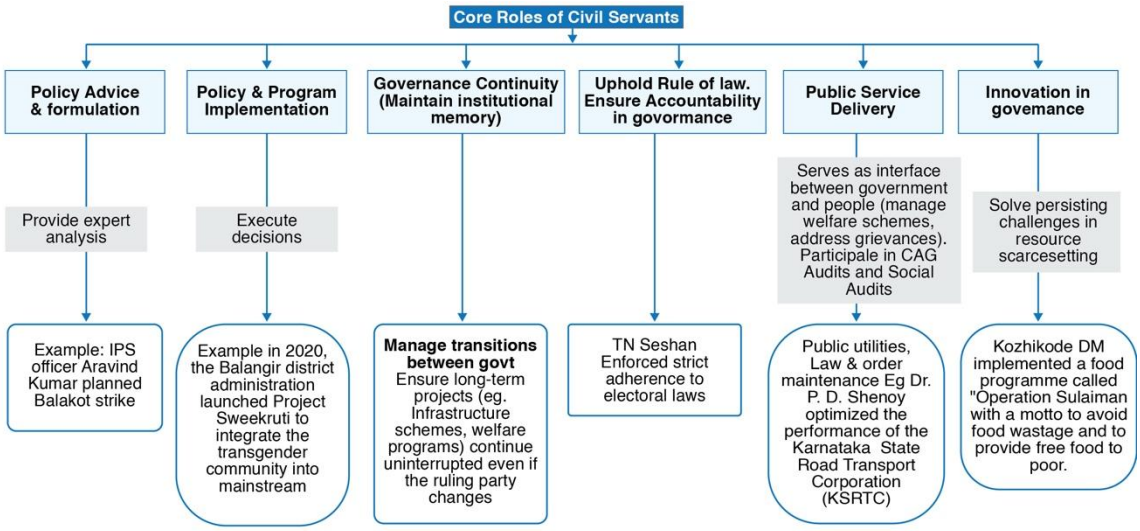
- Transition from service providers to facilitators and regulators in a liberalised economy.

Student Notes:

- Build institutional capacity through domain expertise to regulate markets effectively and protect public interests.

Leaders with Moral Authority:

- Hold power, prestige, and social status; expected to lead with professionalism and ethical standards.
- Set examples that influence government and private sector behavior.
- Prioritize public welfare and act in a non-partisan manner.



The competency framework for the Civil Services under **Mission Karmayogi** envisages to prepare civil servants for the future by making them **more constructive, enabling, energetic, innovative, proactive, professional, progressive, transparent and technology enabled.**

Characteristics of Indian Civil Services

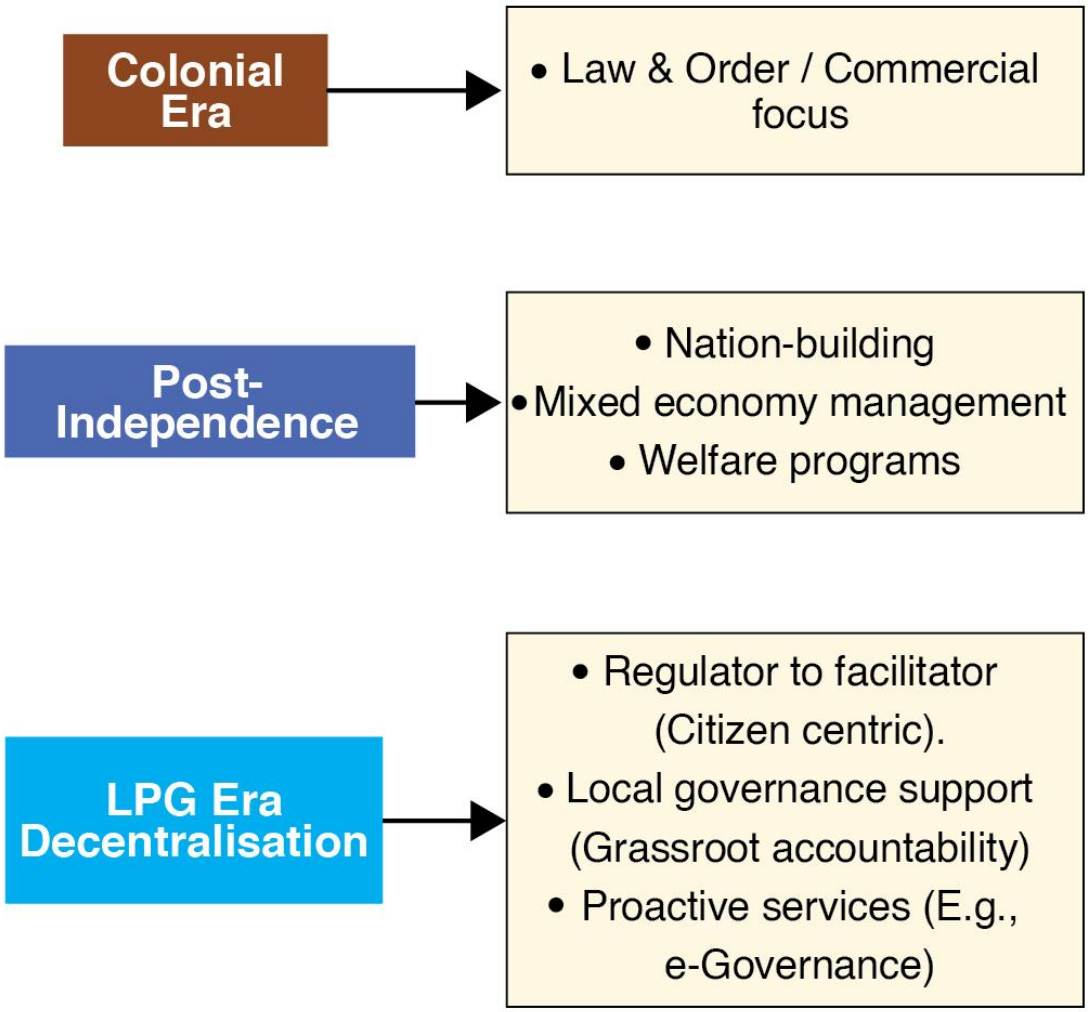
Indian Civil Services possess following characteristics. However, these traits have evolved over time to ensure stability, fairness, and effectiveness in administration.

Characteristic of civil service

1. **Anonymity:** Civil servants perform duties without personal recognition, representing the government rather than themselves.
2. **Community Service Consciousness:** Dedicated to the public interest, civil servants work to improve community welfare over personal gain.
3. **Public Responsibility:** Administrators are accountable to the public, ensuring their decisions and actions align with societal expectations and legal standards
4. **Monopoly:** Inherent lack of competition within government roles, often leading to exclusive control over certain administrative functions
5. **Large-Scale Organization:** Civil service operates within vast structures that handle extensive issues, impacting broad segments of society
6. **Consistent Treatment:** Ensures equitable service to all citizens, upholding fairness and uniformity in applying rules and policies.
7. **Secrecy:** Protection of sensitive information
8. **Hierarchy:** Defines the chain of command and delineates responsibilities.

Student Notes:

1.2. Evolution of Civil Services in India



1.3. Issues with Civil Services in India

Various scholars and committees, including the **Second Administrative Reforms Commission**, have highlighted criticisms of the civil services' performance as follows:

Erosion of Neutrality, Political Interference, and subjugation to political executive:

- Bureaucrats are increasingly exhibiting political bias in critical functions. This is **both a cause and effect of increasing political interference** in postings, transfers, and other administrative aspects. Senior civil servants are perceived as being subjugated by the political leadership.
- E.g., despite allegations of misconduct and criticism for partisan behaviour, IPS officer Rajeev Mishra was promoted by the West Bengal government. Also, Civil servants in Delhi often find themselves caught between conflicting authorities (Centre and UT)

Lack of Specialised Expertise (Generalist vs. Specialist):

- Career bureaucrats, mainly generalists, often lack the specialized technical expertise required for complex government functions, raising doubts about an IAS officer's ability to manage diverse portfolios like civil aviation, power, or defense effectively.
- Early single examination rank heavily influences career trajectories, overshadowing actual job performance and expertise.

Student Notes:

Corruption and Incompetence:

- The civil service system is affected by significant corruption and incompetence at various levels, which frequently goes unpunished.
- Example: "Puja Khedkar" case as instance of fraud and procedural misuse. Enforcement Directorate Assistant Director Shekhar Kumar accused of demanding a ₹2 crore bribe to halt an investigation.

Insufficient Public Engagement, Culture of Superiority and 'Mai Baap' Attitude (colonial overhang):

- Lack of stringent penalties for misconduct. E.g., 2 IAS officers involved in ordering a stadium to be cleared for walking a pet dog faced no reduction in status or salary, only transfers.
- Results in policies less aligned with ground realities, leading to implementation challenges and public dissatisfaction.

Demoralization and Fear of Politicization:

- Moves like lateral entry threaten serving officers' hegemony and are seen as potentially compromising the neutrality and impartiality of the civil service by **inducting political loyalists.**

Structural Rigidity, Red tape, Slow changes:

- Inflexible structures cause delays. E.g., During the 2018 Kerala floods, bureaucratic delays hindered a timely and effective response.

Lateral Entry Challenges

- Lack of clear frameworks, concerns about transparency, potential friction with career bureaucrats, and risk of politicisation of bureaucracy (lateral entry may potentially compromise the neutrality and impartiality of the civil service by **inducting political loyalists**).

A few recent issues are discussed below in detail.

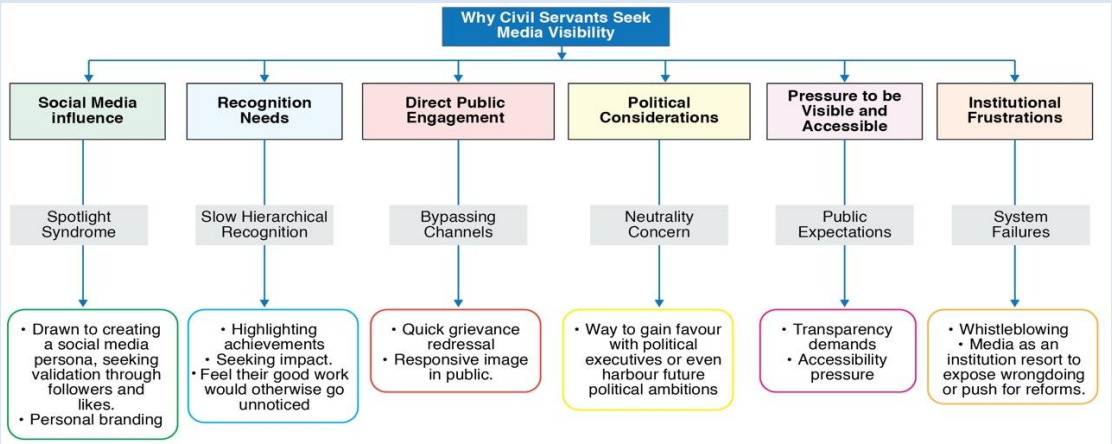
1.3.1. Recent issues related to Civil Services

Social Media Popularity of Civil Servants and the Price of Lost Anonymity

The lure of social media fame is infiltrating the corridors of power. Time to rein in social-savvy bureaucrats?

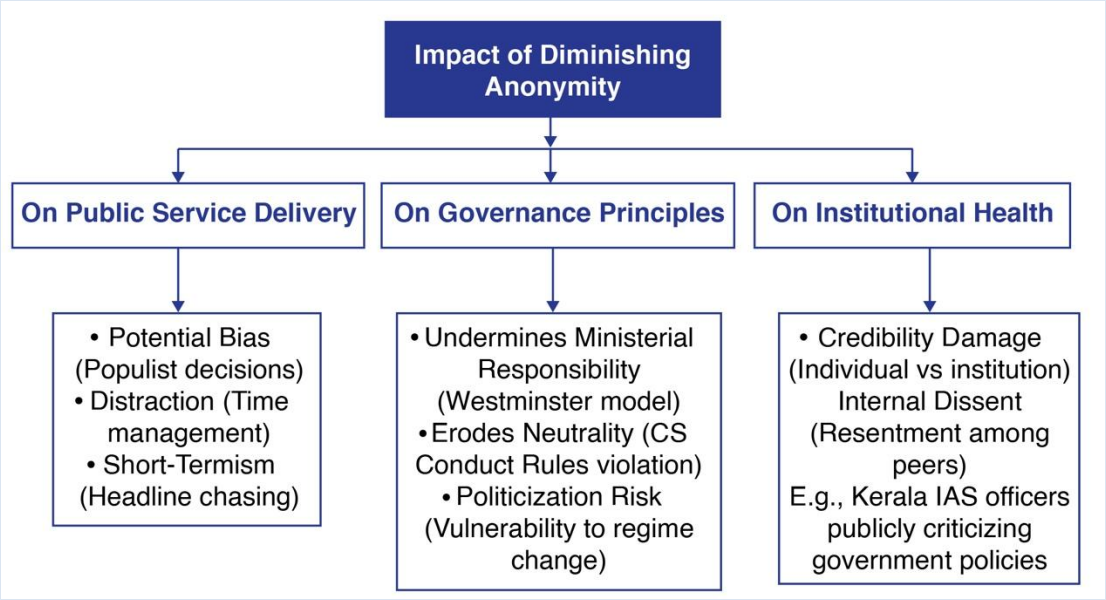
The traditional Westminster model of bureaucracy, which India largely adopted, emphasizes the principle of civil service anonymity. A growing trend of civil servants becoming public figures, actively engaging with media and social media, is reshaping perceptions and potentially impacting the core tenets of governance.

Reasons



Student Notes:

Impact



Use of Social media in innovative service delivery & governance

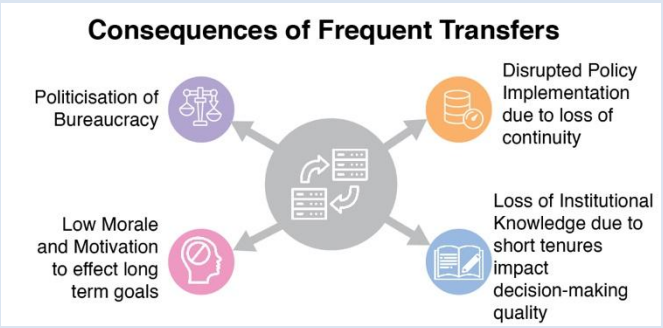
Many officers use Twitter, Facebook, and other platforms to reach out to people and hear their problems. Social media helps officers for rapid grievance redressal, spreading public awareness, enhancing transparency, promoting community engagement, and sharing real-time updates on government schemes and services.

1. **Prashant Nair,** IAS Officer (Kozhikode, Kerala): Used Facebook to mobilize community efforts for cleaning a 14-acre pond.
2. **Awanish Sharan,** IAS Officer (Chhattisgarh): Introduced "Sangi Express" bike ambulances for remote tribal areas. Social media played a crucial role in spreading awareness.

As individual officers increasingly become public figures through media exposure and social platforms, the **traditional institutional voice through official spokepersons** risks being overshadowed by personal opinions and individual identities. This shift can undermine the collective neutrality and impartiality that civil services are meant to uphold.

Transfer as a tool for political control of bureaucracy

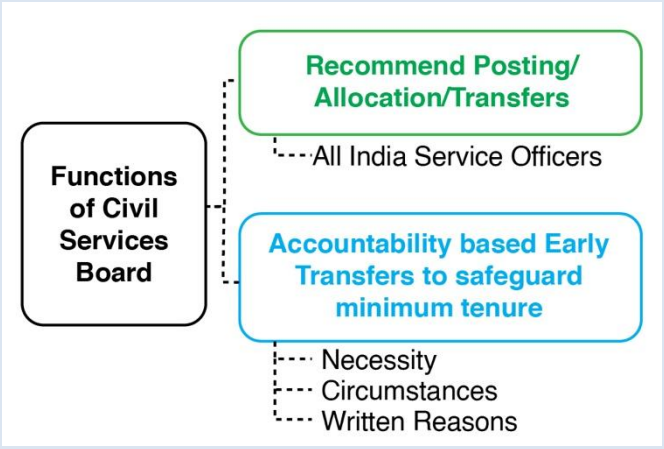
Despite recruitment through exams and some protections, civil servants remain vulnerable to arbitrary transfers. Politicians' use of transfers to control bureaucracy undermines bureaucratic autonomy, fosters corruption, and weakens effective governance.



- Politicians **leverage civil servants' strong preference** to be posted near their hometowns or in urban, desirable locations.
- The fear of being transferred to less desirable or remote postings is used as a threat to compel civil servants to comply with political demands. Thus, officers and District Collectors often remain aligned with local Ministers to retain their positions for extended periods.

Student Notes:

- For example, a **2024 working paper** "*Bureaucrat Assignments as Instruments of Political Control: Evidence from Land Administration Officials in India*" pointed out that Politicians pressure tehsildars to facilitate land conversions benefiting real-estate developers. Developers in turn, provide financial kickbacks to politicians in return.



Role of Civil Services Board (CSBs)

Supreme Court in ***T.S.R. Subramanian case*** directed states to constitute CSBs to act as final authority to ensure fair postings for all officers. CSB is made up of **high-ranking service members** who are professionals in their domains, with the cabinet secretary at the national level and the chief secretary at the state level, who serve as the **state government's guide and advisor**.

T.S.R. Subramanian case Judgement

- **Establish CSB to guide** on transfers, postings, and disciplinary actions.
- Assurance of **minimum tenure** for civil servants to ensure efficiency.
- Government must provide justifications when choosing to dissent from the CSB's recommendation.
- Civil servants to **respond** only to recorded instructions, except in exceptional circumstances, to prevent favoritism and corruption. Oral and verbal instructions, if not recorded, goes against spirit of RTI Act.

Issues:

Karnataka High Court questions conduct of State government in not constituting Civil Services Board even 10 years after apex court's direction

The civil services board (CSB) will look into posting and transfer of Indian Administrative Service (IAS) officers

CAT restrains govt from transferring or posting IAS cadre officers without the recommendations of Civil Services Board

- **Government's resistance to consult CSBs:** Recommendations can be amended, modified, or rejected by governments. Government contend that the IAS Cadre Rules, 1954 (2014 & 2016 amendment) don't mandate that all transfers and postings of IAS officers shall be only on the recommendations of the Civil Services Board. Even as per the Rules, the recommendations of the Civil Services Board may be required **only if the IAS officer is transferred prematurely** before completion of the period of service in a post.
- **Using covert methods**: If the political leadership cannot directly transfer an officer who resists undue influence, they may resort to implicating the officer in false cases to undermine and remove them, highlighting how restricting political control through bodies like the Civil Services Board can sometimes lead to more covert and damaging tactics.
- **Conflict of interests due to bureaucrats in boards**: This may

To maintain a harmonious balance between the political and permanent executive, the autonomy of career bureaucrats is essential.

Why Public Perception of Civil Services matter?

A positive public perception of a transparent, accountable, and committed civil service is the bedrock upon which citizens' trust in governance is built and sustained. It fosters a **virtuous cycle** that strengthens democratic institutions and processes.

Student Notes:

- **Enhances Legitimacy and Trust:** A fair and effective civil service boosts government legitimacy by inspiring public confidence through transparent recruitment and grievance redressal.
- **Promotes Accountability and Reduces Corruption:** Accountability and transparency deter corruption; tools like the RTI Act and CVC strengthen integrity and public vigilance.
- **Improves Policy Implementation:** Competent and committed civil servants encourage citizen cooperation, leading to better outcomes in programs requiring citizens cooperation. E.g., Swachh Bharat Abhiyaan.

> Telangana
> **Officials take up task of cleaning toilets in Warangal village**
> *A team of about 40 principal secretaries and joint secretaries of various states led by Parameswaran Iyer, took up the cleaning exercise.*

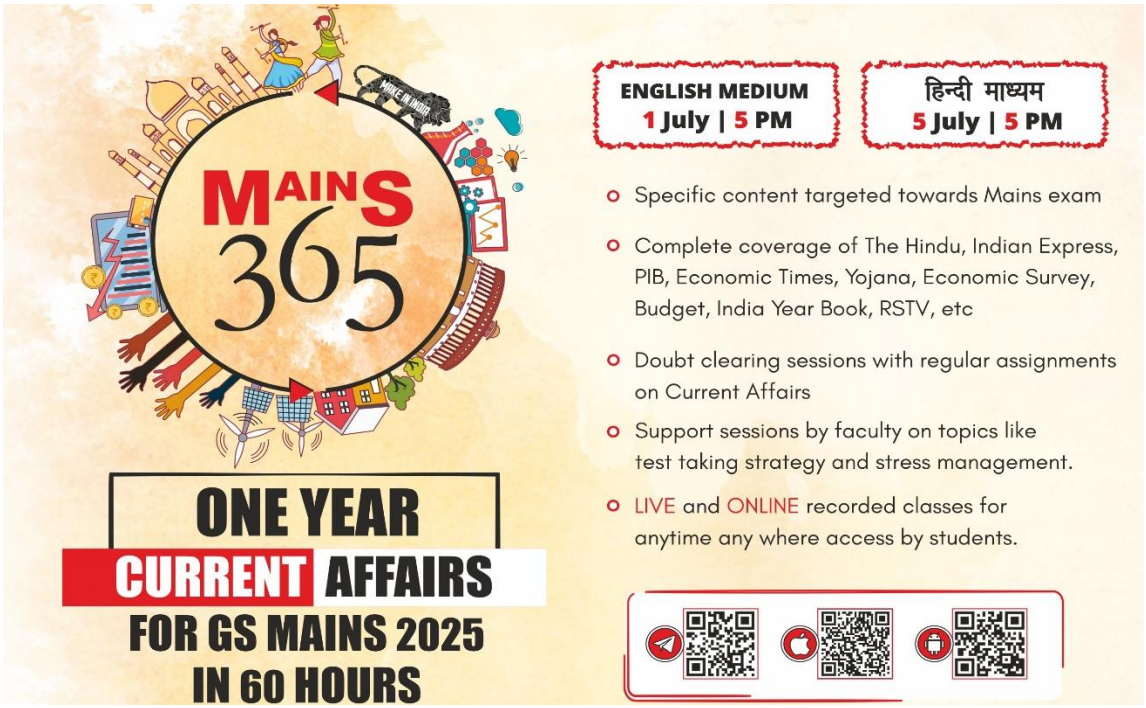
- **Strengthens Democratic Institutions:** Neutral and impartial civil servants uphold the Rule of Law and democratic stability, ensuring governance continuity despite political changes.
- **Fosters Citizen Engagement:** Positive perception motivates active citizen participation in governance, enhancing responsive and collaborative governance.
  - **E.g.,** LG Mulaqat Scheme of LG Manoj Kumar Sinha in J&K.

> **Without a political govt, people in J&K use 'L-G Mulaqat' window to raise issues, get solution**

- **Serves as Role Model:** Civil servants exemplifying integrity and professionalism cultivate civic virtues and ethical conduct in citizenry.
  - **E.**g., former Tamil Nadu DGP V.R. Lakshminarayanan was known for his political nonpartisanship, integrity and efficiency.
- **Ensures Stability and Continuity:** The permanent civil service framework guarantees administrative stability and sustained development beyond electoral cycles.

> The IAS officers' loyalty has to be to the people, the Constitution and the nation: K. Sujatha Rao

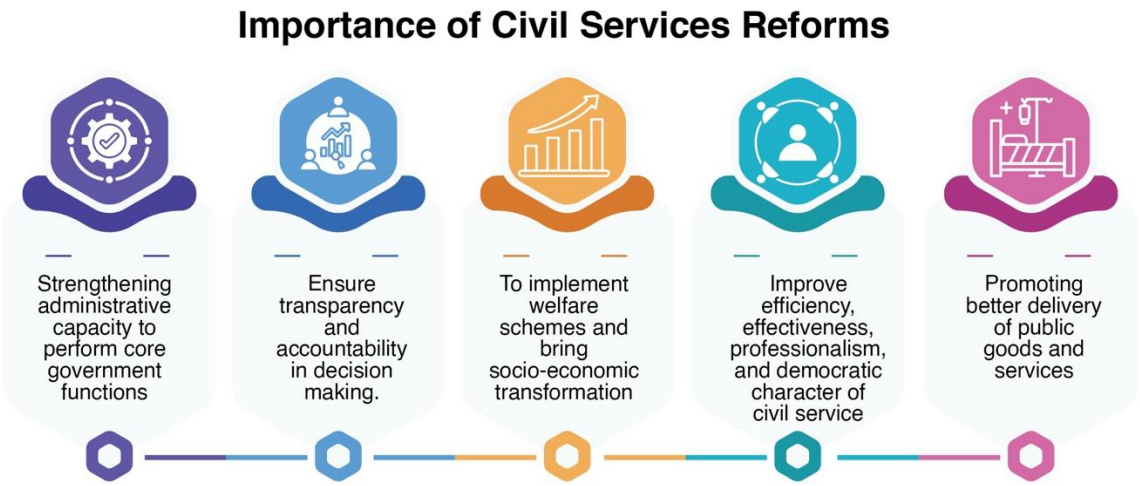
In essence, a civil service that is, and is perceived to be, transparent, accountable, and committed is a vital pillar supporting the edifice of a thriving democracy. It transforms governance from a mere exercise of authority into a partnership between the state and its citizens.



Student Notes:

2. Civil Services Reforms in India

Civil Service Reform is a **deliberate effort** by the government to enhance its ability to implement policies efficiently and effectively. The main components of Civil Service Reform should pertain to the following:



Transforming Civil Service Mindset

A paradigm shift in the nature of the **civil service** and its **servants is necessary** to address the emerging **demands** and **changes** in society and the economy. The table below summarizes the nature of changes required in this esteemed service for better performance:

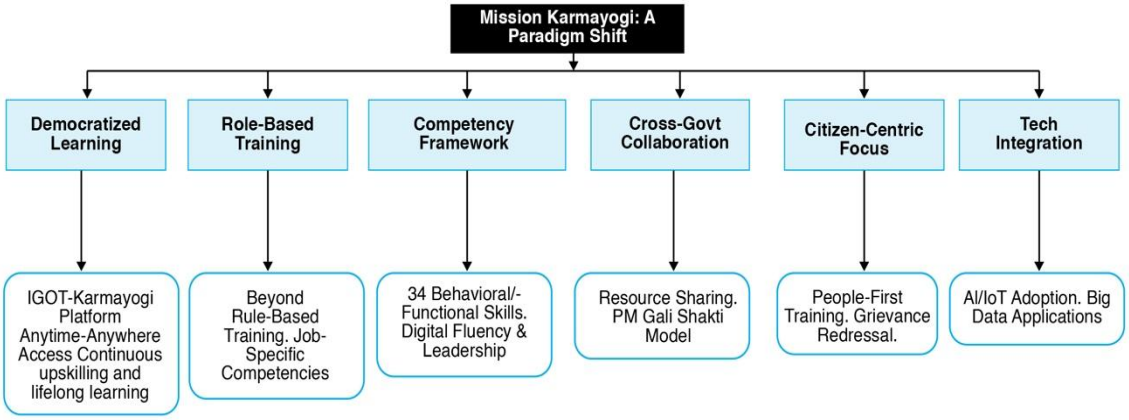
Aspect	Traditional Approach	Required Shift
Commitment	To the Civil Service	To public service
Core Values	Integrity and neutrality	Integrity, impartiality, and delivery
Precedent	Follower	Creator
Work	Exclusively in policy and ministerial support roles	Varies roles between operations, policy, specialist skills, and ministerial support
Aims	To lead the development of a major policy area.	To deliver the outcomes of a major policy area.
Experience	Widens experience by brief tenures in public sector	Widens experience by taking a private sector role
Training	One Time	Career-long development and learning
Orientation	Status quo	Change
Approach	Monopolistic	Competitive

2.1. Mission Karmayogi: A paradigm Shift

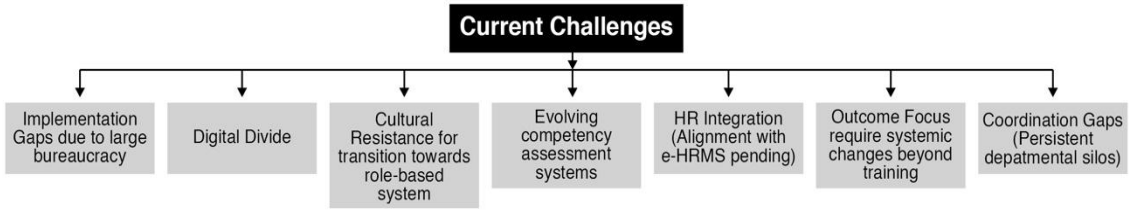
Mission Karmayogi represents a transformative shift from the traditional, rule-bound civil service framework towards a **dynamic, role-based, and citizen-centric** governance model. Rooted philosophically in the Bhagavad Gita's principle of "**Yogah Karmasu Kaushalam**"—the art of achieving excellence in action **without attachment to outcomes**—the mission encourages civil servants to transition from mere **karmacharis** (employees) to dedicated **karmayogis** who serve with integrity, commitment, and **continuous self-improvement.**

Student Notes:

Key features

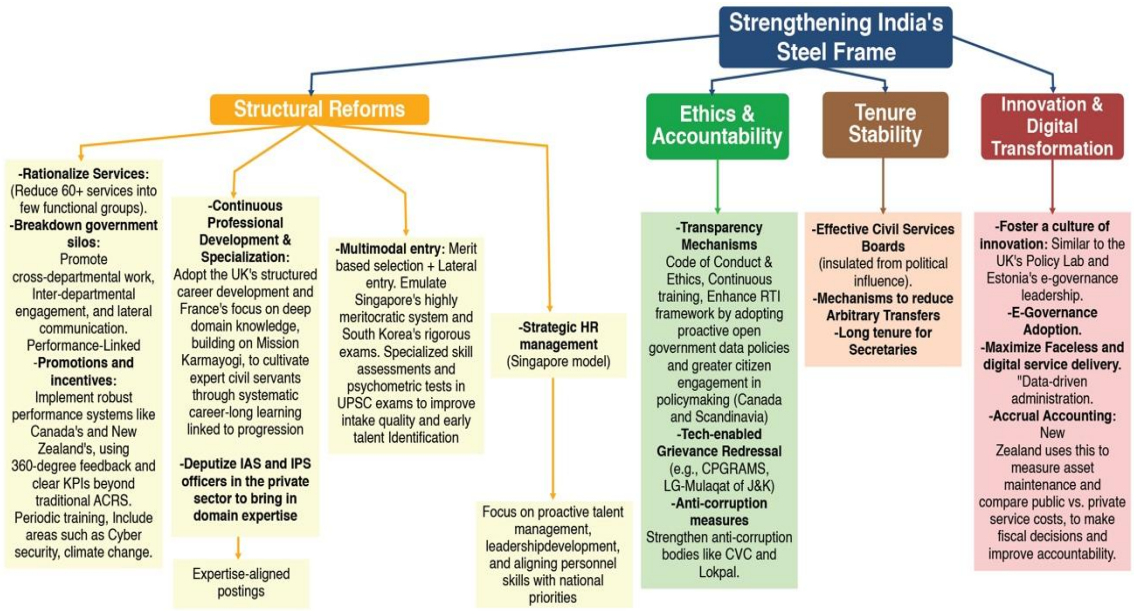


Challenges with Mission Karmayogi



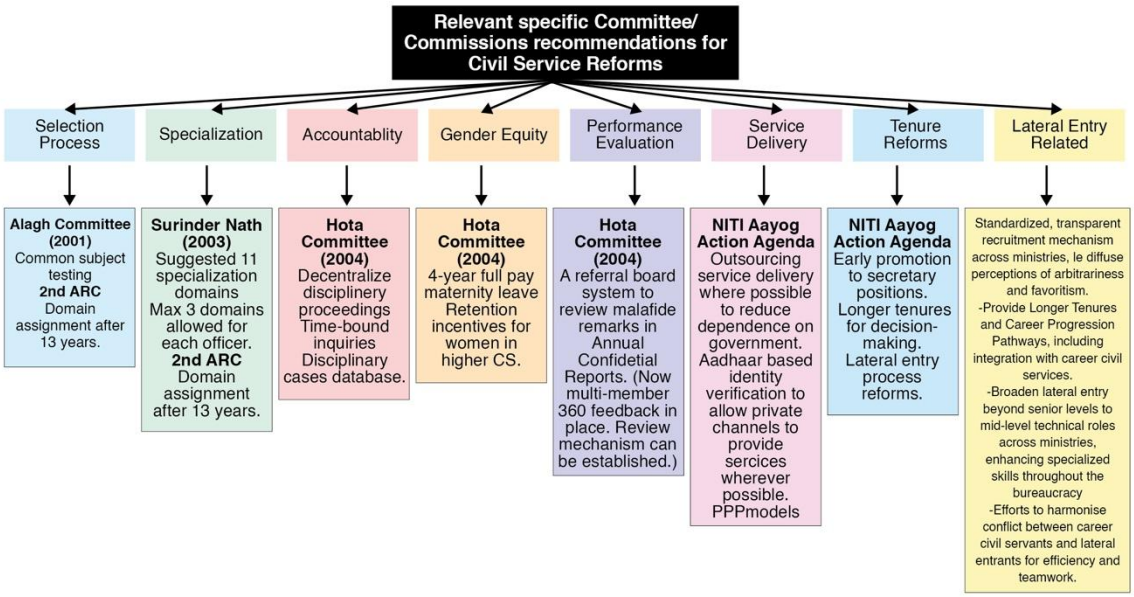
The raison detere of mission karmayogi is **assignment of right person for the right role at the right time.** It also aims to train civil servants in **behavioral competencies**, particularly those interacting with citizens, to improve public experience. Filling these gaps is crucial for realizing the objectives of Mission Karmayogi.

2.2. Civil Services Reforms- What more can be done?

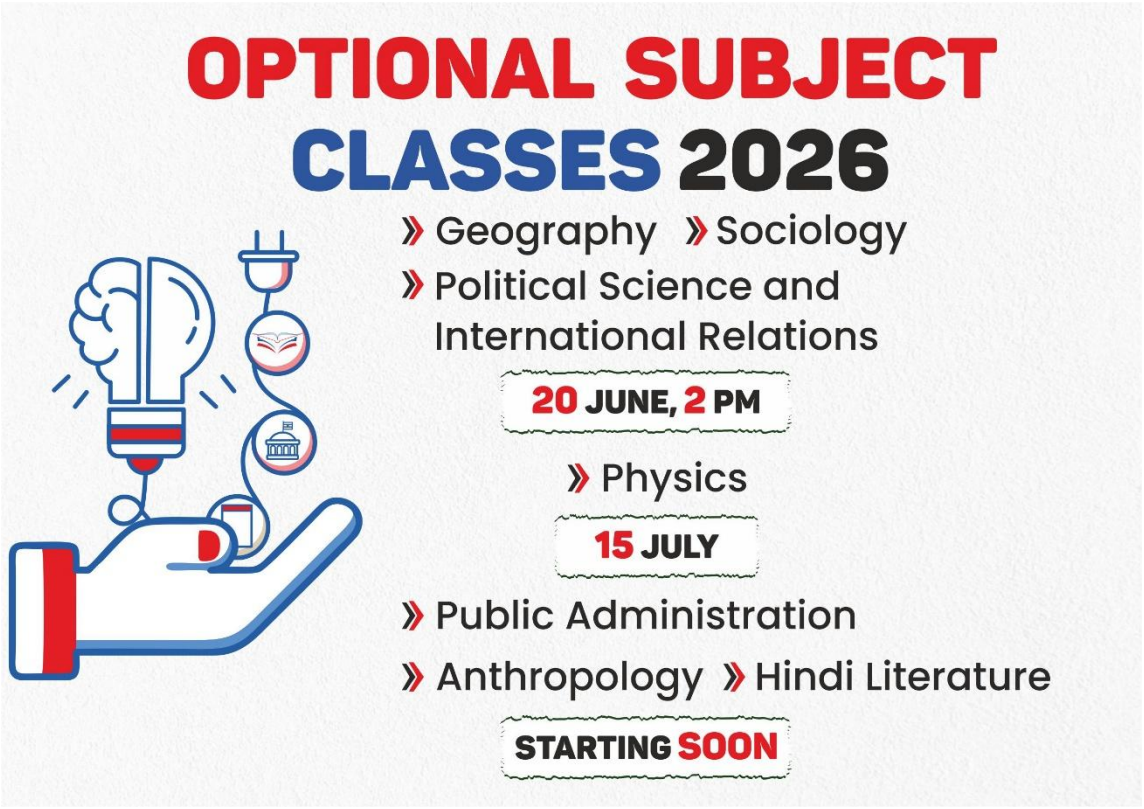


Student Notes:

2.2.1 Relevant Committee/Commission recommendations



Civil services reforms must prioritize citizen-centricity, accountability, enhanced and updated training mechanisms, and protection of bureaucratic neutrality and non-partisanship to build a modern, efficient bureaucracy. Cultivating continuous capacity building and gender inclusivity would ensure the services adapt to evolving governance challenges and be responsive and future-ready to uphold democratic values and drives India's inclusive development.



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Student Notes:

DEVELOPMENT PROCESSES AND THE DEVELOPMENT INDUSTRY
THE ROLE OF NGOS, SHGS, VARIOUS GROUPS AND ASSOCIATIONS, DONORS, CHARITIES, INSTITUTIONAL AND OTHER STAKEHOLDERS

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Student Notes:

Previous Years Questions (2013-24)

- "The legitimacy and accountability of Self Help Groups (SHGs) and their patrons, the micro-finance outfits, need systematic assessment and scrutiny for the sustained success of the concept. Discuss. (2013, 10 marks)"
- "The penetration of Self Help Groups (SHGs) in rural areas in promoting participation in development programmes is facing socio-cultural hurdles. Examine. (2014, 12.5 marks)"
- "Examine critically the recent changes in the rules governing foreign funding of NGOs under the Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Act (FCRA), 1976. (2015, 12.5 marks)"
- "The Self-Help Group (SHG) Bank Linkage Programme (SBLP), which is India's own innovation, has proved to be one of the most effective poverty alleviation and women empowerment programmes. Elucidate. (2015, 12.5 marks)"
- "How can the role of NGOs be strengthened in India for development works relating to protection of the environment? Discuss throwing light on the major constraints. (2015, 12.5 marks)"
- ""In the Indian governance system, the role of non-state actors has been only marginal." Critically examine this statement. (2016, 12.5 marks)"
- ""The emergence of the Self-Help Groups (SHGs) in contemporary times points to the slow but steady withdrawal of the State from developmental activities." Examine the role of the SHGs in developmental activities and the measures taken by the Government of India to promote the SHGs. (2017, 15 marks)"
- "The need for cooperation among various service sectors has been an inherent component of development discourse. Partnership bridges the gap among the sectors. It also sets in motion a culture of 'collaboration' and 'team spirit'. In the light of statements above examine India's development process. (2019, 15 marks)"
- ""Micro-Finance as an anti-poverty vaccine, is aimed at asset creation and income security of the rural poor in India". Evaluate the role of the Self Help Groups in achieving the twin objectives along with empowering women in rural India. (2020, 15 marks)"
- "Can the vicious cycle of gender inequality, poverty and malnutrition be broken through microfinancing of women SHGs? Explain with examples. (2021, 10 marks)"
- "Can Civil Society and Non-Governmental Organizations present an alternative model of public service delivery to benefit the common citizen? Discuss the challenges of this alternative model. (2021, 15 marks)"
- "Do you agree with the view that increasing dependence on donor agencies for development reduces the importance of community participation in the development process? Justify your answer. (2022, 15 marks)"
- "Discuss the contribution of civil society groups for women's effective and meaningful participation and representation in state legislatures in India. (2023, 15 marks)"
- "Public charitable trusts have the potential to make India's development more inclusive as they relate to certain vital public issues." Comment. (2024, 10 marks)"

Previous Years Questions Analysis: (Avg. weightage: ~29.67%)

1. **Highest Weightage – Non-State Actors are Key:** This is the most frequently tested theme within your Governance breakdown. A deep understanding of the role, contributions, challenges, and accountability of NGOs, SHGs, Civil Society Organisations (CSOs), and other non-state actors in the development process is crucial.
    - *PYQ Example:* "The emergence of the Self-Help Groups (SHGs) in contemporary times points to the slow but steady withdrawal of the State from developmental activities." Examine the role of the SHGs in developmental activities and the measures taken by the Government of India to promote the SHGs. (2017, 15 marks)

Student Notes:

2. **Focus on Impact and Effectiveness:** Questions often require evaluating the impact of these groups on specific areas like poverty alleviation, women empowerment, environmental protection, or as alternative service delivery mechanisms.
   - *PYQ Example:* Can Civil Society and Non-Governmental Organizations present an alternative model of public service delivery to benefit the common citizen? Discuss the challenges of this alternative model. (2021, 15 marks)
3. **Regulatory Framework and Challenges:** Be aware of the regulatory environment (e.g., FCRA for NGOs) and the challenges these organizations face (funding, accountability, socio-cultural hurdles).
   - *PYQ Example:* Examine critically the recent changes in the rules governing foreign funding of NGOs under the Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Act (FCRA), 1976. (2015, 12.5 marks)

---

1. Development

The **United Nations** defines development as a **comprehensive economic**, social, and political process that aims to improve the **well-being** and quality of life of people. However, Prof. **Amartya Sen** has conceptualized 'development' as 'freedom'. Freedom is both the **primary end and the principal means** of development. To him, the only acceptable evaluation of human progress is primarily and ultimately **enhancement of freedom** and the achievement of development is dependent on the **free agency of people**.

Human Development Index (HDI)

The HDI is a summary measure that **assesses average** achievements in **three fundamental dimensions** of human development:

- **Life Expectancy:** This dimension reflects the overall health and longevity of a population.
- **Education**: It considers both the quantity (years of schooling) and quality (expected years of schooling) of education.
- **Standard of Living:** This dimension includes **Gross National Income (GNI)** per capita, which indicates the economic well-being of individuals.

Building on this understanding, **sustainable development** emphasizes the responsibility to meet the needs of the present **without compromising the ability of future generations** to meet their own needs. Thus, development has to balance freedom and well-being with long-term ecological and social sustainability to ensure enduring progress for all.

1.1. Challenges Associated with Development in India

India's development journey is riddled with complex and interconnected challenges as follows:

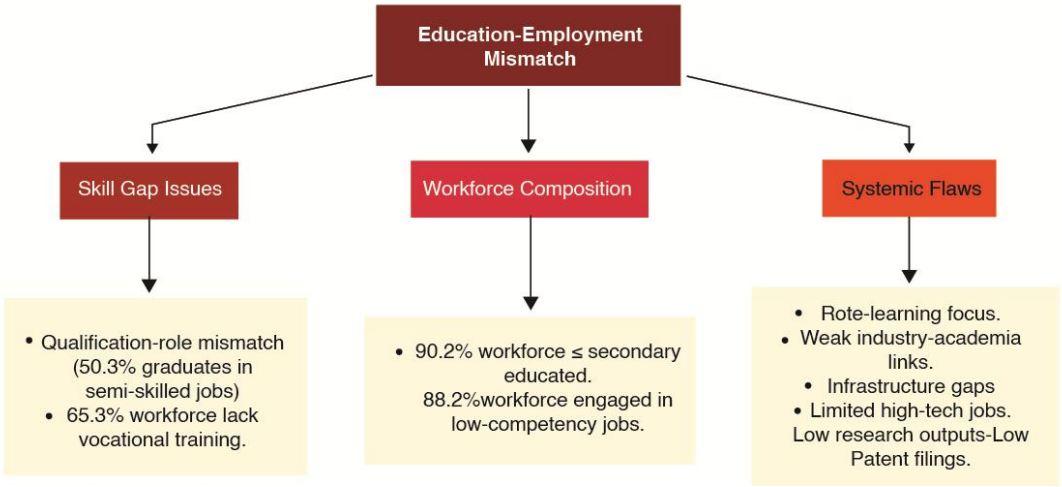
1. **Unequal Distribution of Resources:**
   - Flawed land reforms have **perpetuated unequal land ownership**, hindering agricultural growth and exacerbating income disparity.
   - **Inter-regional disparities** in development due to inadequate planning and resource allocation have led to social unrest.
2. **Deficiencies in Human Capital Development:**
   - Stagnant investment in **education (2.9% of GDP)** coupled with **low doctor-to-patient ratio** (0.7 per 1000) hinders workforce productivity and future economic prospects.

Human Capital

- Human Capital refers to the **collective skills, knowledge, experience**, and **health** of a country's workforce.
- It includes the **attributes gained** through education, training, and healthcare, which enhance individual productivity and economic value.
- **High-quality** human capital drives economic growth and development, while **deficiencies** like low education levels, poor health, and gender inequality hinder progress and future prospects.

- Gender inequality severely restricts female participation in education, health, and the workforce, limiting overall development.

3. **Socioeconomic Inequality:**
   - The **top 1% holds** a disproportionate share of wealth (40 times the national average), hindering economic mobility and access to resources for a large section of the population.
   - Lack of **quality education** and healthcare disproportionately impacts the poor, creating a vicious cycle of poverty.
4. **Education-Employment mismatch:**



5. **Environmental Degradation:**
   - Rampant pollution, with 9 out of the 10 most **polluted cities globally** being Indian, poses a serious health threat and hinders sustainable development.
6. **Implementation Bottlenecks:**
   - Ineffective implementation of land reforms and development plans hinders progress and exacerbates existing inequalities.
   - Outdated infrastructure in resource-rich areas like Jharkhand limits the efficient utilization of natural resources.

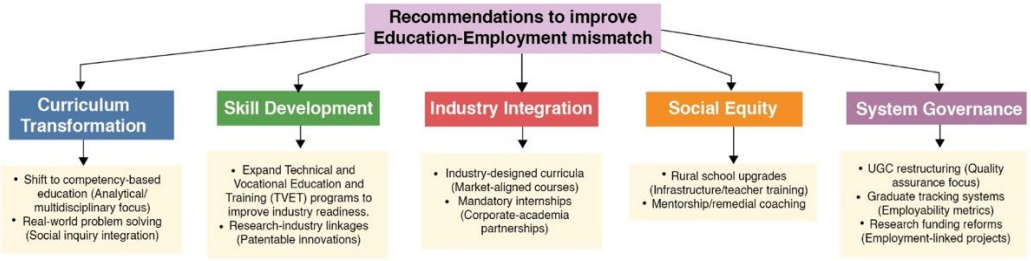
These challenges demand a multi-pronged approach. India needs to invest in inclusive growth strategies, improve governance and infrastructure development.

1.2. Strategies for Addressing India's Development Challenges

To create a holistic solution to address the development challenges in India, strategies that can be followed are:

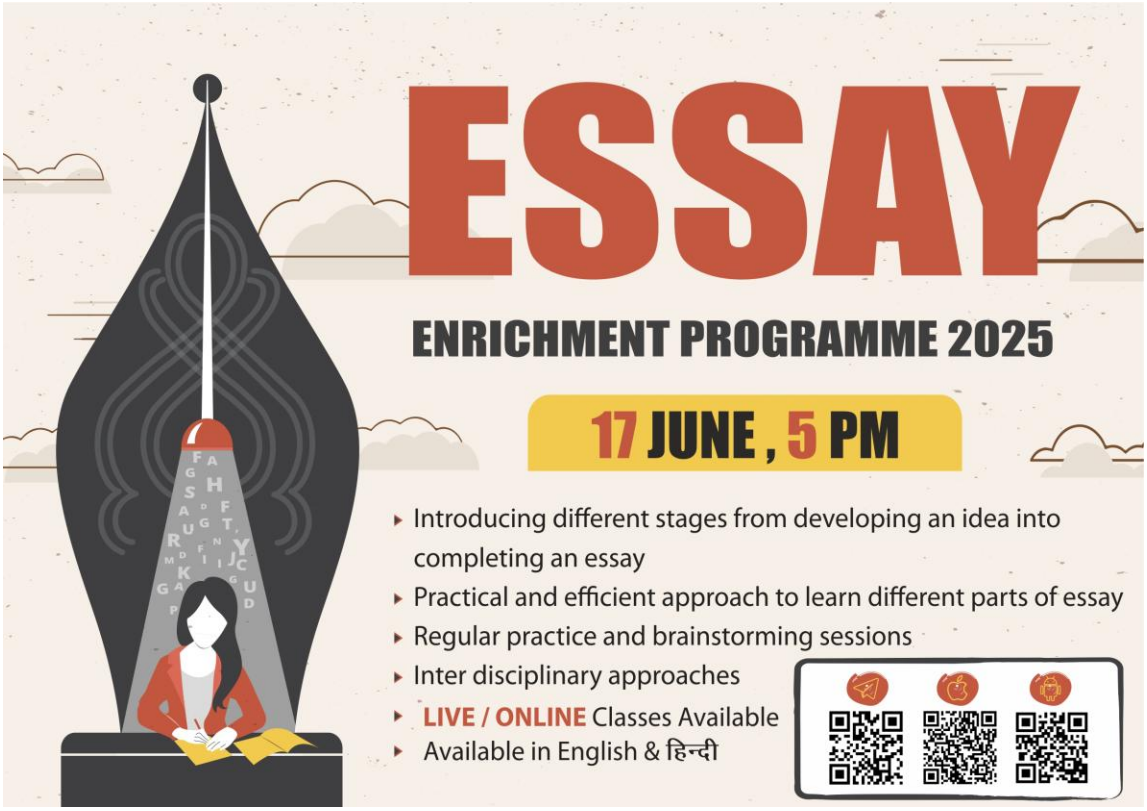
1. **Policy and Governance Reforms**
   - **Land and Legal Reforms:** Implement fair and transparent land reforms to ensure equitable distribution, supported by a modern digital registration system. Strengthen legal frameworks to protect rights, particularly for marginalized groups.
   - **Decentralised Development:** Focus on regional equity by developing infrastructure and promoting economic activities in underdeveloped areas, reducing regional disparities.
2. **Investment in Human Capital**
   - **Education and Health Enhancement:** Significantly increase investment in education and health sectors to a **minimum of 5% of GDP** for each. Establish strict standards for quality and efficiency and encourage public-private partnerships to extend reach and improve service delivery.
   - **Gender Equality Programs:** Launch empowerment initiatives focusing on education, employment opportunities, and health services for women, alongside enforcing stronger laws against gender-based discrimination and violence.

Student Notes:



3. **Economic Reforms and Social Security**
   - **Progressive Taxation and Fair Redistribution**: Implement progressive taxation to ensure a fairer distribution of wealth.
     - Expand and improve social security systems to cover all vulnerable sections of society, reducing economic inequality.
   - **Skill Development and Employment**: State-sponsored skill development programs should be aimed at increasing employment among economically disadvantaged groups, fostering economic mobility.
4. **Environmental Management and Sustainability**
   - **Pollution Control and Sustainable Practices:** Enforce stringent environmental regulations and promote sustainable agricultural and industrial practices.
     - Invest in renewable energy sources to decrease reliance on fossil fuels and mitigate environmental degradation.
5. **Community Engagement and Resource Management**
   - **Community-Managed Resource Policies:** Develop policies that ensure sustainable practices and equitable distribution of benefits by actively involving local communities in resource management decisions and actions.
   - **Technology Integration in Resource Utilization:** Modernize technology for efficient extraction and processing of natural resources.

By implementing these strategies, India can address its multifaceted development challenges in a comprehensive and sustainable manner, fostering a more inclusive and progressive society.

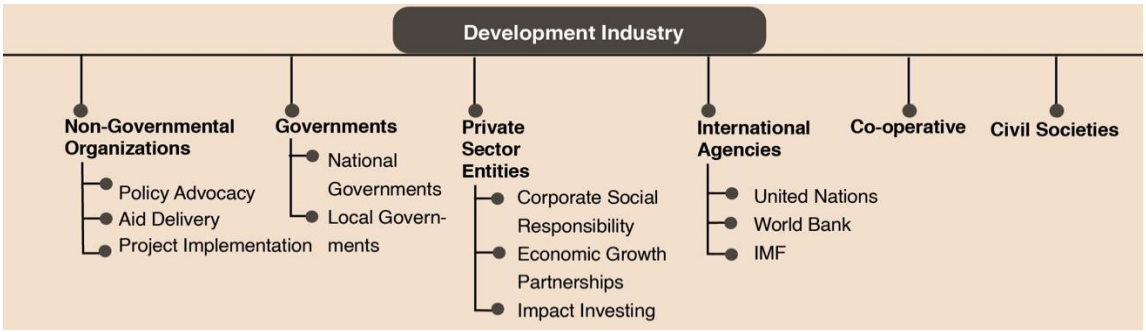


Student Notes:

2. Development Industry

The **"development industry"** refers to the global network of organizations, agencies, and institutions that work towards promoting development, particularly in the Global South.

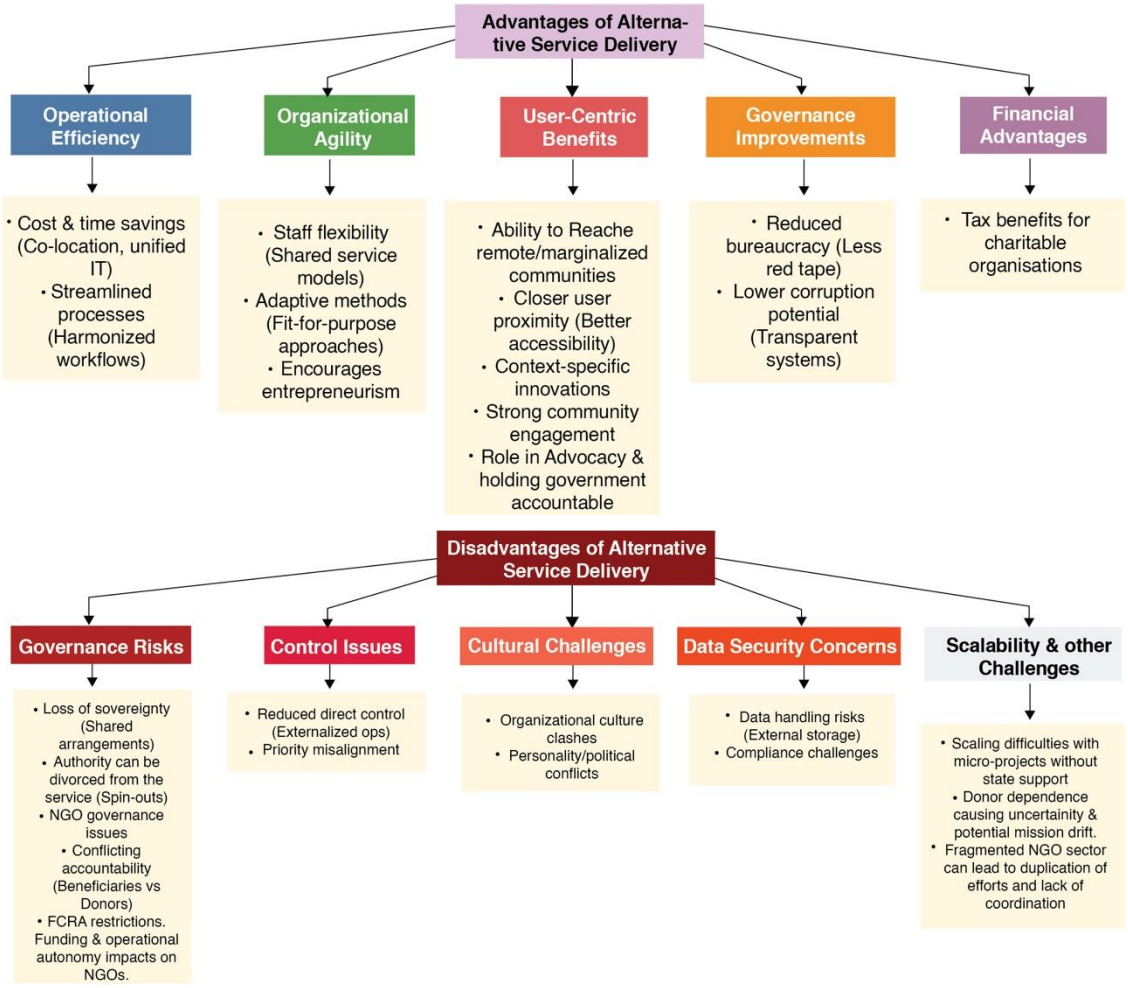
The **government** has traditionally been the **primary agent** for delivering public services, ensuring equitable access to essential resources such as education, healthcare, and infrastructure. However, to enhance efficiency and reach underserved populations, **alternative service delivery mechanisms** have emerged.



2.1. Alternative Service Delivery Mechanisms

Alternative service delivery (ASD) mechanisms may be defined as the provision of public services through arrangements **other than the traditional departmental structure**. These includes arrangements such as **NGOs, Civil society Organizations, Charitable organizations, Private sector etc.**

ASD has unique advantages and disadvantages.



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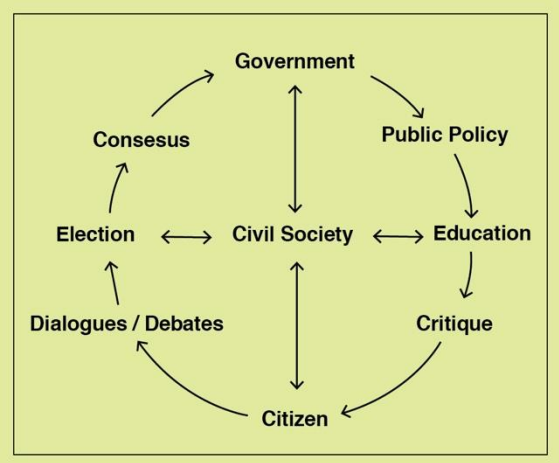
Few examples of ASDs in India are:

- **Pratham:** It has significantly contributed to **children's literacy through its ASER reports and intervention programs like "Teaching at the Right Level."**
- **Aravind Eye Care System:** It delivers high-quality, affordable eye care using an **innovative, financially sustainable model** that subsidizes services for the poor. It developed a high-volume, high-quality, low-cost model for cataract surgery, making eye care accessible to millions. Their innovations include assembly-line efficiency in surgery, tiered pricing to subsidize the poor, and local manufacturing of intraocular lenses.
- **SEWA**: It has empowered informal women workers by providing **access to financial services, healthcare, and social security.**

While ASD mechanisms can fill critical gaps, particularly when the state withdraws or is overstretched, they **cannot wholly replace the state's fundamental responsibility** for universal public service provision, which requires broader infrastructure, consistent funding, and democratic accountability.

2.2. Civil Society Organisations

Civil Society Organisations (CSOs) are **groups and movements outside the government** that engage in advocacy, human rights, social justice, and democratic governance. They act as a **watchdog on the state,** amplify marginalized voices, and contribute to public discourse and policy shaping in a democracy.



- According to the **World Bank**, Civil Society refers to refers to a ***wide array of organizations****, community groups, Non-governmental organizations (NGOs), labour unions, indigenous groups, charitable organizations, faith-based organizations, professional associations and foundations.*
- Civil society, also called the **"third sector"** (after government and private sector), has the power to **influence** the actions of elected **policymakers** and businesses.
- Examples of well-known civil society organizations include **Amnesty International, the International Trade Union Confederation, World Wide Fund for Nature (WWF), Greenpeace and the Danish Refugee Council (DRC).**

The **National Policy on Voluntary Sector 2007** defines **voluntary organizations (VOs)** broadly to include a variety of groups focused on public service, encompassing **community-based organizations, NGOs, charitable groups,** support organizations, networks, and professional associations.



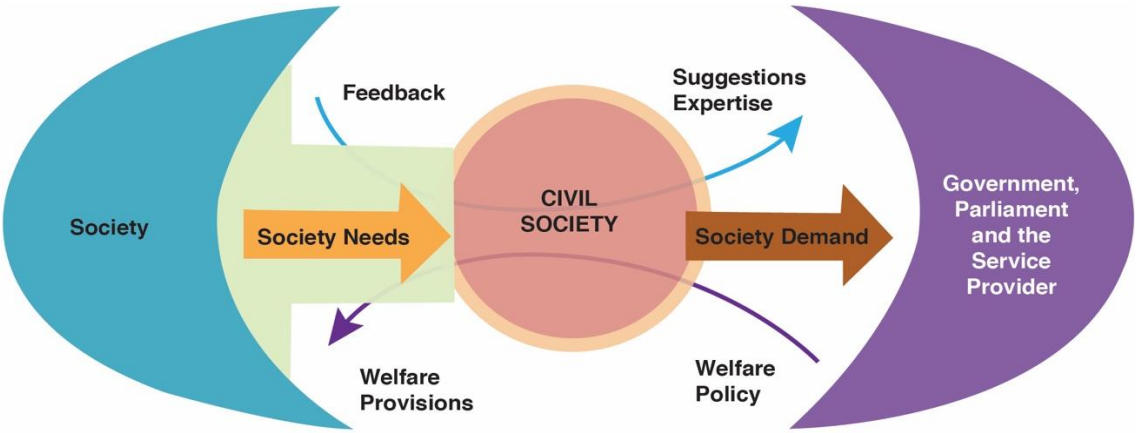
2.2.1. Features of Civil Society Organization

- **Autonomous Operation**: Functions independently from governmental and commercial influences.
- **Voluntary Engagement**: Participation is freely chosen, motivated by shared objectives and enthusiasm.
- **Socially Driven Purpose**: Focuses on public welfare rather than profit maximization.
- **Diverse and Inclusive:** Includes a broad spectrum

Student Notes:

of groups with various interests and methodologies.

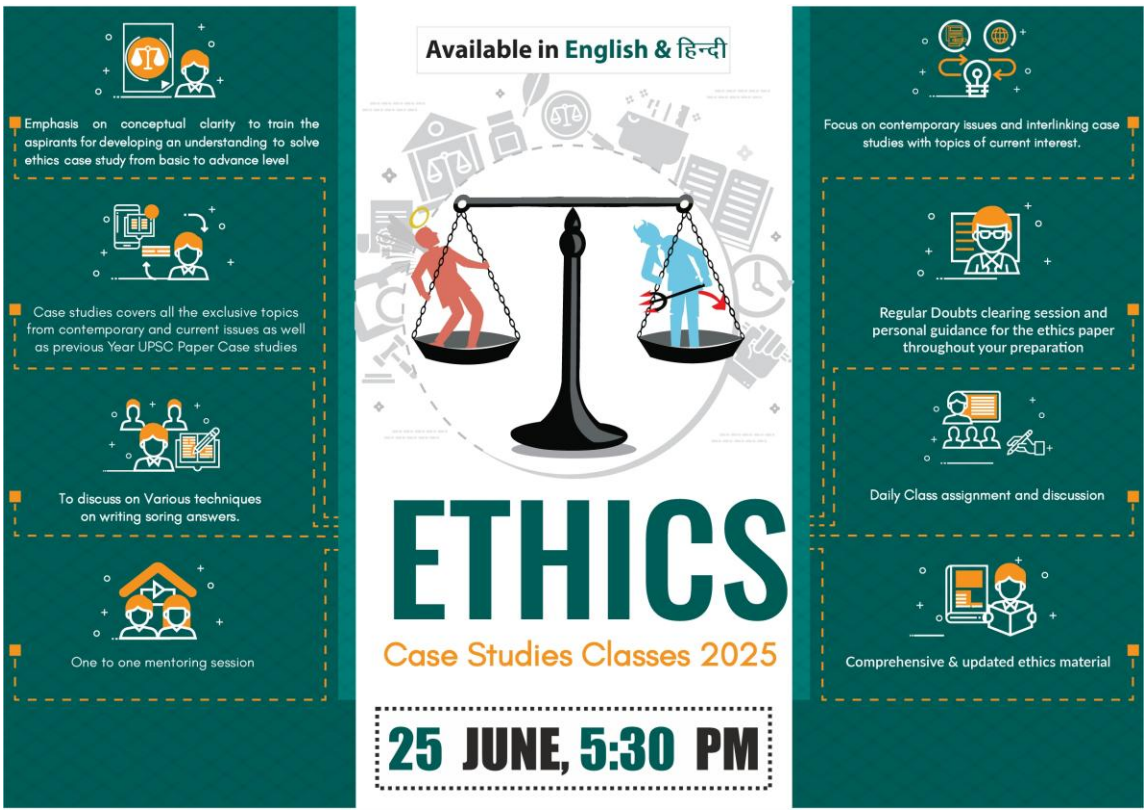
- **Advocacy for Marginalized Groups:** Represents and champions the interests of underrepresented communities.
- **Accountable Practices**: Holds responsibility to its members, beneficiaries, and the wider public.



2.2.2. Civil Society in India

Civil society, rooted in **Gandhian volunteerism,** now manifests in various forms of activism. Initially, voluntary organizations in **independent India** addressed government **development** gaps.

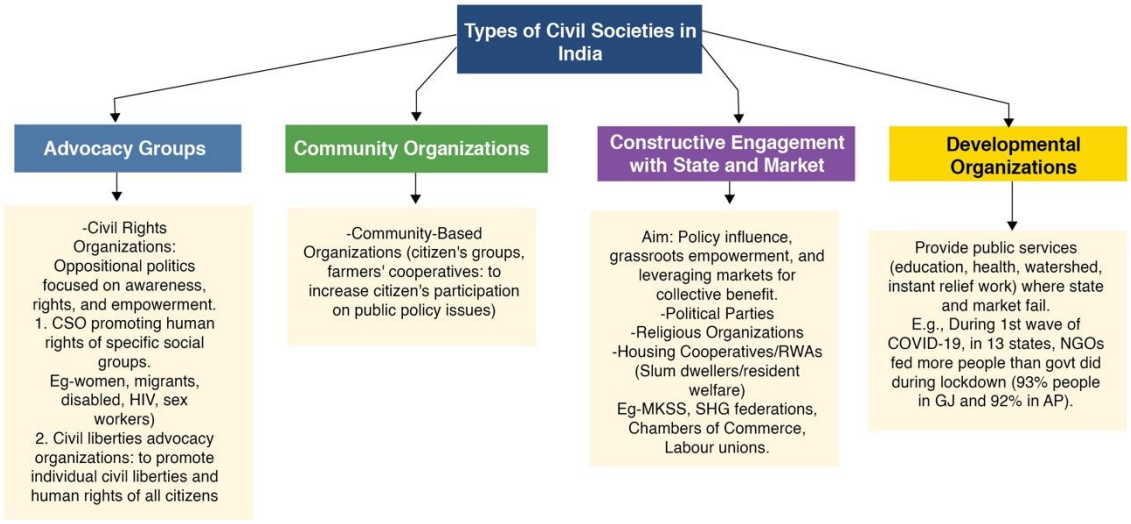
- For example, Civil societies organized **handloom** weavers into **cooperatives** for direct marketing and better pricing.
- AMUL, a **dairy cooperative society**, emerged from this cooperative movement.



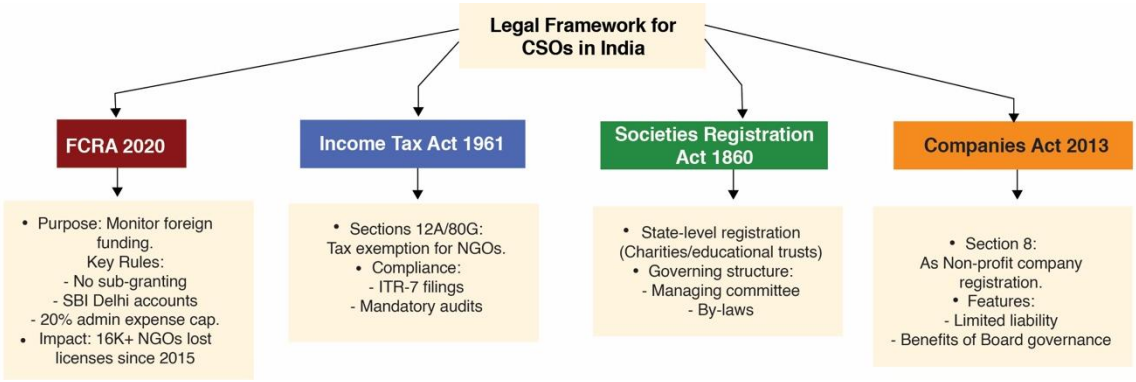
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2.2.3 Types of Civil societies in India

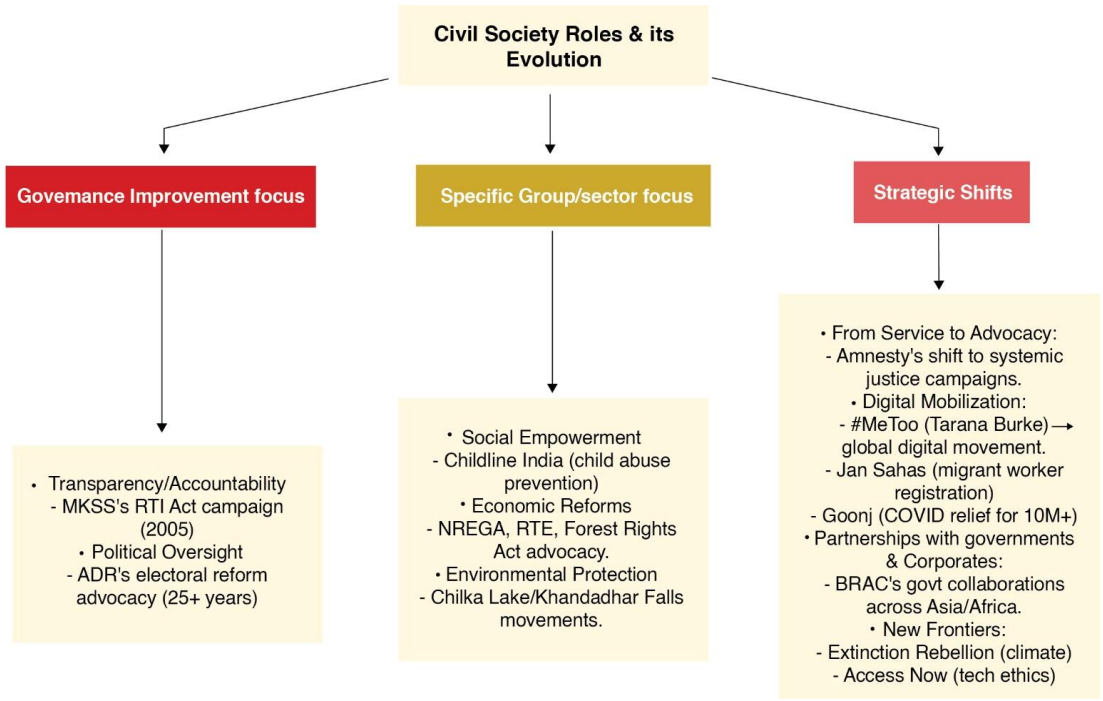
Based on the law under which the CSOs operate and the kind of activities they take up, civil society groups can be classified into:



2.2.4. Legal framework for CSO Regulation in India

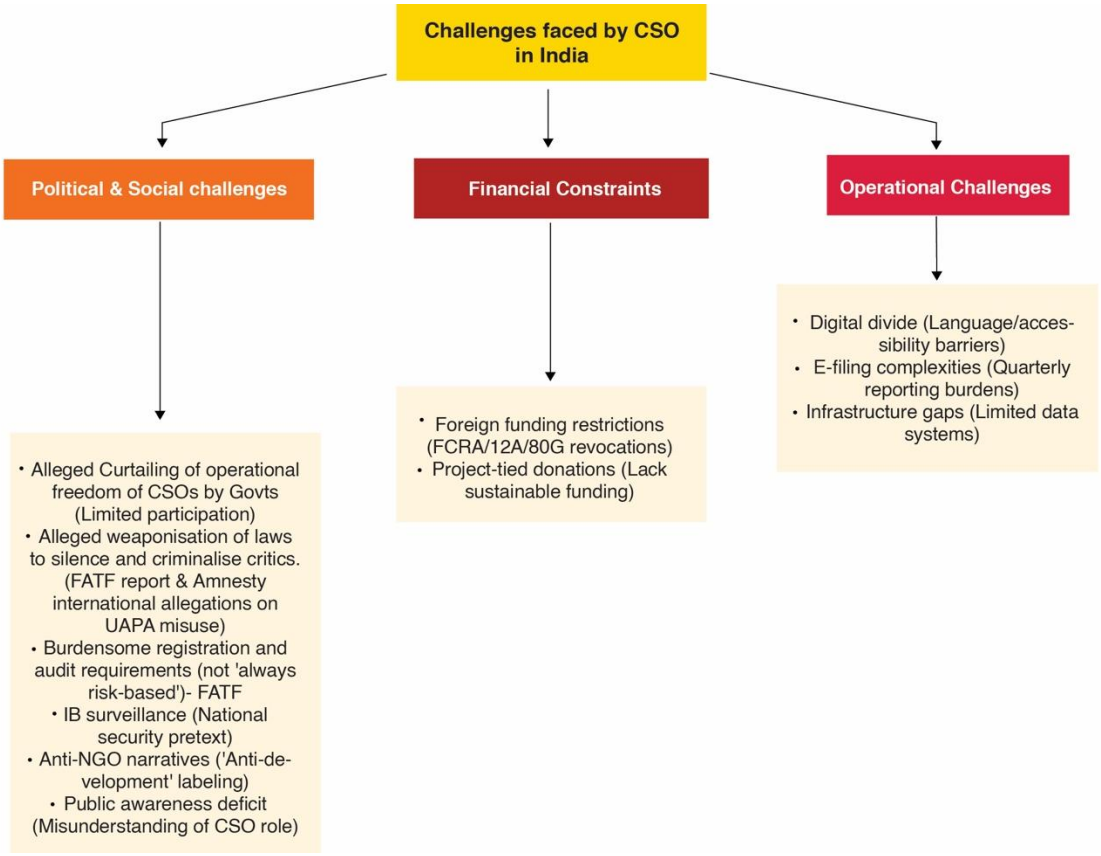


2.2.5 Changing Role of Indian Civil society



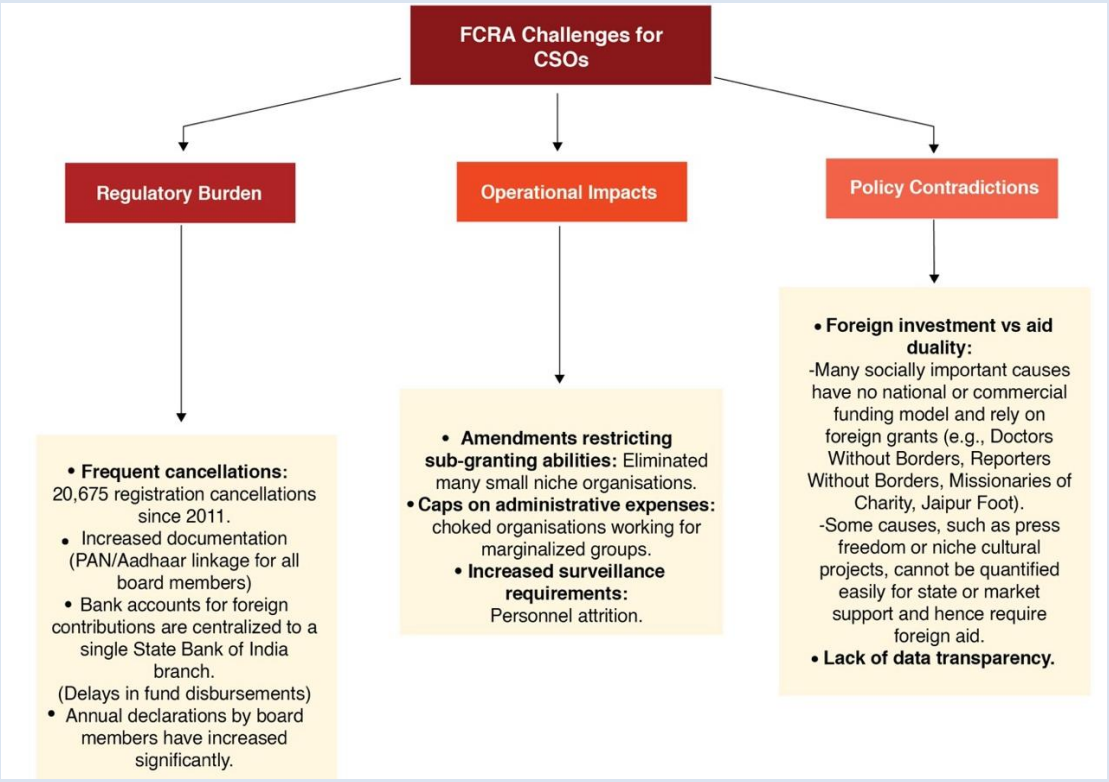
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2.2.6. Challenges Hindering Civil Society in India



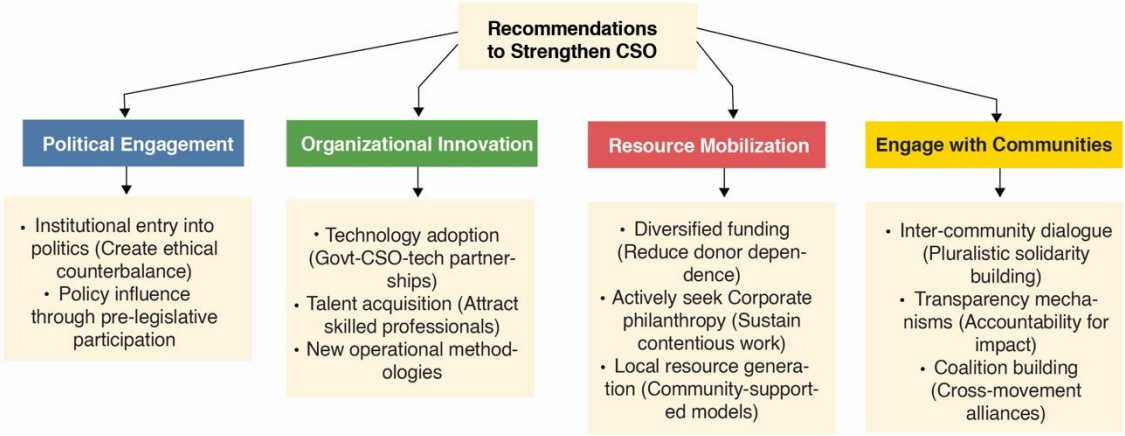
FCRA regulations and CSOs

Tensions between regulatory oversight and democratic freedoms in India's civil society sector under the FCRA framework has been in news. CSOs have faced following issues due to FCRA regulations:

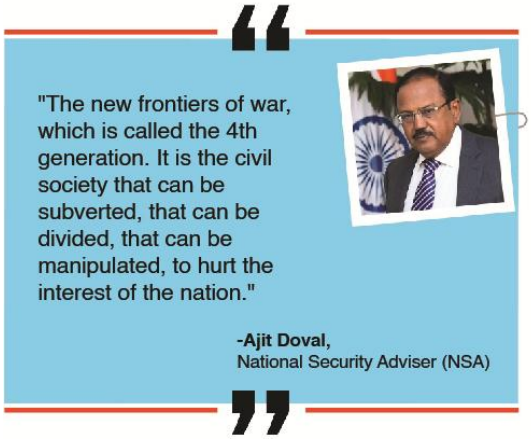


Student Notes:

2.2.7 Suggestions to improve working of Civil Societies



Indian democracy, due to **massive inequality and low-income universal suffrage**, makes **civil society essential for inclusive development** and transforming development into a **"Jan Andolan" (people's movement).**



2.3. Non-Governmental Organizations (NGOs)

A Non-governmental organization (NGO) is a **non-profit group that functions independently** of any government. **Civil Society, when organized** in structure and specialized in function, takes the form of NGOs. They are **organized on community**, national and international levels to serve a social or political goal such as humanitarian causes or the environment.

Evolution of NGOs in India	
Period	**Activities**
Pre Independence:	• **Social Reform Movements**: Reformers like Raja Ram Mohan Roy, Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar etc. laid the foundation for organized social work. • **Political Movement:** Many political associations and organizations paved the way for the organized political activism. • **Women's Organizations**: Women-led organizations like the **All India Women's Conference (AIWC)** and the **National Council of Women** focused on women's education, health, and empowerment. • **Gandhian Approach**: NGOs inspired by Gandhian ideals emerged, promoting khadi, rural upliftment, and non-violence.
1950s and 1960s:	• Despite their limited role, NGOs primarily concentrated on basic needs such as education, healthcare, and poverty alleviation.
1970s and 1980s:	• **Rights and Advocacy:** NGOs increasingly engaged in rights-based advocacy. They worked on issues related to child rights, women's empowerment, and environmental conservation.

1990s and 2000s	• **Due to globalization and technological development**, the role of NGOs has increased. • NGOs now actively participate in **policy formation** and **program implementation**. • Additionally, they collaborate with **Self Help Groups**, engage in **Micro Credit** initiatives, and focus on livelihood development.
2000s Onwards	• NGOs have shifted toward **evidence-based practices** and **impact assessment**. • Their role has now expanded to focus on rights-based approaches and involved in many areas like digital literacy, disaster relief, climate change action etc. • NGOs collaborate with **international organizations** and **businesses** (CSR initiatives).

Types of NGOs

NGOs can be classified in various types:

- **Charity-Oriented NGOs:** Their primary goal is to meet the immediate needs of the underprivileged. They provide essential services such as clothing, medication, food, shelter, education, and transportation.
- **Service-Oriented NGOs:** They run campaigns to advance specific causes related to family planning, healthcare, and education.
- **Empowering-Oriented NGOs:** These NGOs focus on empowering marginalized communities. They work on capacity-building, skill development, and advocacy for rights and justice.
- **Participatory-Oriented NGOs:** They involve local communities in **decision-making** processes. They believe in **collaborative efforts** for development.
- **National and International NGOs:**
  - **National NGOs:** These operate within a specific country, addressing national-level issues.
  - **International NGOs:** These have a global reach and work across borders. They focus on issues like human rights, environmental conservation, and disaster relief on an international scale.

However, this classification is not strict and rigid. These NGOs keep taking multiple works that can be categorized in one category or other.

Registration of NGOs

Indian NGOs mainly comes under three segments – Societies, Trusts, Charitable Companies.

- **Societies:** Societies have to register under the **Societies Registration Act 1980**.
- **Trusts:** Private trusts are registered under the central government's **Indian Trusts Act**, **2015,** and public ones are registered under the state legislation concerned.
- **Charitable companies:** They are set up according to the **Companies Act, 2020**. For charitable companies, the compliance requirements are high, as loans and advances are easily available to them compared to a trust or a society. They have to even pay **Income tax under IT act 1961.**

NGO DARPAN

NGO DARPAN is an online platform developed by **NITI Aayog** in collaboration with the **National Informatics Centre** to enhance transparency and accountability of Non-Governmental Organizations (NGOs) and Voluntary Organizations (VOs) in India.

It facilitates **registration, updates,** and **interaction** between NGOs/VOs and government departments.

Student Notes:

2.3.1. Role of NGOs in Development

In India, a developing country, there are significant gaps in **development left** by the **government** that are often **filled by NGOs.** These organizations step in to address areas where the government is either unwilling or unable to act effectively:

- **Supplementing Education and Healthcare:** In areas where **state resources are scarce,** particularly in rural regions, NGOs play a critical role. They help operate **schools** and **healthcare** facilities, significantly improving access and quality.
  - For instance, the Kerala **Sastra Sahitya Parishad** is renowned for contributing to Kerala's high literacy rate.
- **Addressing Social and Cultural Issues:** NGOs often tackle sensitive issues like caste discrimination, which many governments avoid due to political reasons. By advocating against such discrimination, NGOs help enforce laws that are otherwise overlooked.
- **Protecting Tribal Rights:** In high-profile cases like **Vedanta vs. Posco, NGOs** have defended tribal communities against exploitation by multinational corporations and have supported the enforcement of laws like **Forest Rights Act** the through partnerships with local governance bodies.

Prominent Environmental NGOs in India:

Greenpeace

World Wide Fund for Nature (WWF)

Bombay Natural History Society (BNHS)

The Energy Research Institute, Birdlife International

The Centre for Science and Environment etc.

- **Protection of Environment:** They play a crucial role in environmental **protection** by raising awareness, advocating for **sustainable** practices, and implementing grassroots **conservation** projects.
- **Welfare Scheme Implementation:** Close to the community, NGOs effectively act as bridges between the government and the public, facilitating the implementation of welfare programs. They serve as implementers, catalysts, and partners in these initiatives.
- **Promoting Transparency:** The Right to Information (RTI) became a reality in India largely due to persistent efforts by various NGOs like Pratham.
- **Disaster Rehabilitation:** Post the 2004 Tsunami, NGOs not only assisted in rescue efforts but also established vocational training centers to aid long-term rehabilitation.

These roles highlight the indispensable function of NGOs in filling the developmental gaps in regions where governmental reach and resources are limited.

Case Studies and Examples		
Impact Area	**NGO/Campaign**	**Description/Outcome**
Education	Kerala Sastra Sahitya Parishad	Instrumental in achieving a 100 percent literacy rate in Kerala by providing extensive educational outreach.
Poverty Alleviation	YUVA, SPARC	Worked to prevent the demolition of slums and improve living conditions, securing better housing and facilities for the poor.
Minority Rights	Vedanta vs. Posco case	Advocated for indigenous rights, ensuring the enforcement of the Forest Rights Act and CAMPA Act through collaborations with local governance.
Disaster Response	Rapid Response	Provides disaster response and preparedness services across India, notably effective during major emergencies.
Environmental Protection	Centre for Science and Environment	Key player in global environmental reforms, focusing on pollution control, hazardous waste management, and food safety.

Health Initiatives	Aid India during COVID-19	Amplified efforts during the COVID-19 pandemic to deliver healthcare and support to remote villages, enhancing the community health infrastructure.
Child Protection	Bachpan Bachao Andolan	Freed over 90,000 children from labor, slavery, and trafficking, advocating for child rights and providing rehabilitation.
Ethical Manufacturing	Good Weave International	Established a certification system for rugs manufactured without child labor, promoting ethical industry practices in South Asia.
Women's Rights	Women's India Trust	Focuses on empowering women through vocational training, health education, and legal awareness to enhance their social and economic status.
Wildlife Conservation	Wildlife Trust of India	Works to protect wildlife and habitats through conservation projects, legal advocacy, and partnership with governmental and non-governmental agencies.
Water Conservation	Water.org	Provides solutions for clean water and sanitation, impacting millions by facilitating access to safe water resources and hygiene education.

2.3.2. Challenges faced by NGOs in India

Non-governmental organizations (NGOs) in India play a crucial role in addressing various societal and developmental challenges. However, on one hand, these organisations are sometimes perceived as **hindering development** and raising concerns related to **credibility**. On the other hand, NGOs face their **own set of challenges**.

Allegations and Economic Impact

- **Accusations of Hindering Economic Growth**: Reports from the **Intelligence Bureau** suggest **"foreign-funded" NGOs** may stall economic growth by 2-3% through opposition to industrial projects.
  - Activities against industrial projects include protests, litigation, and advocacy campaigns that delay or halt project implementation.
- **Foreign Influence Concerns**: Allegations that **foreign donors** influence NGO activities to align with **international agendas**, potentially against India's economic and politically interests.

Transparency and Accountability Issues

- **Financial Reporting:** Only about 10% of NGOs report their annual income and expenditure statements, leading to concerns about the effective use of funds.
- **Regulatory Compliance:** Many NGOs struggle with adhering to stringent regulations under the **Foreign Contribution Regulation Act (FCRA),** which can lead to operational disruptions.

Security Concerns Associated with NGOs

- **Organized Crime and Terror Funding**: Some NGOs, like the IRF, have been accused of diverting funds for terrorism and radicalization.
- **Tax Evasion and Money Laundering**: NGOs can sometimes act as channels for tax evasion and money laundering activities.

Challenges Faced by NGOs

Funding Shortages and Restrictions


Government warns NGOs of penal action for receiving foreign funds without FCRA registration

In a public notice, the Ministry said that each FCRA-registered NGO or association has to utilise foreign contribution for the purpose for which it has been registered or granted prior permission under the Act

- **Limited Access to Funds:** Many NGOs struggle with **limited access to funds** due to stricter FCRA regulations. It impacts **financial sustainability** and leading to reliance on **intermittent** and **uncertain** funding sources.

Student Notes:

Urban-Rural Disparity

- NGOs in urban areas often have better access to **resources**, **training**, and **funding** compared to their rural counterparts, leading to imbalances in development efforts.

Professionalization over Volunteerism:

- NGOs started as **voluntary organizations**, but now they are **becoming professional entities**, which is defeating their original purpose.

Skill Gaps in Personnel:

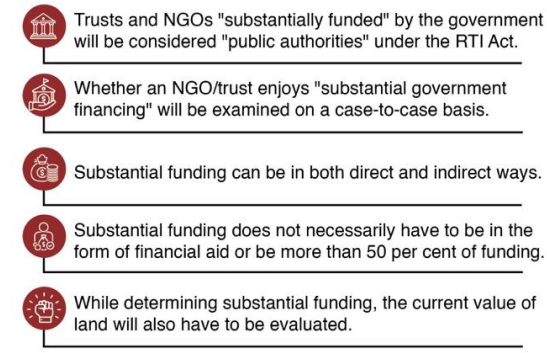
- There is a lack of **professionally trained staff** in NGOs, which makes it difficult for them to achieve their goals effectively.

Related news: NGOs under RTI:

Recently, Supreme Court ruling has brought the non-government organisations (NGOs) receiving funds from the governments under the ambit of Right to Information (RTI) Act, 2005.

Issues with the ruling

- Government could use such regulations to stifle dissent and target right-based advocacy groups.
- Smaller NGOs which may lack the capacity to confirm with such legal norms and rules.



2.3.3. Suggestions to Improve the Working of NGOs

Here are some suggestions that aimed at optimizing the functionality and accountability of NGOs across the country:

Relaxing regulations:

- The rules and regulations of grants-in-aid should be liberalized by the government and sanction more grants to NGOs.

Monitoring agency:

- At the same time, the government should appoint commissions of enquiry or committees to cross check the misuse of funds by NGOs.

Recommendations of Vijay Kumar Committee:

- Modernising **registration process** for seamless operation of the applicable provisions of the IT (Income Tax) Act and FCRA with respect to NGOs.
- Details of NGOs should be made available as searchable database information.

2nd ARC recommendations:

- FCRA should be decentralised and delegated to State Governments/District administration.
- Fine balance between the purpose of the legislation and functioning of the voluntary sector to avoid subjective interpretation of law and its possible misuse.

Focusing on rural areas:

- The government should give **some special incentives** for NGOs who are working in rural areas.

"NGO sector is under siege in the country"

Expert gives a clarion call to the government to treat NGOs as a trusted and essential partner for the country. "NGOs have had a very long and impactful history in the country, evolving from individual acts of kindness to organised efforts that have transformed communities, the country and science"

Appreciate efforts of NGOs:

- The government also should **recognize** those NGOs, by giving awards or rewards with additional grants.

Technology intervention:

- NGOs should leverage the **latest technologies**, such as the internet and websites, to raise **funds**, establish **mutual associations**, advertise their products, and select efficient personnel.

Collaboration and cooperation:

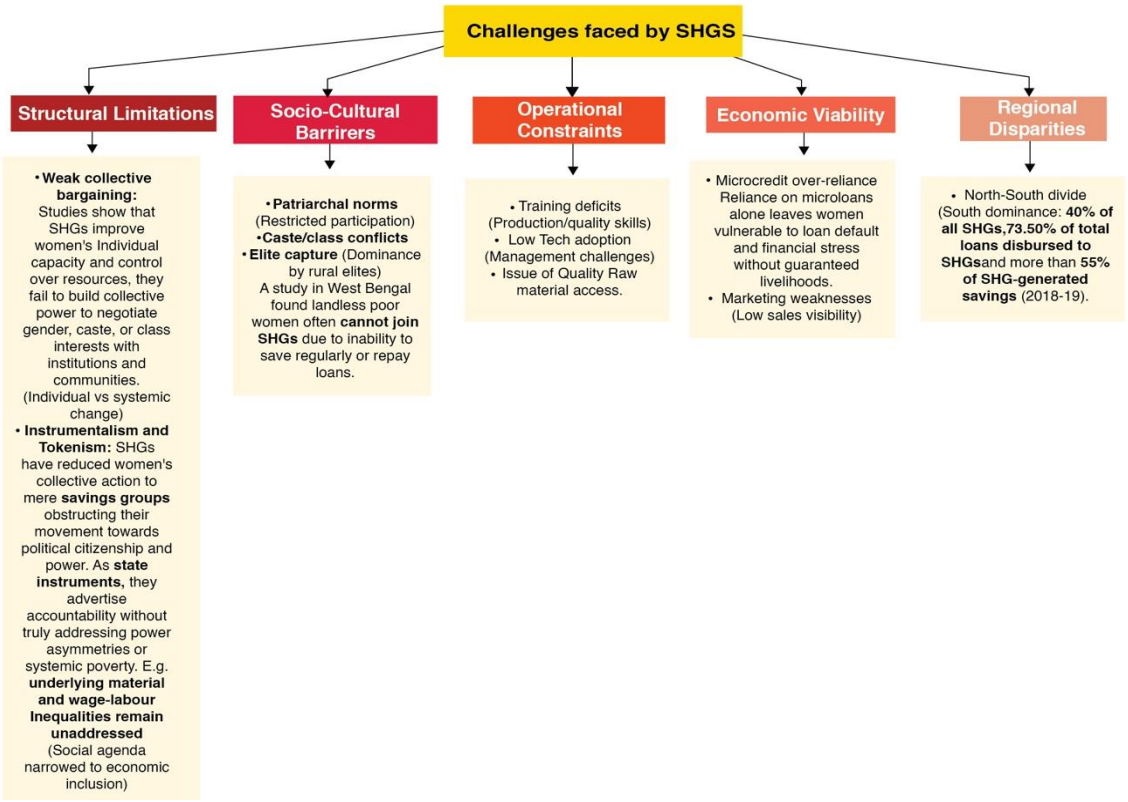
- Universities, colleges and schools should collaborate with NGOs and conduct a campus interview for the young graduates who are interested in voluntarism.

These reforms can significantly strengthen the NGO sector's capacity to address social, environmental, and developmental challenges more effectively.

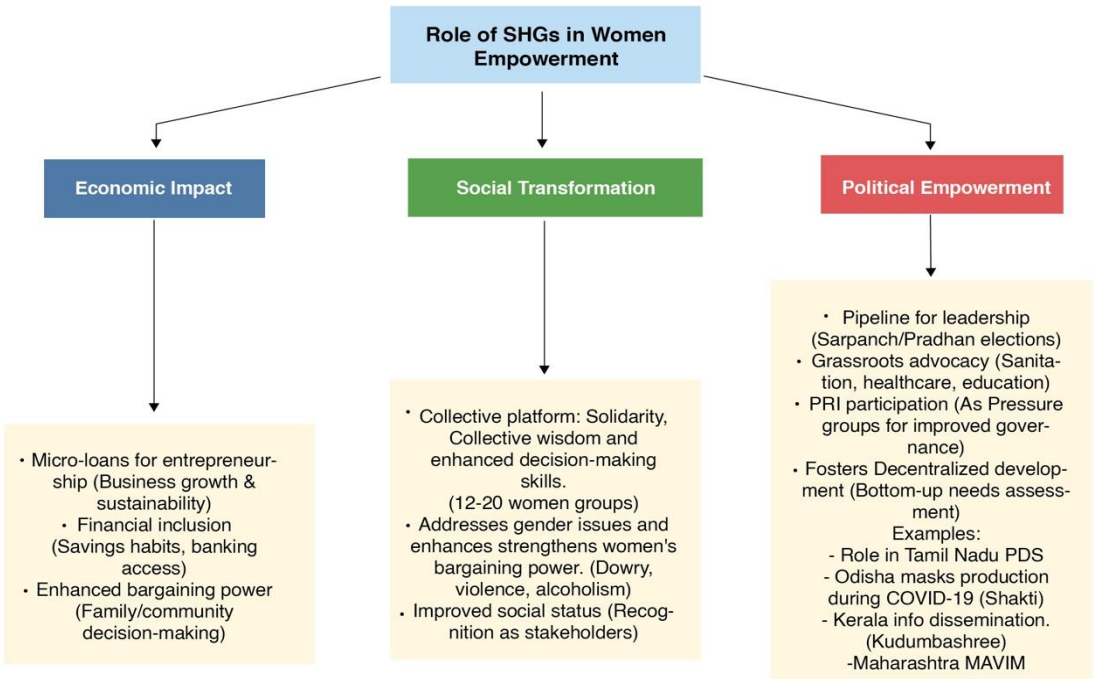
2.4. Self Help Groups (SHGs)

Self-Help Groups (SHGs) are **small, informal groups**, often composed primarily of women, formed through a **social mobilization process** that empowers the poor to organize themselves. These groups enable members to **actively participate and make decisions** on issues related to poverty eradication, employment generation, and income improvement.

2.4.1. Characteristics of SHGs



2.4.2. Significance of SHGs

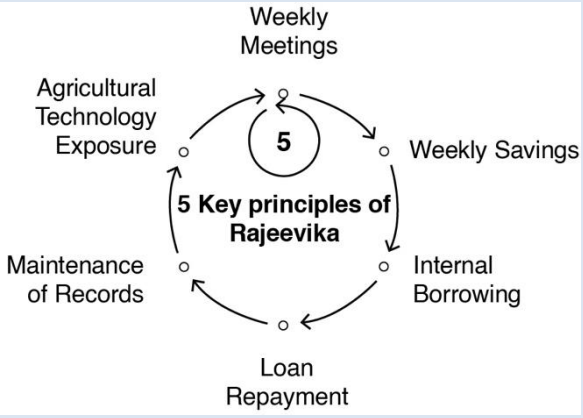


Student Notes:

Rajasthan's SHGs help African women to farm and flourish

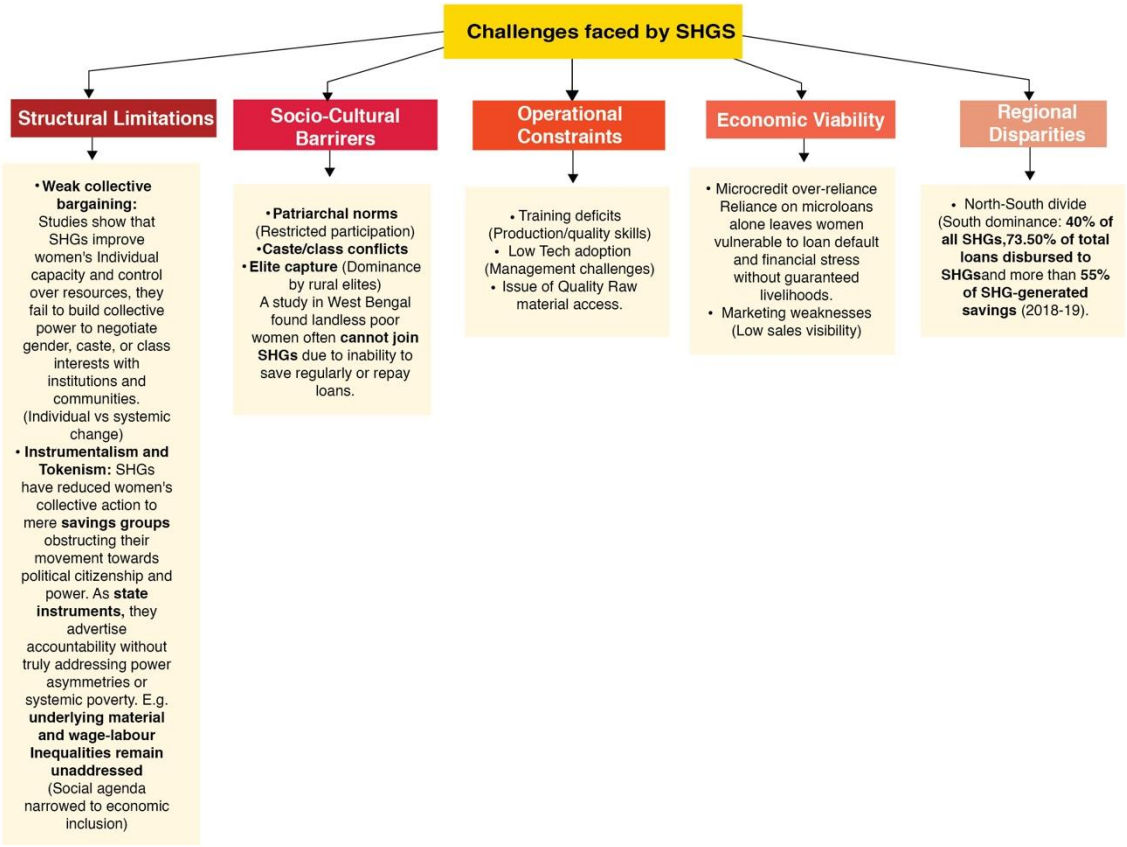
Women representatives from Mali and Senegal, who are saving up to ₹17 crore a year and utilsing the money for inter loaning, have supported one another with funds during emergencies

Women from Dholpur's SHGs, established by the Rajasthan Grameen Ajeevika Vikas Parishad (Rajeevika), has helped about 12,500 women in the West African countries of Mali and Senegal **earn livelihoods, conserve environment and establish cooperative federations** to take up farming, biogas production, poultry farming and goat rearing.



2.4.3. Issues related to SHGs

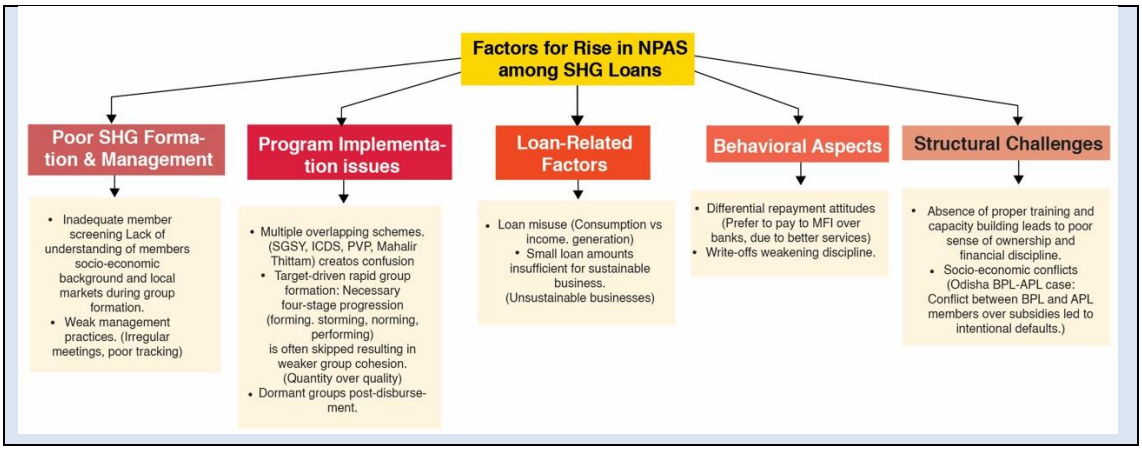
Despite their successes, **Self-Help Groups (SHGs)** face several significant challenges:



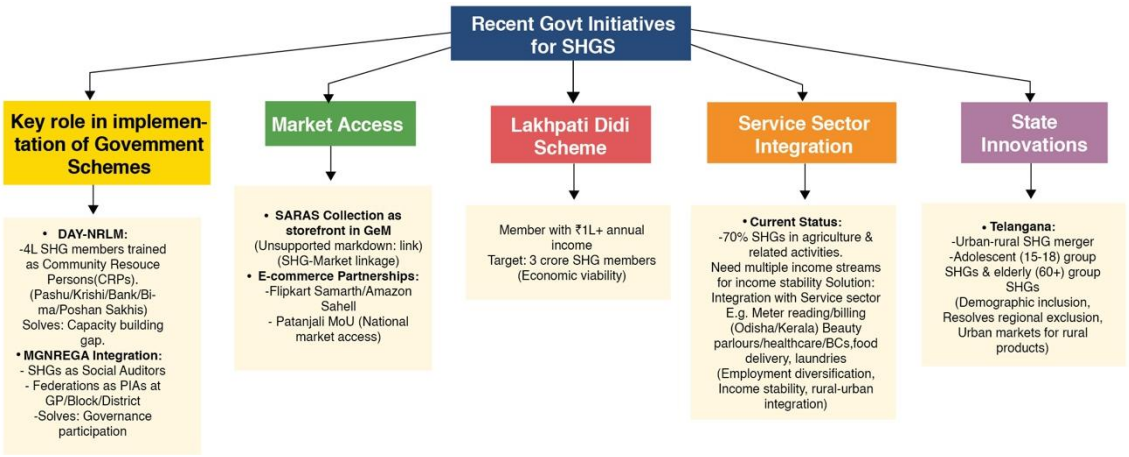
Rising NPAs for SHG loans

SHGs play a crucial role in promoting financial inclusion and empowering rural women through access to credit and collective savings. However, the rising incidence of NPAs within SHG loans poses a significant challenge to their effectiveness and sustainability.

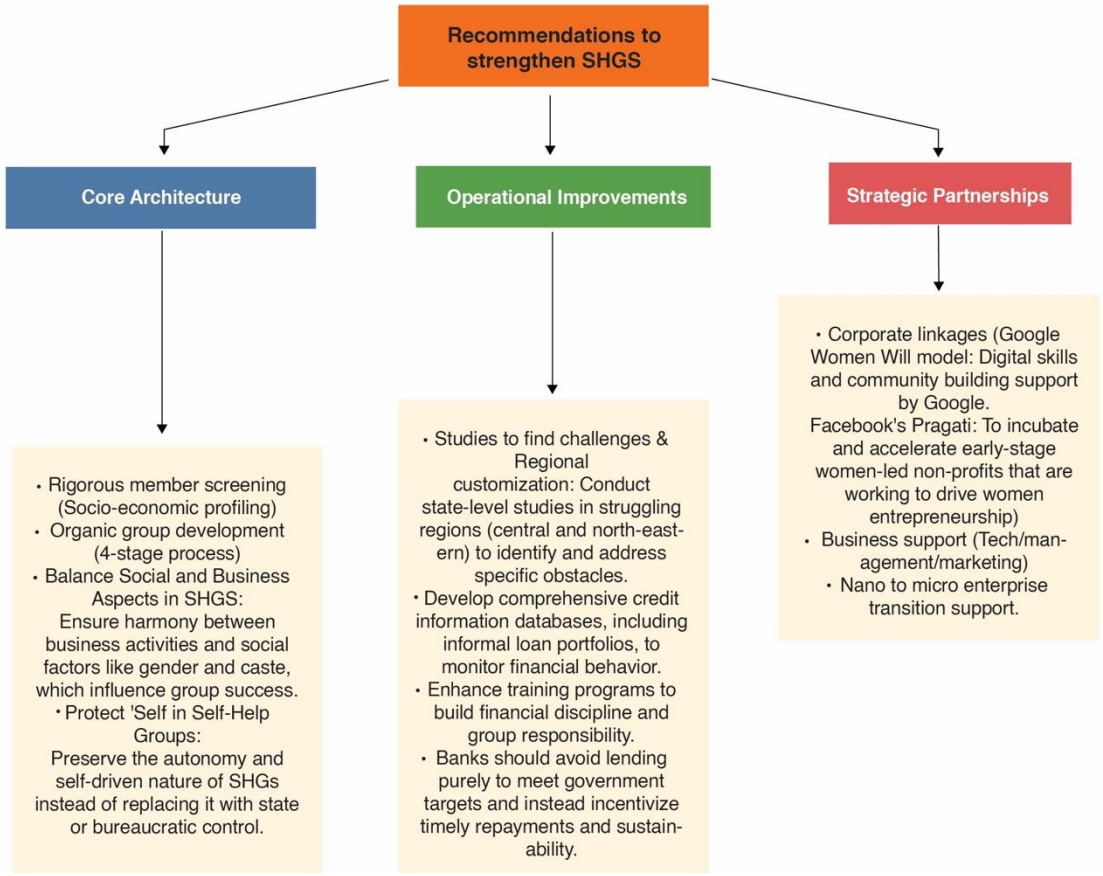
Student Notes:



2.4.4. Recent Government Interventions to strengthen SHGs



2.4.5. Suggestions to Improve the Working of SHGs:



Student Notes:

A **SHG 2.0, as emphasized by the World Bank,** addresses the structural and credit-related challenges of SHGs, and it needs to be implemented to transform SHGs into a true vehicle for women's empowerment and people-centered development. Government policies must align with this idea to achieve efficient resource mobilization and the consequent upliftment of women.

2.5. Co-operatives

Co-operatives are **autonomous associations** of **individuals** who voluntarily come together to meet their common economic, social, and cultural needs and aspirations through a jointly-owned and democratically-controlled enterprise.

They are based on the values of **self-help, self-responsibility, democracy, equality, equity**, and **solidarity**.

Historical Background:

- **Early Beginnings**: The co-operative movement began in Europe in the 19th century as a response to the industrial revolution and the social changes it brought about.
- **International Growth**: The movement spread globally, adapting to various cultural and economic contexts while maintaining core principles.

2.5.1. Functioning of Co-operatives

- Co-operatives function through **open membership** and **democratic control**, with each member having one vote.
- Members contribute **equitably** to the capital and benefit proportionally from surpluses.
- They maintain autonomy and **self-governance**, even in external agreements.
- Co-operatives also focus on **education** and training for their members and collaborate with other **co-operatives** locally and internationally.

Co-operatives in India

- **Pre-Independence:** The co-operative movement in India began in the early 20th century to address issues of **rural credit** and support farmers.
- **Post-Independence:** The movement expanded significantly after independence, with the **government promoting** co-operatives as a means of economic and social development.
    - The establishment of institutions like the **National Cooperative Development Corporation (NCDC) provided further support**.

2.5.2. Significance of Co-operatives

Economic Impact:

- **Boost to Rural Economy**: Co-operatives cover around 97% of Indian villages, and around 19% of agricultural credit is disbursed by co-operatives.
- **Economies of Scale**: The cooperative sector fosters economies of scale, evident in sectors like dairy, where more than 45,000 cooperatives with nearly 60 lakh members exist.
- **Employment**: The cooperative sector provides self-employment to more than 17.8 million people, improving socio-economic conditions, particularly for weaker sections through fisheries, labor, and gender cooperatives.

Constitutional Provisions

- **Article 19(1)(c):** Grants citizens the right to form co-operatives.
- **97th Constitutional Amendment Act added:**
    - **Article 43B:** it mandates the state to promote co-operative societies.
    - **Part IXB** (**Articles 243ZH to 243ZT**): it deals with co-operatives and outlines their composition, election procedures, and the principle of democratic functioning.

Legal Framework

- **MULTI-STATE COOPERATIVE SOCIETIES (MSCS) (AMENDMENT) ACT & RULES, 2023**: Governs co-operative societies that operate in more than one state.
- **State Co-operative Societies Acts:** Each state has its own Co-operative Societies Act that regulates co-operatives operating within the state.

Student Notes:

Social Impact:

- **Inclusive Growth:** Co-operatives prevent the accumulation of economic power and ensure a wider dispersal of ownership of productive capital.
- **Welfare:** They provide bargaining power to members, such as in cooperative spinning mills and weavers' cooperative societies, helping prevent exploitation.

Agricultural and Environmental Impact:

- **Fertilizer Sector:** Indian Farmers Fertiliser Cooperative Ltd. (IFFCO) reaches more than 5.5 crore farmers through its network of over 40,000 cooperatives.
- **Promotion of Organic Farming:** Co-operatives like the **Sittilingi Organic Farmers Association** promote organic farming, improving farmers' incomes by paying more than market prices for produce.

Innovation:

- **Product Development:** Co-operatives like **AMUL** have added numerous new products, while IFFCO organizes training in the usage of drones and other technologies for its members.

2.5.3. Issues Related to Co-operatives

Cooperatives in India suffer from following issues:

Management Challenges:

- **Professional Management**: Many co-operatives lack professional management, leading to inefficiencies and poor performance.
- **Governance Issues:** Democratic control can sometimes result in governance challenges, with conflicts of interest and political interference affecting decision-making.

Financial Constraints:

- **Capital Access**: Co-operatives often struggle to access adequate capital for expansion and modernization.
- **Sustainability**: Ensuring financial sustainability while maintaining co-operative principles can be challenging, particularly in competitive markets.

Regulatory Hurdles:

- **Complex Regulations**: Co-operatives are subject to complex regulatory frameworks, which can vary significantly between states, creating administrative burdens.
- Cooperative banks are under the dual regulation of the RBI and state governments, which reduces their accountability. An example is the PMC Bank crisis.

Regional Imbalance:

- **Uneven Development**: The cooperative sector is more developed in the western and southern parts of the country compared to eastern regions like West Bengal, Odisha, Bihar, and the northeastern states.

Government Initiatives for Cooperatives in India

The Government of India has launched several initiatives to promote and strengthen the cooperative sector:

1. **Ministry of Cooperation**
    - **Establishment:** The **Ministry of Cooperation** was established in **July 2021** to provide a **separate administrative, legal, and policy framework** for strengthening the cooperative movement in the country.
    - **Objective:** To streamline processes, improve ease of doing business for cooperatives, and deepen the reach of cooperatives to the grassroots level.

Student Notes:

2. **National Cooperative Development Corporation (NCDC)**
   - **Establishment:** The NCDC was established in 1963 under the National Cooperative Development Corporation Act, 1962.
   - **Objective:** To promote cooperative development across various sectors, including agriculture, agro-processing, rural industries, and services.
3. **Sahakar Mitra Scheme**
   - **Objective:** To provide paid internships to young professionals in the cooperative sector.
4. **Model Cooperative Societies Act**
   - Proposed to standardize and modernize cooperative laws across states.
   - **Objective**: To provide a uniform legal framework for the functioning of cooperatives, ensuring better governance and accountability.
5. **Rashtriya Mahila Kosh (RMK)**
   - **Objective:** To provide micro-finance to women cooperatives.

2.5.4. Suggestions to Improve the Working of Co-operatives

Following recommendations are advanced for strengthening cooperatives in India.

Policy and Regulatory Reforms:

- **Simplified Regulations:** Simplify regulatory frameworks to reduce administrative burdens and enhance ease of operation.
- **Consistent Policies:** Develop consistent policies that provide stable and long-term support for co-operatives, facilitating their growth and sustainability.

Capacity Building:

- **Training Programs:** Implement comprehensive training programs for members and leaders to enhance their managerial and technical skills.
- **Education Initiatives:** Promote education about co-operative principles and practices to build a knowledgeable and committed membership base.

Financial Support:

- **Access to Credit:** Improve access to credit by simplifying loan procedures and providing financial incentives for co-operative development.
- **Government Schemes:** Strengthen government schemes that support co-operatives, ensuring they are effectively implemented and reach the intended beneficiaries.

Technological Integration:

- **Digital Platforms:** Leverage digital platforms to improve transparency, efficiency, and member engagement within co-operatives.
- **Innovative Solutions:** Encourage the adoption of innovative solutions, such as mobile banking and e-commerce, to expand market access and improve service delivery.

Strengthening Networks:

- **Federations and Alliances:** Promote the formation of federations and alliances among co-operatives to enhance their bargaining power and influence.
- **International Collaboration:** Foster international collaboration to share best practices and access global markets.

By addressing these areas, co-operatives can enhance their effectiveness and better contribute to the socio-economic development of their members and communities.

Student Notes:

2.6. Microfinance Institutions

What are Microfinance Institutions?

Microfinance, also called **microcredit**, is a type of banking service that is provided to **unemployed or low-income** individuals or groups who otherwise would have no other access to financial services.

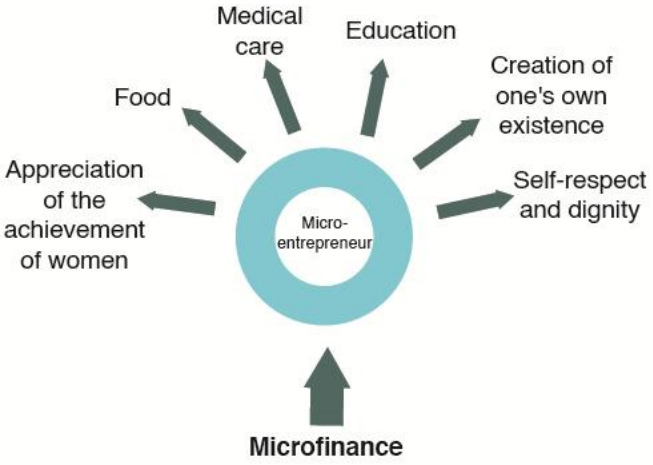
MFIs operate in several **forms and shapes in India:**

- Joint Liability Groups
- Self Help Groups
- The Grameen Bank Model
- Rural Cooperatives.

2.6.1. Role of Microfinance Institutions in Development

Microfinance Institutions (MFIs) play a **crucial role** in promoting development, particularly among underserved and economically disadvantaged communities:

- **Financing the Unfinanced**: MFIs focus on understanding the needs of the poor and develop efficient methods to deliver essential financial services, crucial for poverty alleviation**.**
- **Women Empowerment:** MFIs provide loans to **underprivileged women** who lack access to traditional banks, facilitating their economic growth and independence.
- **Rural Development:** In rural areas, MFIs offer credit **without** formal **mortgages**, helping to reduce dependence on high-interest local moneylenders.



The role of MFIs in development is thus multi-faceted, touching various aspects of economic and social upliftment, especially in marginalized communities. Their impact in fostering financial inclusion and supporting grassroots economic growth remains crucial for broader societal progress.

2.6.2. Issues Related to Microfinance Institutions

Microfinance Institutions (MFIs) are crucial for **providing financial** services to underbanked populations, but they **face several issues:**

- **High Interest Rates:** MFIs often charge higher interest rates than traditional banks, which can **burden** economically vulnerable borrowers and lead to **debt cycles.**
- **Over-Indebtedness:** Easy access to micro-loans can result in **borrowers** taking on **more debt** than they can manage, especially with limited financial literacy.
- **Inadequate Regulation:** Minimal regulatory oversight can lead to **non-transparent lending** practices and practices not in the best interest of consumers.
- **Limited Reach in Remote Areas:** Operational challenges and costs limit MFIs' effectiveness in remote rural areas.
- **Market Saturation:** In some regions, market saturation leads to fierce competition among MFIs, driving them to take greater risks and potentially compromising their stability and mission.

Addressing these issues requires a multifaceted approach, including better regulatory frameworks, enhanced focus on consumer protection, and stronger emphasis on financial education for borrowers.

2.6.3. Enhancing the Effectiveness of Microfinance Institutions (MFIs)

To improve the reach and impact of Microfinance Institutions (MFIs), the following strategic enhancements can be implemented:

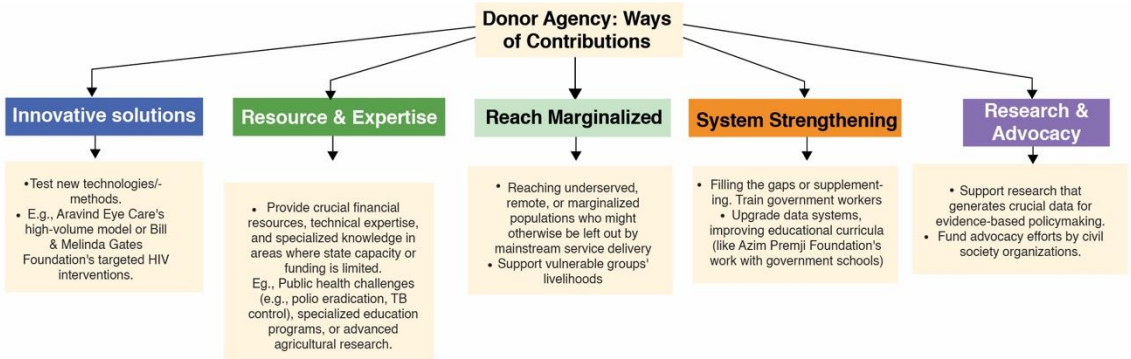
- **Enhanced Supervision:** Increase field supervision with regular audits and on-site checks to ensure operational efficiency and ethical practices.
- **Incentives for Rural Expansion:** Provide tax breaks or funding support to encourage MFIs to open branches in unbanked rural areas, enhancing financial inclusion.
- **Diversification of Services:** Broaden the range of financial products offered by MFIs and implement transparent pricing, using technology to maintain consistency and efficiency.
- **Leveraging Technology:** Invest in technologies like mobile banking, digital wallets, and automated loan processing to make loans more accessible at competitive rates.
- **Separate Regulatory Authority:** Establish a dedicated regulatory body to oversee MFI operations, enforce compliance, and reduce malpractices and political influence.
- **Strengthening Credit and Collection Processes:** Improve credit assessment and debt collection methods, and conduct educational programs to inform villagers about financial products and responsible borrowing.

These measures aim to enhance the capacity of MFIs to drive economic development and financial inclusion, especially in rural and underserved areas.

2.7. Donor Agencies

A donor agency is an organization, government, or institution that provides financial assistance to fund projects, programs, or initiatives in developing countries.

2.7.1. Important contributions



Important contributions of few international Donor agencies (Examples):

1. **Bill & Melinda Gates foundation**: They have particularly contributed in
   - **Health related initiatives:**
     - Significant contribution to **India's polio eradication campaign**.
     - Launched the **"Avahan" initiative** in 2003, an HIV prevention program, which was later integrated into the national HIV prevention program. This program prevented an estimated **600,000 new HIV infections**.
     - Supported the development of **low-cost vaccines** and improving sanitation.
     - Promoted use of **AI-powered tools** for rural healthcare workers, especially in Uttar Pradesh and Bihar.
   - **Agricultural Development:** Empowering smallholder farmers, especially women, to enhance productivity and income.

Student Notes:

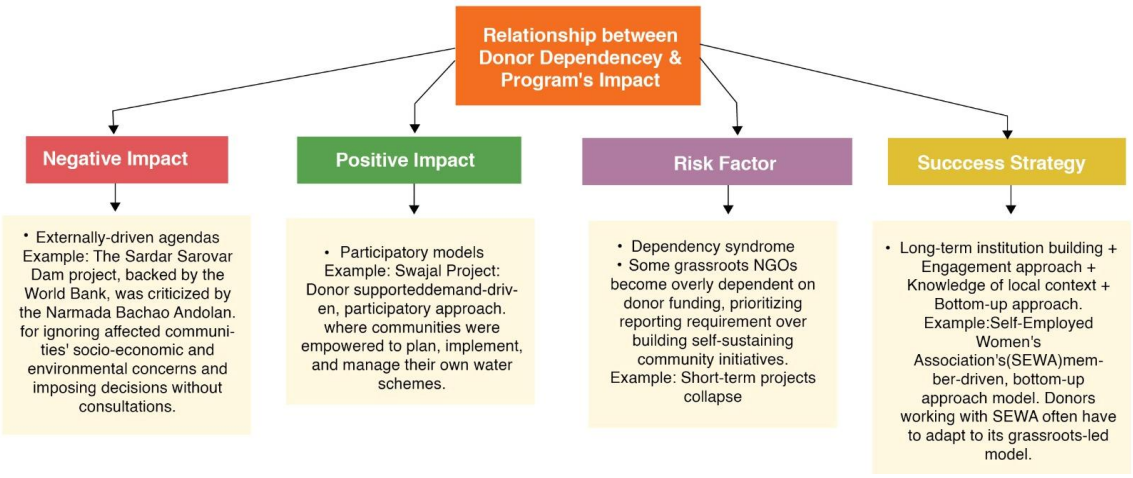
Student Notes:

- **Financial Inclusion and Gender Equality:** Promoting access to digital financial services and women's economic empowerment.

2. **United States Agency for International Development (USAID):** It has transitioned from food aid to supporting infrastructure, health (including TB and HIV/AIDS, maternal and child health), clean energy, climate resilience, agriculture (e.g., "Feed the Future" program), and disaster management. It significantly backed India's Swachh Bharat Abhiyan and COVID-19 response. Recently, USAID has been actively involved in India's efforts to combat TB.
3. **Ford Foundation**: It has played important role in supporting the establishment of premier institutions like IIMs, the National Institute of Design (NID), and aiding agricultural research during the Green Revolution. Its focus has also included community development, women's studies, and, more recently, empowering vulnerable communities to access justice and government schemes.
4. **Michael & Susan Dell Foundation**: This foundation concentrates on improving educational outcomes in public schools, skilling youth for employment, and fostering financial inclusion for micro-entrepreneurs and small businesses in urban areas.

Contributions of Indian Donor agencies (Examples):

- **Tata Trusts:** Recognized the **enormous gap** in affordable and accessible cancer care in India and launched a **Distributed Cancer Care Model** to address this issue.
  - Created a **network of cancer care centers** across multiple states, including **Assam, Odisha, and Jharkhand**.
  - The model involves **strengthening state-level hospitals** and creating **new facilities closer to patients' homes**, to **improve access** to cancer care.
- **Azim Premji Foundation:** Core strategy avoids creating **parallel systems**. Thus, it focuses on strengthening the existing public education infrastructure rather than replacing it.
  - Works **directly with government school teachers** and education functionaries and focuses on **building capacity** through sustained professional development programs.
  - Develops **high-quality open-source learning materials** for wider access.
  - Conducts **research to inform education policy and practice**.
- **Infosys Foundation**: A long-standing supporter of **Akshaya Patra, an NGO** renowned for its highly efficient, centralized kitchens that provide mid-day meals to millions of school children, foundation invests in technology and infrastructure for these kitchens, the Foundation has contributed to the efficiency and scale.
- **Piramal Foundation:** It supports the **development of digital tools for frontline health workers** (like Anganwadi workers and ASHAs) to improve service delivery efficiency in maternal and child health, and education. E.g., initiatives like "Fetosense" (a mobile fetal heart rate monitor).



Thus, when donors prioritize and genuinely support community-led initiatives and participatory processes, they can empower local voices and strengthen ownership.

Student Notes:

GOVERNMENT POLICIES AND INTERVENTIONS FOR DEVELOPMENT IN VARIOUS SECTORS AND ISSUES ARISING OUT OF THEIR DESIGN AND IMPLEMENTATION

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Student Notes:

Previous Years Questions (2013-24)

- "Electronic cash transfer system for the welfare schemes is an ambitious project to minimize corruption, eliminate wastage and facilitate reforms. Comment. (2013, 10 marks)"
- "The basis of providing urban amenities in rural areas (PURA) is rooted in establishing connectivity. Comment. (2013, 10 marks)"
- "Though 100 percent FDI is already allowed in non-news media like a trade publication and general entertainment channel, the Government is mulling over the proposal for increased FDI in news media for quite some time. What difference would an increase in FDI make? Critically evaluate the pros and cons. (2014, 12.5 marks)"
- "An athlete participates in Olympics for personal triumph and nation's glory; victors are showered with cash incentives by various agencies, on their return. Discuss the merit of state sponsored talent hunt and its cultivation as against the rationale of a reward mechanism as encouragement. (2014, 12.5 marks)"
- "Two parallel run schemes of the Government, viz. the Adhaar Card and NPR, one as voluntary and the other as compulsory, have led to debates at national levels and also litigations. On merits, discuss whether or not both schemes need run concurrently. Analyse the potential of the schemes to achieve developmental benefits and equitable growth. (2014, 12.5 marks)"
- ""To ensure effective implementation of policies addressing water, sanitation and hygiene needs the identification of the beneficiary segments is to be synchronized with the anticipated outcomes." Examine the statement in the context of the WASH scheme. (2017, 10 marks)"
- ""Policy contradictions among various competing sectors and stakeholders have resulted in inadequate 'protection and prevention of degradation' to environment." Comment with relevant illustrations. (2018, 10 marks)"
- "'In the context of neo-liberal paradigm of development planning, multi-level planning is expected to make operations cost-effective and remove many implementation blockages.' - Discuss. (2019, 15 marks)"
- "The Gati-Shakti Yojana needs meticulous coordination between the government and the private sector to achieve the goal of connectivity. Discuss. (2022, 10 marks)"
- "Reforming the government delivery system through the Direct Benefit Transfer Scheme is a progressive step, but it has its limitations too. Comment. (2022, 10 marks)"
- "What are the aims and objects of recently passed and enforced, The Public Examination (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024? Whether University/State Education Board examinations, too, are covered under the Act? (2024, 15 marks)"

Previous Years Questions Analysis: (Avg. weightage: ~20.73%)

1. **Critical Analysis of Policy Cycle:** This high-weightage theme requires understanding the entire policy cycle – from design and formulation to implementation and impact assessment. Focus on identifying issues, contradictions, and challenges at each stage.
    - *PYQ Example:* ""Policy contradictions among various competing sectors and stakeholders have resulted in inadequate 'protection and prevention of degradation' to environment." Comment with relevant illustrations. (2018, 10 marks)"
2. **Focus on Design and Implementation Gaps:** Questions frequently highlight the gap between policy intent and outcomes. Be prepared to discuss issues in policy design, implementation machinery, and the effectiveness of specific government schemes or interventions.
    - *PYQ Example:* "Two parallel run schemes of the Government, viz. the Adhaar Card and NPR, one as voluntary and the other as compulsory, have led to debates at national levels and also litigations. On merits, discuss whether or not both schemes need run

concurrently. Analyse the potential of the schemes to achieve developmental benefits and equitable growth. (2014, 12.5 marks)"

3. **Suggestive and Solution-Oriented Approach:** Beyond critique, aim to suggest practical measures for improving policy formulation, ensuring effective implementation, and achieving desired developmental outcomes.
    - *PYQ Example:* "Reforming the government delivery system through the Direct Benefit Transfer Scheme is a progressive step, but it has its limitations too. Comment. (2022, 10 marks)" (Implicitly asks for understanding limitations to suggest improvements).

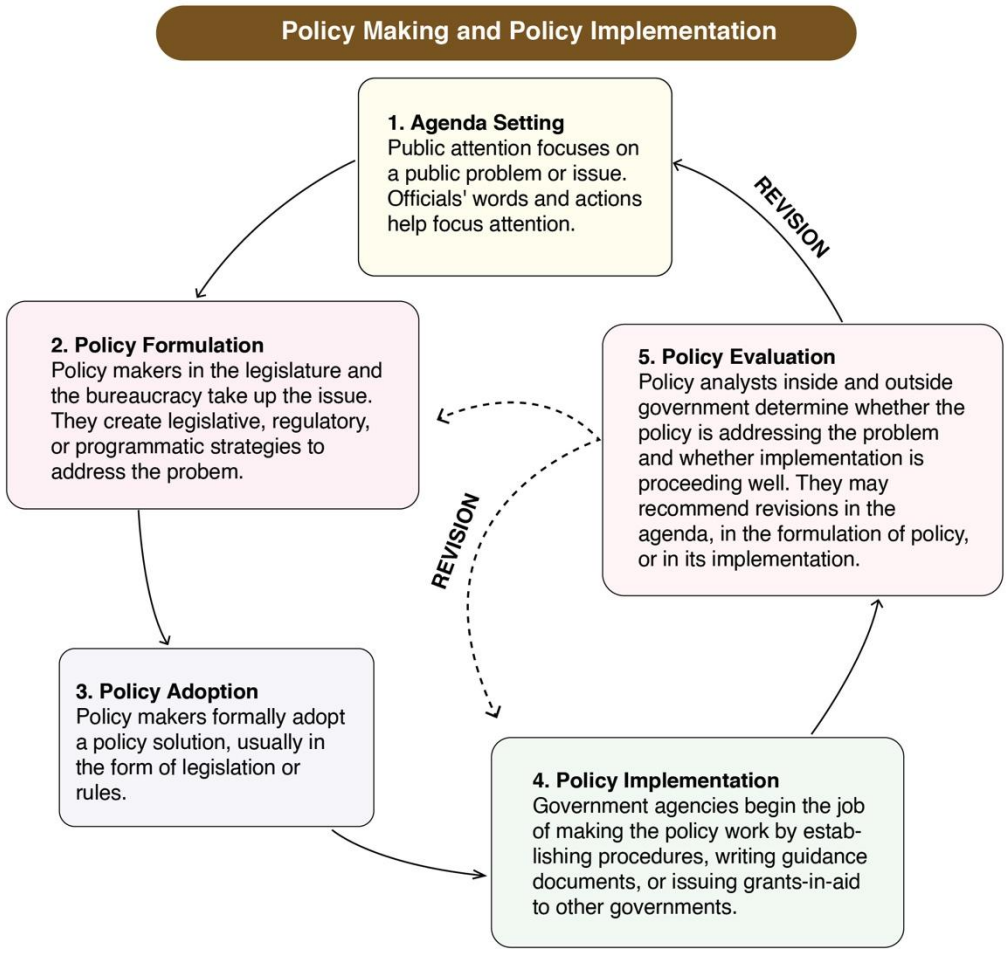
Student Notes:

1. Public Policy

Public policy is the framework of laws, regulations, and actions governments **implement to achieve social and economic goals**. It's a statement of the government's intent and commitment to address a particular issue or problem. Public policy shapes the decisions of government officials and agencies, and it affects society, the economy, and politics.

1.1. Process of Public Policy Formation

The process of public policy formation involves several stages, including agenda setting, policy formulation, adoption, implementation, and evaluation.



1.2. Nature of Public Policies

1. **Goal-Oriented**: Policies aim to achieve specific objectives, like the **Swachh Bharat Abhiyan**, which aims to improve sanitation across the country.

2. **Collective Action**: These policies result from coordinated efforts by government officials. For instance, the **GST (Goods and Services Tax)** was implemented through collective decision-making by central and state governments.
3. **Systematic:** Policies are developed and implemented through structured processes, as seen in the rollout of the **Aadhaar system**, which involved multiple stakeholders and systematic planning.
4. **Strategic**: Focuses on long-term goals, such as the **National Education Policy 2020**, which aims to transform the educational landscape over the next few decades.
5. **Complex:** Involves interconnected components and communication loops, exemplified by the **Digital India initiative**, which integrates various technological and governance frameworks.
6. **Action-Oriented:** Creates an environment for implementation, such as the **Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act (MGNREGA),** which guarantees employment to rural households.
7. **Consultative:** Involves wide consultation, seen in the drafting of the new **Labour Codes**, which included inputs from workers, employers, and other stakeholders.

1.3. Types of Public Policy

Public policies in India are diverse, addressing various sectors and target groups to promote balanced and inclusive development.

Category	Type	Description	Examples
Sector-Wise Public Policies	**Economic Policy**	Focuses on growth and inclusivity through initiatives emphasizing industrialization, infrastructure, and foreign investment.	Five-Year Plans, Make in India
	Social Policy	Addresses healthcare, education, gender equality, and social well-being to bridge social disparities.	National Rural Health Mission (NRHM), Sarva Shiksha Abhiyan (SSA), MGNREGA
	Environmental Policy	Balances economic development with sustainability, emphasizing ecological preservation.	National Clean Air Programme (NCAP), National Action Plan on Climate Change (NAPCC)
	Education Policy	Shapes the future by promoting holistic learning, research, innovation, and access to quality education.	National Education Policy (NEP) 2020
	Healthcare Policy	Recognizes quality healthcare as a fundamental right, focusing on affordable services and infrastructure.	Ayushman Bharat, National Health Mission (NHM)

Category	Type	Description	Examples
Target Group-Wise Public Policies	**Substantive**	General welfare and development, such as education, employment, economic stabilization, law enforcement, and anti-pollution legislation.	Right to Education Act (RTE), Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act (MGNREGA), anti-pollution legislation
	Regulatory	Regulation of trade, business, safety measures, and public utilities by organizations like LIC and RBI.	Directorate General of Foreign Trade (DGFT) regulations, Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) guidelines
	Distributive	Specific segments of society, related to grants of goods, public welfare, or health services.	Saakshar Bharat Mission, Public Distribution System (PDS), Pradhan Mantri Suraksha Bima Yojana (PMSBY)

	Redistributive	Rearrangement of policies to bring about social and economic changes, streamlining disproportionate goods and services.	Progressive taxation, subsidies for essential goods and services, Pradhan Mantri Jan Dhan Yojana (PMJDY)
	Capitalization	Financial help from the central government to state and local governments.	Centrally Sponsored Schemes (CSS), Smart Cities Mission, Atal Mission for Rejuvenation and Urban Transformation (AMRUT)

Category	Type	Description	Examples
Scope-Wise Public Policies	**Domestic Policies**	Actions impacting citizens directly.	Regulatory Policies: RBI regulations; Economic Policies: Mudra Yojana, LPG reforms; Social Policies: National Nutrition Policy
	Foreign Policy	Strategy for interacting with other nations.	Non-Aligned Movement (NAM), Neighbourhood First Policy

2. Public Policy in India

Public Policy in India after Independence

Public policy in India has evolved through distinct phases, each characterized by unique approaches to development

First Phase: Post-Independence Planned Economy

- **Active Role of State:** In the planned economy, the state actively promoted and shaped society through public policy, expanding its scope from mere regulation to development.
- **Planned Economic Development:** Post-independence, India adopted planned economic development, believing that economic progress would spur social, political, and human development.
- **Planning Commission:** The Planning Commission was primarily responsible for formulating policies and perspectives to guide the country's direction. The Five-Year Plans (FYPs) became the cornerstone of all government policies.
- **Regulatory and Promotional Policies:** Policies were crafted for regulation (e.g., controlling the scope for entrepreneurs and industrialists) and promotion (e.g., social change through acts like the Dowry Act and Divorce Act).
- **Focus Areas:** The primary goal was socio-economic development, with significant policy formulation in industrial and agricultural development.
- **Security Policies:** In response to internal and external security threats, defense policies aimed at national integration and cohesiveness were formulated. However, policies often faced contradictions; what was beneficial for economic development could be counterproductive for national integration.

Neo-Liberalism

- Neo-liberalism is a **political and economic ideology** that emphasizes the role of **free markets, deregulation,** and the **reduction of government intervention** in the economy.
- After the 1990s, **neo-liberalism** in **India** gained momentum.
- Key **changes** included reducing government control, privatizing state-owned enterprises, and encouraging foreign investment.
- These policies led to significant **economic growth**, **improved infrastructure**, and increased global trade.
- However, they also resulted in greater **income inequality** and regional **disparities**, with the benefits of growth not reaching everyone equally.

Student Notes:

Second Phase: Post-LPG Reforms and Devolution of Power

- **LPG Reforms:** This phase began after the Liberalization, Privatization, and Globalization (LPG) reforms in India, which marked a shift towards a market-driven economy.
- **Devolution of Power:** Significant changes included the **73rd and 74th Constitutional Amendment Acts**, which **decentralized** power to local governments, promoting greater participation and governance at the grassroots level.

Present Phase: NITI Aayog and Cooperative Federalism

- **NITI Aayog:** Established in 2015 to replace the Planning Commission, NITI Aayog aims to better serve a rapidly developing nation. It focuses on a collaborative and technology-driven approach to policy formulation.
- **Inclusive and Decentralized Policy-Making:** Unlike the Planning Commission's centralized plans, NITI Aayog facilitates policy-making that is inclusive and decentralized, aligning with contemporary governance needs.
- **Cooperative and Competitive Federalism:** The current phase is characterized by a blend of cooperative and competitive federalism, encouraging states to work together and compete in achieving development goals.

Multi-level planning

- Multi-level planning in India involves the central, state, district, and local governments **working together.**
- It aims to **create and implement** development plans tailored to regional needs.
- This approach enhances **efficiency**, **optimizes resource use,** and **promotes** community participation.
- It ensures that **development efforts** are more **inclusive** and **effective**, addressing the diverse needs of the population.

BUREAUCRATIC ROLES IN POLICY CYCLE

Role of civil servants in each stage of public policy formation:

1. **Agenda Setting:** Civil servants **identify emerging issues** and **priorities** them based on government priorities and public needs, shaping the policy agenda.
2. **Policy Formulation:** Civil servants draft policy options, **conduct research**, and **provide expertise** to develop detailed proposals aligned with government objectives and legal frameworks.
3. **Adoption:** Civil servants facilitate the **decision-making** process by presenting policy recommendations to policymakers, ensuring clarity and feasibility.
4. **Implementation:** Civil servants oversee the translation of policies into action, coordinating across departments, monitoring progress, and adjusting strategies as needed to achieve desired outcomes.
5. **Evaluation:** Civil servants assess policy **effectiveness**, gather feedback, and analyze outcomes to determine if objectives are met, providing insights for future policy adjustments or improvements.

3. Challenges in Policy Formulation at various Stages

Public policy formation in India faces several challenges at each stage: agenda setting, policy formulation, adoption, implementation, and evaluation. Understanding these challenges can help identify areas for improvement and ensure more effective policy-making.

1. **Agenda Setting**
   - **Political Prioritization:** Issues that gain **political attention** may not always be the most pressing ones.
     - For instance, while **environmental concerns** are critical, they often take a backseat to more immediate economic or political issues.
   - **Public Awareness and Engagement:** Limited public awareness and engagement can hinder the identification of crucial issues. Many rural and marginalized communities struggle to have their voices heard.

Student Notes:

- For example, in many **tribal areas of India**, issues such as lack of **access to clean drinking water** and basic healthcare services are often overlooked because these communities have **limited platforms** to raise their concerns.

Case studies and examples:

Delhi Air Pollution:

- Despite the severe **air pollution** in **Delhi,** which poses significant health risks, political focus often shifts towards economic growth projects.
- This includes infrastructure development or industrial expansion, overshadowing the urgent need for environmental policies and actions.

Western Ghats:

- The **Kasturirangan Committee Report** on the Western Ghats highlighted the need to protect ecologically sensitive areas.
- However, it often receives **less political attention** compared to economic activities like mining and real estate development.
- This happens despite the **long-term environmental impact** and biodiversity loss caused by these activities.

2. **Policy Formulation**
   - **Lack of Data:** Reliable data is crucial for effective policy formulation. In India, **gaps in data collection** and **inconsistencies** in data quality often led to poorly informed policies.
     - For example: The formulation of **policies around urban planning** often suffers from inadequate data on informal settlements, leading to gaps in addressing urban poverty.
   - **Stakeholder Involvement:** Ensuring comprehensive stakeholder participation is difficult. Marginalized groups may not have adequate representation in policy discussions.
     - For example, the lack of farmer engagement in the formulation of the Farm Acts 2020 led to widespread protests, resulting in the government repealing the acts.
3. **Policy Adoption**
   - **Political Consensus:** Achieving consensus among various political parties and stakeholders can be challenging. This often leads to delays or dilution of policy measures.
     - For example: The passage of the **Women's Reservation Act** or the **Goods and Services Act,** after much delay, highlights the difficulty in achieving political consensus.
   - **Bureaucratic Hurdles:** The complex and often slow bureaucratic processes can impede the timely adoption of policies.
     - The delay in adopting **e-governance initiatives** in several departments and states shows the difficulties in updating government systems and the resistance to using digital solutions.
4. **Implementation**
   - **Resource Allocation:** Effective implementation requires adequate financial and human resources. In many cases, policies are hampered by insufficient funding and lack of trained personnel.
     - For example, **the National Rural Health Mission (NRHM)** faced challenges due to insufficient funding and a shortage of trained healthcare personnel, impacting its ability to improve rural healthcare services.
   - **Coordination**: Effective implementation requires coordination between various government departments and levels of government, which can be challenging.
     - For example: The challenges faced in implementing the **Right to Education (RTE)** Act include inadequate infrastructure in schools, lack of trained teachers, and uneven distribution of resources across states.
6. **Evaluation**
   - **Monitoring Mechanisms**: Robust mechanisms for monitoring and evaluating policies are often lacking. This leads to difficulties in assessing the actual impact of policies.

Student Notes:

- For example, the **Public Distribution System (PDS)** in India suffers from inadequate monitoring, leading to leakage, corruption, and the failure to accurately target intended beneficiaries.

- **Feedback Integration:** Integrating feedback from evaluations into policy revisions is not always systematic or timely.
  - For example: Evaluations of the **Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act (MGNREGA)** have highlighted issues such as corruption and mismanagement, but addressing these issues effectively has been a continuous challenge.

Addressing these challenges requires a **multi-faceted approach**. By tackling these issues, India can enhance the **effectiveness** of its public policy formation and **implementation** processes.

4. Strategies for Improving Policy Formulation

Addressing the challenges in public policy formation in India requires a concerted and strategic approach. Here are some ways forward for each stage:

1. **Agenda Setting**
   - **Enhanced Public Engagement:** Increase efforts to raise public awareness and encourage active participation in policy discussions through community meetings, digital platforms, and media campaigns.
   - **Data-Driven Prioritization:** Utilize data analytics and research to identify and prioritize pressing issues based on evidence rather than political expediency.
2. **Policy Formulation**
   - **Strengthen Data Collection:** Invest in robust data collection systems and ensure regular updates to provide reliable information for policy formulation.
   - **Inclusive Stakeholder Involvement:** Create platforms for diverse stakeholder engagement, especially marginalized groups, to ensure their needs are considered in policy design.
3. **Policy Adoption**
   - **Foster Political Consensus:** Promote dialogue and negotiation among political parties and stakeholders to build consensus on critical policies. Mediation and conflict resolution mechanisms can help.
   - **Streamline Bureaucratic Processes:** Simplify administrative procedures and reduce red tape to accelerate policy adoption. Digital governance tools can enhance efficiency.
4. **Implementation**
   - **Ensure Adequate Resources:** Allocate sufficient financial and human resources for policy implementation. Training programs for personnel and better budget planning are essential.
   - **Improve Coordination:** Establish inter-departmental task forces and use technology to enhance coordination among different levels of government and departments.

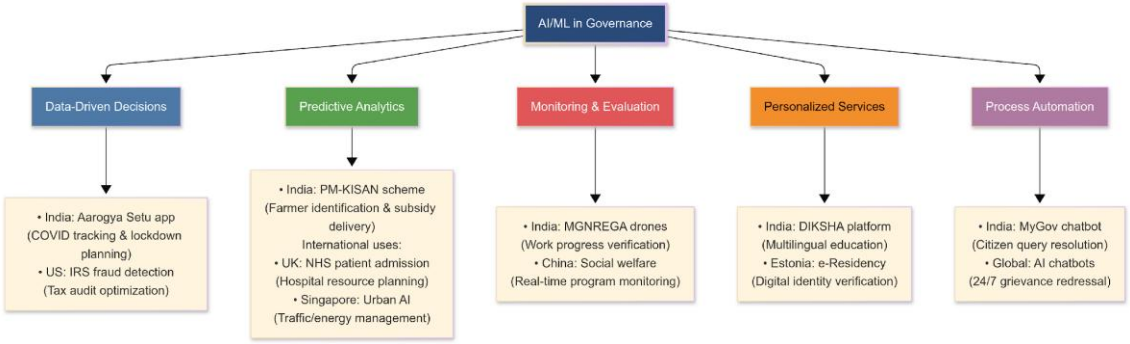
Importance of Good Public Policies in India Now More Than Ever

- Good public policies are crucial for India today due to rapid **changes and challenges** in various sectors.
- Effective policies help in **addressing pressing** issues like economic inequality, healthcare access, education quality, and environmental sustainability.
- With a growing **population and urbanization**, there is an urgent need for robust infrastructure, efficient public services, and sustainable development.
- Additionally, the COVID-**19** pandemic has highlighted the importance of resilient healthcare systems and social safety nets.
- Good public policies ensure that **resources** are allocated wisely, fostering **economic growth, social justice,** and **overall well-being**.
- They also help in leveraging technology and innovation to improve governance and enhance the quality of life for all citizens.

Student Notes:

5. Evaluation

- **Develop Robust Monitoring Systems:** Implement comprehensive monitoring and evaluation frameworks that use technology for real-time tracking of policy outcomes.
- **Feedback Integration:** Create mechanisms to systematically incorporate evaluation feedback into policy revisions. Regular review meetings and transparent reporting can aid this process.



Conclusion

To improve policies involves leveraging technology, fostering inclusive dialogue, enhancing data systems, and ensuring resource adequacy. By addressing these challenges through strategic reforms, India can improve the effectiveness and responsiveness of its public policy formation and implementation processes.



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Student Notes:

PRESSURE GROUPS

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3. Pressure Groups and Democracy 82

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Student Notes:

Previous Years Questions (2013-24)

- "Pressure group politics is sometimes seen as the informal face of politics. With regards to the above, assess the structure and functioning of pressure groups in India. (2013, 10 marks)"
- "Khap Panchayats have been in the news for functioning as extra-constitutional authorities, often delivering pronouncements amounting to human rights violations. Discuss critically the actions taken by the legislative, executive and the judiciary to set the things right in this regard. (2015, 12.5 marks)"
- "How do pressure groups influence Indian political process? Do you agree with this view that informal pressure groups have emerged as more powerful than formal pressure groups in recent years? (2017, 10 marks)"
- "What are the methods used by the farmers' organisations to influence the policy-makers in India and how effective are these methods? (2019, 10 marks)"
- ""Pressure groups play a vital role in influencing public policy making in India." Explain how the business associations contribute to public policies. (2021, 10 marks)"

Previous Years Questions Analysis: (Avg. weightage: ~8.54%)

1. **Understand Role and Influence:** Focus on how pressure groups (formal and informal, including farmer organisations, business associations, and even controversial entities like Khap Panchayats) influence the political process and public policy in India.
    - *PYQ Example:* ""Pressure groups play a vital role in influencing public policy making in India." Explain how the business associations contribute to public policies. (2021, 10 marks)"
2. **Methods and Effectiveness:** Be aware of the techniques used by pressure groups (lobbying, protests, advocacy) and critically evaluate their effectiveness and impact on democratic governance.
    - *PYQ Example:* "What are the methods used by the farmers' organisations to influence the policy-makers in India and how effective are these methods? (2019, 10 marks)"
3. **Comparative Aspects and Indian Context:** Understand the characteristics of pressure groups in India, how they differ from political parties, and any criticisms or recommendations for reforming their functioning.
    - *PYQ Example:* "How do pressure groups influence Indian political process? Do you agree with this view that informal pressure groups have emerged as more powerful than formal pressure groups in recent years? (2017, 10 marks)"

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1. Pressure Groups

Pressure group is defined as a group of **people actively promoting** and **defending their common interest**. They are the private **associations** which influence **public policy**. Pressure groups are **organizations** that **do not aim to hold political office** but work to **influence government decisions** and policies, focusing on **specific issues** or interests.

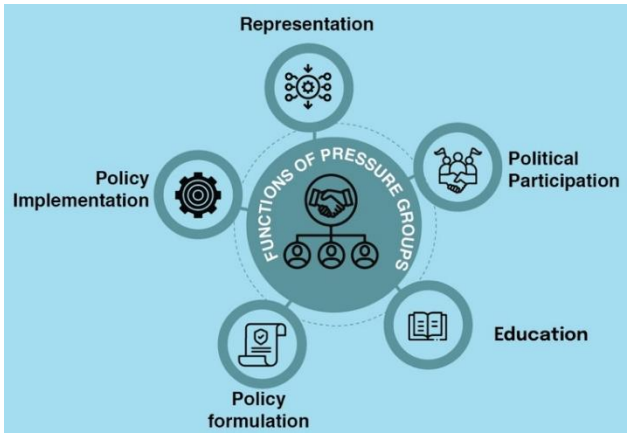
1.1. Significance and Role of Pressure Groups

Pressure groups play a **crucial role** in a democratic society by influencing government policies and decisions through various means, as follows:

- **Political Agents:**
    - Pressure groups act as **agents of political modernization**, **political socialization**, and **political education** by pushing for necessary reforms.
- **Connecting Government and Society:**
    - They serve as a **liaison** between the government and society, ensuring that the concerns and demands of the public are communicated to the authorities.

- This connection helps in maintaining a **balanced** and **responsive** governance system.

- **Role in Legislative Process:**
  - Through their **expertise and lobbying**, pressure groups act as the 'legislature behind the legislature.' They provide **valuable inputs** and **influence the drafting** and modification of laws.
- **Role in Administration:**
  - By **lobbying with the bureaucracy**, pressure groups influence policy implementation.
  - They also complement the efforts of the opposition in holding the government accountable.



- **Facilitating Social Progress:**
  - They contribute to social progress and prevent social stagnation by questioning existing norms, encouraging accountability, and gathering public support for necessary changes.
  - For instance, the **NAZ Foundation's** fight against Section 377 of the IPC and the **Bharatiya Muslim Mahila Andolan's** campaign for the Triple Talaq Bill are notable examples.
- **Enabling Constructive Participation:**
  - Pressure groups enable ***constructive participation*** of citizens, which is essential for a vibrant democracy.
  - They keep the **democratic conscience** of the nation alive by encouraging active public involvement in governance.
- **Safety Valve and Feedback Mechanism:**
  - Pressure groups act as a safety valve and vent for grievances, allowing **citizens to express their dissatisfaction and demands**.
  - They also provide a feedback mechanism for the government, helping it to understand the public pulse and make necessary adjustments in policies.

Recent Examples

Farmer Protests and Repeal of Farm Laws:

- In 2020, Indian farmers led by **Sanyukt Kisan Morcha (SKM), Bharatiya Kisan Union (BKU) etc.** launched massive **protests against the three farm laws** introduced by the government, marking one of the biggest movements in recent times.
- These **protests** led to the ultimate **repeal** of these laws and **showcased** the power of pressure groups through collective action, public support, and political influence.

NEET-Examination:

- The **National Students' Union of India (NSUI)**, a student organization, actively protested against irregularities in the **NEET-UG exam 2024**.
- The **sustained protests** led to attention on the issue, highlighting the power of student pressure groups in **influencing educational** policies and accountability.

1.2. Techniques used by Pressure Groups

Pressure groups employ various techniques to influence **government policies** and public opinion to further their interests. Some of the primary methods include:

Electioneering:

- Pressure groups engage in electioneering by **supporting and promoting candidates** who are sympathetic to their causes.

- They may **endorse** candidates, mobilize voters, and provide campaign contributions to ensure that their preferred candidates are elected to public office.

Lobbying:

- Lobbying involves **direct interaction** with public officials to **persuade them** to adopt and enforce policies beneficial to the group's interests.
- This can include meeting with legislators, providing expert testimony, and submitting policy proposals to influence decision-making processes.

Case Study: Lobbying for Net Neutrality in India

Issue: Telecom companies lobbied for **differential pricing for data services** between 2014-2016.

Lobbying Efforts: Major telecom players like Airtel and Reliance Jio pushed for plans like Facebook's Free Basics, arguing it would improve infrastructure investment.

Public and Advocacy Response: Advocacy groups (Internet Freedom Foundation, SaveTheInternet.in etc.) and the public **campaigned massively against these efforts,** emphasizing the importance of a free and open internet.

Regulatory Action: In February **2016, TRAI ruled in favour of net neutrality**, banning differential pricing for data services.

Outcome: This ensured equal treatment of all internet traffic in India.

Global Experience with Lobbying

Many countries view lobbying as an essential part of democratic functioning, allowing individuals and groups to influence decisions that affect them. Prominent countries that regulate lobbying include:

- **USA**: The Lobbying Disclosure Act, 1995 requires lobbyists to register and report their fees and activities.
- **Canada, Australia, Germany, Taiwan**: These countries have similar regulations to ensure transparency in lobbying activities.

Lobbying in India:

In India lobbying has traditionally been a tool for industry bodies like FICCI and CII to engage with the government, especially ahead of the national budget. Despite its importance, lobbying remains largely unregulated. There are no specific laws defining or overseeing lobbying activities, leading to a lack of transparency and accountability.

Lobbying and Corruption in India

- **Perception of Bribery**: Lobbying is often seen as synonymous with bribery in India due to a widespread belief that government dealings usually involve paying off officials.
- **Lack of Regulation**: India lacks clear laws and regulations to define and govern lobbying activities. This absence of a regulatory framework makes it difficult to distinguish between legitimate lobbying and corrupt practices.

Pros and Cons of Lobbying in India

Pros	Cons
Informed Policymaking: Lobbyists provide valuable information and expertise, helping policymakers make informed decisions.	**Inequality:** Lobbying can favor those with financial resources, undermining the principle of equality.
Advocacy: Industry groups can voice legitimate concerns about policies that affect them.	**Transparency Issues:** Without regulation, lobbying activities can lack transparency, leading to suspicions of corruption.

While lobbying is a recognized and regulated activity in many democracies**, India lacks comprehensive laws to manage it effectively**. Addressing this gap with appropriate regulations can help ensure lobbying is transparent and serves public interest without being conflated with corruption.

Propagandizing:

- Pressure groups engage in propagandizing to **shape public opinion** and, consequently, gain indirect influence over government actions.
- They utilize **media campaigns, social media, public relations efforts**, and educational initiatives to promote their viewpoints and garner public support.

Funding Political Parties:

- By providing **financial support to political parties**, pressure groups can gain favor and influence within those parties.
- This funding can be used for **campaign activities, advertisements, and other political expenses**, ensuring that the interests of the pressure groups are represented within the party's agenda.

Non constitutional Means:

- Some pressure groups resort to non-constitutional means such as **strikes, protests, and in extreme cases, violence**.
- These actions are taken to draw attention to their causes, disrupt normal activities, and pressure the government to address their demands.
- While these methods can be effective, they can also lead to legal repercussions and public backlash.

1.3. Difference between Pressure Groups and Political Parties

Pressure groups	Political parties
Try to **influence the decision** of those in powers	Parties contest for **acquiring formal post** in government
Formed on **common interests** irrespective of ideologies	Formed on **ideological lines** generally. Interest are much wider
Agencies of **interest articulation**	Agencies of **interest aggregation**
Methods- Electioneering, propagandizing, lobbying and direct actions like Bandh, Hartals	**Follow** Constitutional means for securing power
Generally **temporary** in nature	Mostly **continuous** in nature
They are **not accountable** to the people	**Accountable** to the people

1.4. Types of Pressure Groups

Pressure groups can be **categorized based on their nature, structure, and objectives**. The main types of pressure groups include:

1. **Institutional Interest Groups:**
   - These are associations of people who are **part of government** organization. They typically raise their concerns and protest through constitutional means.
   - **Examples**: IAS Association, IPS Association, Government Banks.
2. **Associational Interest Groups:**
   - These groups are **specialized** and pursue **limited, specific goals**.

Comparison of PGs in Developed and Developing countries	
Developing countries PGs	**Developed countries PGs**
PGs are less developed and immature	PGs are developed, immature and visible
Community based PGs are dominant	Associational PGs are more dominant.
PGs for mainly of capitalist class and labour class	PGs for almost every group or association are present. eg PGs even for nurses
Mainly target bureaucracy and ministers	Mainly target the legislatures
Presence of Anomic Interest Groups in large number	Anomic Interest Groups are generally absent

- They represent the interests of particular sectors or professions, including trade unions, organizations of businessmen and industrialists, students, and farmers.
- **Examples**:
  - FICCI (Federation of Indian Chambers of Commerce & Industry)
  - ASSOCHAM (Associated Chambers of Commerce and Industry of India)
  - AITUC (All India Trade Union Congress)
  - Bar Council of India (BCI)
  - National Students Union of India (NSUI)

3. **Non-Associational Interest Groups:**
   - These are **informal, community-based pressure groups** often formed on the basis of caste, region, religion, language, or ethnicity.
   - They may not have a formal structure but wield significant influence due to their large and cohesive memberships.
   - Examples:
     - RSS (Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh)
     - Karni Sena
     - VHP (Vishva Hindu Parishad)

2. Characteristics of the Indian Pressure Groups (PGs)

Indian pressure groups exhibit several distinctive characteristics that reflect the nation's diverse and dynamic socio-political landscape. These characteristics include:

- **Presence of Traditional Social Structures**: Many Indian pressure groups are based on **traditional social structures** such as caste and religion.
- **Emergence Due to Resource Demands**: Many pressure groups in India have emerged because **different sections of society are competing for limited resources**. As resources are scarce, these groups form to advocate for their specific interests and ensure their demands are heard.
- **Alternative to Political Parties**: Pressure groups provide an **alternative to political parties** by representing people who may not be adequately represented in the formal political process. They offer a platform for **diverse voices and interests**.
- **Patronage of Political Parties**: Many associational pressure groups operate under the **patronage of political parties,** often acting as extensions of these parties to mobilize support and influence policy. **Example**: ABVP (Akhil Bharatiya Vidyarthi Parishad) is associated with the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP).
- **Influence of Foreign Lobbies**: Foreign lobbies and international organizations have a considerable influence on Indian politics, advocating for policies that align with their interests and objectives.
- **Representation of Changing Societal Consciousness**: Indian pressure groups reflect the **evolving consciousness of society**, addressing contemporary issues and advocating for social change. Examples:
  - India Against Corruption (anti-corruption movement)
  - Safai Karmachari Andolan (movement for the rights of manual scavengers)
  - PUCL (People's Union for Civil Liberties)
  - ADR (Association for Democratic Reforms)
- **Presence of Anomic Interest Groups**: Anomic interest groups are **spontaneous pressure groups that arise in response to specific frustrations or issues**. They are characterized by their collective and often rapid response to particular grievances. Examples:
  - Naxalite Groups (left-wing extremist groups)
  - JKLF (Jammu and Kashmir Liberation Front)
  - ULFA (United Liberation Front of Assam)

Student Notes:

Student Notes:

Case Studies: Anomic Pressure Groups

- In 2024, Bangladesh saw massive student protests, initially sparked by demands to reform the government job reservation system. The movement **quickly escalated into widespread unrest**, challenging Prime Minister Sheikh Hasina's rule. The protests were **spontaneous and lacked formal leadership**, fitting the characteristics of an **anomic pressure group**. Violent crackdowns intensified the situation, resulting in significant public support for the protesters. Ultimately the movement led to PM Sheikh Hasina's resignation, marking a profound impact on the nation's political landscape.
- In May 2025, the group Palestine Action vandalized a Jewish-owned business in London, alleging ties to Israeli arms manufacturer Elbit Systems.

Impact of Social Media and Digital Platforms on Pressure Groups in India

Social media and digital platforms have **revolutionized the functioning and effectiveness** of pressure groups in India, enhancing their ability to influence public policy and mobilize support.

Positive Impacts	Negative Impacts
Increased Reach and Accessibility: Platforms like **Facebook, Twitter,** and **Instagram** enable pressure groups to reach a **wider audience**, including **marginalized communities**, at a lower cost.	**Misinformation and Fake News:** The spread of **misinformation** can undermine the **credibility** of pressure groups.
Enhanced Mobilization and Engagement: Real-time mobilization through **WhatsApp** and **Telegram** increases participation in **protests and rallies**. **Interactive engagement** through social media fosters a sense of **community** and **active public involvement**.	**Surveillance and Censorship:** Increased **surveillance** and potential **censorship** by authorities pose risks to activists.
Greater Visibility and Awareness: Hashtags and **viral campaigns**, such as **#MeToo** and **#JusticeForNirbhaya**, draw **national and international attention**. **Continuous media coverage** keeps issues in the public eye.	**Echo Chambers and Polarization: Social media algorithms** can create **echo chambers**, limiting constructive dialogue. The **anonymity** and immediacy of social media can also lead to **extreme viewpoints** and **polarization**.
Transparency and Accountability: Real-time documentation of events and **public scrutiny** ensure **government accountability**.	**Digital Divide: Unequal access** to digital platforms can exclude important voices from the discourse.
Collaborative Networks: Digital platforms facilitate **global alliances**, **resource sharing**, and **crowdfunding** for campaigns.	

Recent Examples

1. **Farmers' Protests (2020-2021):** Social medial helped in massive digital mobilization against farm laws.
2. **#JusticeForSSR (2020):** Social media campaigns demanding **justice for actor Sushant Singh Rajput** led to multiple high-level investigations.
3. **#StopAdani Movement (2021):** Environmental activists used social media to **mobilize global protests** against the Adani coal project.
4. **#StudentsLivesMatter (2020-2021):** Student-led digital campaigns led to the reconsideration of exam schedules during the COVID-19 pandemic.

Social media and digital platforms have **significantly enhanced the reach, visibility, and effectiveness** of pressure groups in India. While they present **challenges** like **misinformation** and digital divides, their role in modern activism is indispensable for mobilizing support, raising awareness, and influencing policy decisions.

2.1. Criticism of Indian Pressure Groups (PGs)

Indian pressure groups face several criticisms that hinder their effectiveness as agents of interest articulation:

Challenge	Description
Focus on Parochial Interests	Unlike pressure groups in the West, Indian pressure groups are often organized around **caste, religion,** and **ethnicity**. They tend to pursue narrow, **sectarian interests** rather than broader socio-economic goals, limiting their impact on national policy.
Lack of Autonomous Existence	Many Indian pressure groups act as **junior partners** to political parties and are often sponsored by them. This lack of independence compromises their ability to represent their constituencies impartially.
Instability Due to Lack of Commitment	Indian pressure groups often suffer from **instability** because their loyalty is frequently shifting. This lack of consistent commitment weakens their influence and effectiveness.
Propagation of Extremism and Non-constitutional Means	Some pressure groups propagate **extremist views** and resort to **non-constitutional means** such as strikes, protests, and violence to achieve their goals. This approach can undermine the rule of law and social harmony.
Lack of Sound Civic Consciousness	The absence of a robust **civic consciousness** in India hinders the development of healthy and functional pressure groups. This deficiency results in groups that are less effective in advocating for the public good.
Political Funding and Arm-Twisting	**Political funding** by pressure groups enables them to exert undue influence on the government, often prioritizing their interests over larger national concerns. This practice can lead to decisions that are not in the best interest of the broader population.
Excessive Proximity to Government	The close relationship between some pressure groups and the government can **diminish the credibility** of both entities in the eyes of the public. While pressure groups have the right to advocate for their interests, the government must maintain a **balance between negotiation and undue influence** to preserve its integrity.

2.2. Recommendations to Reform Functioning of Pressure Groups

To enhance the effectiveness and credibility of Indian pressure groups, several measures can be undertaken: **Broaden Focus to Socio-Economic Interests:**

- Encourage pressure groups to address broader socio-economic issues beyond parochial interests like caste, religion, and ethnicity to contribute more effectively to national policy and development.

Ensure Autonomous Existence and Stability:

- Promote the independence of pressure groups from political parties and enhance their stability through capacity-building initiatives and fostering a culture of long-term engagement and dedication to their causes.

Student Notes:

Student Notes:

Discourage Extremism and Unconstitutional Means:

- Implement strict regulations to prevent the propagation of extremism and the use of unconstitutional means by pressure groups.
- Encourage peaceful and lawful advocacy methods through awareness campaigns and legal reforms.

Enhance Civic Consciousness:

- Promote civic education and public awareness to develop a sound civic consciousness among the populace.
- Integrate civic education into school curricula and encourage active citizenship and community involvement.

Regulate Political Funding and Maintain Government Integrity:

- Implement transparent and stringent regulations on political funding by pressure groups to prevent undue influence.
- Establish clear guidelines to manage the relationship between pressure groups and the government, ensuring that legitimate advocacy does not compromise government integrity.

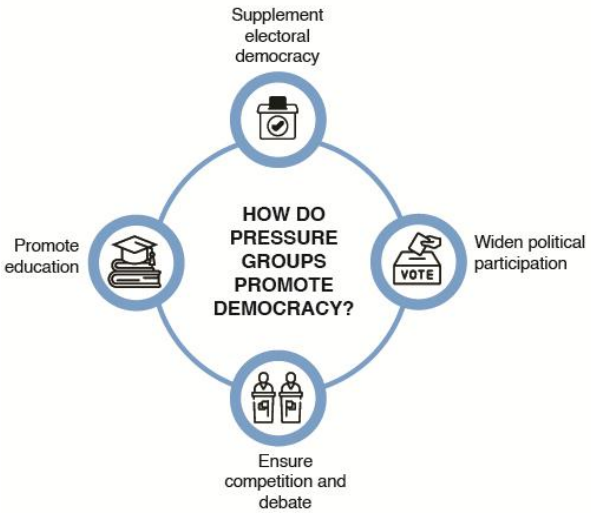
Promote Inclusive Dialogue and Strengthen Legal Frameworks:

- Create platforms for inclusive dialogue between pressure groups, government bodies, and civil society organizations.
- Strengthen legal and regulatory frameworks governing pressure groups to ensure accountability, transparency, and ethical conduct.

By addressing these challenges through comprehensive reforms and proactive measures, Indian pressure groups can become more effective, responsible, and credible agents to the democratic process and national development.

3. Pressure Groups and Democracy

How Pressure Groups Promote Democracy?



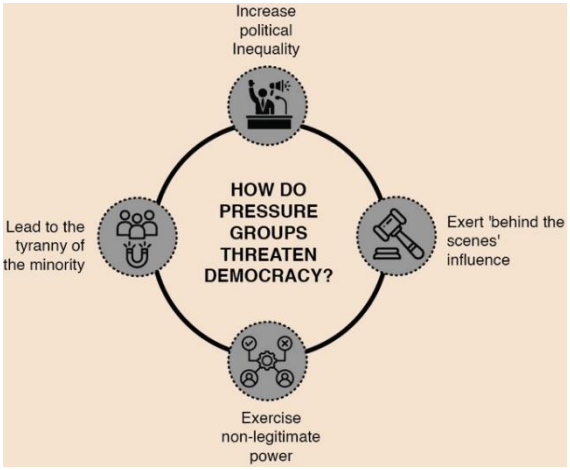
1. **Supplement Electoral Democracy:**
   - **Ongoing Public Engagement:** Pressure groups keep the **government in touch with public opinion** between elections. For example, the India Against Corruption (IAC) movement highlighted rising public sentiment against corruption.
   - **Voice for Minorities:** They articulate concerns **overlooked** by political parties, such as environmental issues, civil liberties, and women's rights.
2. **Widen Political Participation:**
   - **Grassroots Activism:** Pressure groups encourage **political participation**, especially among young people and those **disillusioned** with conventional politics, through single-issue politics and decentralized organization.
3. **Ensure Competition and Debate:**
   - **Distribution of Power:** By competing against each other, pressure groups prevent any single interest from becoming dominant, thereby promoting a balanced distribution of political power.

Student Notes:

4. **Promote Education:**
    - **Informed Electorate:** Pressure groups foster political debates and discussions, leading to a better-informed electorate and improved public policy.

How Pressure Groups Threaten Democracy?

1. **Increase Political Inequality:**
    - **Empowering the Powerful:** Rather than dispersing power, pressure groups often empower those **already in power**, increasing political inequality. The most influential groups typically have **significant financial resources, expertise,** and **institutional leverage**.
2. **Exert 'Behind the Scenes' Influence:**
    - **Lack of Transparency:** Pressure groups often operate **out of public scrutiny**, exerting influence behind closed doors. Insider groups, in particular, engage with government officials away from media and public oversight, undermining **democratic transparency**.
1. **Exercise Non-Legitimate Power:**
    - **Lack of Accountability:** Pressure group leaders are **not elected** by the public, making their influence undemocratic and illegitimate. Many pressure groups **lack internal democracy**, with leaders often being self-appointed or elected with low member turnout.
2. **Lead to the Tyranny of the Minority:**
    - **Minority Domination**: Pressure Groups may also **impose minority views** on the majority. Special interest groups can push policies that **benefit a small section** at the expense of the broader public interest.



While pressure groups play an essential role in a democracy by representing diverse interests and facilitating political participation, they can also threaten democratic principles. The challenges highlight the need for greater scrutiny and regulation of pressure groups to ensure they contribute positively to the democratic process.

